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AND CURRICULUM STUDIES

EMP 401: EDUCATIONAL ADMINISTRATION

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THEORY AND CONCEPT OF EDUCATIONAL ADMINISTRATION

The Concept of Educational Administration and Educational Management

Administration is the organizing and carrying out of a programme of activities and functions to achieve desired and specified objectives. Owens (1998) defines administration as the art of getting things done through others in an organization. The science of administration is therefore the system of knowledge whereby man understands relationships, predicts results and influences outcomes for a common purpose. It is the process or art of running an organization. It also involves arrangement of tasks that are needed to run an organization. Having discussed administration in general, let us now specifically look at educational administration.

Educational administration is an *eclectic field*. It sources its ideas from a wide range of disciplines and fields. Educational administration has many elements in common with other fields, e.g. business administration, church administration, military administration etc. Studies in one type of administration can be used to improve administrative behavior in other areas. There is always much to be learned by a transfer of knowledge from one field of administration to another.

Management is the art of getting things done by others. It is the process of accomplishing specific objectives and directions of a group activity towards the goal. According to McGregor (1960), management is a process that involves planning, organizing and controlling and is performed to determine and accomplish the objectives by the use of people and other resources available.

Educational Management

This is an academic discipline that lacks its own theories, principles, skills and practices but it borrows from other disciplines that are related to and applies to education. School managers are informed and enriched by knowledge from other disciplines.

School managers consult widely and collaborate with the relevant sectors to enhance productivity. Head teachers interact with the various members of the school community to possess a diversity of ideas. School managers provide windows of opportunities in the school for all stakeholders to take part in. Consequently, education management has been described as an eclectic field.

The knowledge of educational management would facilitate the following:

- It ensures that sound policies and objectives are formulated in a school and that the methods are pre-determined for the achievement of the objectives.
- Procures resources necessary for the achievement of the objectives.
- It ensures proper organization and coordination of activities in a school in order to achieve the set objectives with maximum efficiency and effectiveness.
- **(What is the difference between efficiency and effectiveness)** Effectiveness means ability to attain the set goals and efficiency means maximum input at minimum cost.
- It influences and stimulates the human resources so that they work towards the achievements of the set educational objectives.
- It integrates the school and its activities in the setup of the society. This means that there must be good school community relations.

Nature of Theory

Theory is an endeavor to understand reality. It is a conceptual scheme or system that is held to explain a group of facts or phenomena, and to discover and organize facts. Simply put, a theory is the systematically organized knowledge or thought with the supreme aim of explaining observed phenomena. Just as a theory explain why a ship floats on water or why wind flows in a certain direction, there are educational management and leadership theories about how educational institutions and other organizations operate. It is worth to note that the dynamic and progressive nature of knowledge leads to a creation of new concepts in an attempt to make sense of concepts in use.

Theory Verses Practice

According to Hoy & Miskel (1978), theory is directly linked to practice in at least three ways. These ways include:

- i) Theory provides a frame of reference to the practitioner.
- ii) The process of theorizing provides a general mode of analyses of practical events.
- iii) Theory guides practical and rational decision making.

THEORIES OF EDUCATIONAL ADMINISTRATION

Having understood the concept of theory and its importance in educational administration, we will embark on learning three schools of management thoughts or theories, namely classical management theory, human relation movement and behavioral science theory. In this lesson we will learn about Scientific Management theory by Fredrick Taylor which is a classical theory.

Classical Theory (classical school of thought)

The Industrial Revolution gave rise to the need for a more sophisticated approach to administration. Due to the development of new manufacturing technologies, great quantities of raw materials and large numbers of workers were concentrated in the emerging factories. It became increasingly difficult to coordinate all these resources into a smoothly running process; hence people began to pay more attention to the problems of management.

Although several people made considerable contribution to the early development of management thought, three prominent personalities are taken to represent the classical movement. These are Fredrick W. Taylor, Henry Fayol, and Max Weber. The classical theory comprises of the scientific management, administrative management and bureaucracy theories.

The Scientific Management Theory

Scientific management is a management theory that analyzes work flows to improve economic efficiency especially labour productivity. It is also called Taylorism. This classical approach to the scientific management movement was developed by Fredrick Winslow Taylor (1856-1915) who is referred to as its father. He was born in the United States of America in 1856 and studied in France, Germany and Italy. He was the Chief Industrial Engineer at the Midvale Steel Company between 1879-1889. While there, he developed and disseminated new scientific management ideas referred to as the “principles of scientific management”. Scientific management in general, arose in the early 1900s out of a need to improve manufacturing productivity through more efficient use of physical and human resources. Factories were

experiencing problems in formulating proper work procedures, establishing job boundaries, and coordinating flow of materials.

Taylor was concerned with finding more efficient methods and procedures for coordination and control of work. These are:

- i) The development of true science for each person's work;
- ii) The scientific selection, training and developments of the workers;
- iii) Co-operation with the workers to ensure that work is carried out in the prescribed way; and
- iv) The division of unit and responsibility between management and the workers.

Basic Principles of Scientific Management

Taylor formulated specific principles of the scientific management theory. The following are the basic principles of scientific management as stipulated by Fredrick Taylor.

i. Time-study principle

This principle stipulated that all productive work effort must be measured by accurate and standard time established for all work done. It should be possible to tell, for instance, how much time is required to accomplish a certain task.

ii. Piece-rate principle

This implies that the salary or the wages must be proportional to the work done or the output. This is to say a fair day's pay for a fair day's work. This was aimed at stimulating effort and encouraging cooperation. The wage incentives were to be an integral part of each job. In this relation, a worker should be given the highest grade of work of which they are capable.

iii. *Division of labour (job specialization)*

This principle should be applied to the maximum because through repetition of the same work, speed and skill would be developed leading to high productivity. It also implied that duplication of effort should be avoided and workers saved from timewasting tasks such as fetching materials, transporting products and arranging tools. Each individual worker must work on limited objects (or a specific job) so that s/he will know the job well and become a specialist in it. Each employee should be supervised by several foremen, each with distinct responsibilities, such as one for machine speed, another one for repair, and another one for discipline in an arrangement called functional foremanship.

iv. *Separation of planning from performance principle*

This implies that managers have the ultimate authority and decisions. That is, planning should be done by the management while the workers should perform their specific tasks. It refers to the management taking over from workers, the responsibility of planning work as well as for making the performance physically possible. Another aspect of this principle is that everything in an organization should be done by plans which can range from daily to yearly plans. Moreover, planning and scheduling should serve to put people and materials at the right place, right time and ready to work, or in proper condition or use. Finally there should be clear division of management and operational responsibilities between the management and the workers respectively.

v. *Scientific methods of work Principle*

This principle implies that the management should take over from workers the decisions on methods of working, determine scientifically the most efficient methods and train the

workers accordingly. This principle emphasizes elimination of the rule of thumb approaches in deciding how each worker should do a job. It means that the management should use scientific methods rather than intuition and experience to determine work activities and ensure each motion and movement is the most efficient possible within the given time to accomplish a particular task.

vi. *Management control principle*

In this principle, the managers should be trained in the art of management so that they can select, train and develop the human resource (workers) effectively using scientific and systematic methods. The workers should be trained to do specific jobs.

vii. *High targets principle*

Workers should be given high targets so as to stretch them to the maximum capacity. The managers should specify the daily output based on a detailed job analysis that should be the most efficient way to do work.

viii. *Standard conditions principle*

This principle implies that work should be done under standard conditions using the most efficient working methods. In addition, the work environment should be carefully controlled to ensure that the environmental conditions are functionally conducive.

ix. *Discipline principle*

There is need to establish discipline whereby management sets the objectives and the workers cooperate in achieving them. He advocated for the achievement of cooperation of human beings rather than chaotic individualism.

x. *Maximum output principle*

He emphasized that work should always be for maximum output rather than restricted output.

In conclusion, Taylor was majorly concerned about efficiency of administrators and workers and the highest possible production of the organization. In order to be effective, the organization had to have efficient administrators and workers and that it had to be task-oriented. There must be a very high rate of production and hence the need to observe the foregoing scientific management principles.

Administrative Management Theory

This is the second theory under the classical management thought. Scientific management, with its emphasis on efficient production was quite limited in scope. Even though efficiency of production was important, of great importance too were issues related to **management** of the total organization. The management of organizations had become more complex than could be handled by Taylor's scientific management principles alone. From this situation, emerged Administrative Theory. One of the main proponents of this theory was Henri Fayol. Unlike Taylor who had a technician's background, Fayol had the background of a top-management executive (was born in a well to do French family). These different backgrounds are reflected in their perceptions. Unlike Taylor who had concentrated on the worker and studied him as an extension of factory machinery, Fayol focused on the manager. Fayol clearly separated the process of administration from other operations such as production. The different backgrounds of the two theorists are reflected in their perceptions as follows:

- i) Unlike Taylor who concentrated on the worker and studied him as an extension of the factory machinery, Fayol focused on the manager.
- ii) Fayol clearly separated the process of administration from other operations such as production. That is, he made a distinction between managerial and operational activities.
- iii) Fayol emphasized the common elements of the process of administration and is considered to be the father of modern management theory.

Fayol made the distinction between operations and managerial activities. Fayol emphasized the common functions of management that include Planning, Organizing, Commanding, Coordinating and Control.

1. *Planning or forecasting*: He defined this element as looking into the future and deciding what shall be done depending on occurrence of certain events.
2. *Organizing*: Fayol described organizing as the process of dividing work into units and allocating these units to people and departments, that is, establishing the structure of authority, responsibility and tasks.
3. *Commanding*: This is issuing of instructions to ensure that targets are met.
4. *Coordination*: Coordination refers to the unification of effort and ensures that all activities bind the organization together to achieve a common goal or purpose.
5. *Controlling*: This function entails setting targets, monitoring activity to ensure targets are met and taking remedial action to deal with divergence of actual from target performance. Put in simple terms, it is the evaluation of activities against stated goals and plans.

Qualities of a Manager

Fayol also identified qualities that managers should possess if they were to apply his “General Principles of Management” successfully. Among the qualities he examined were those related to:

- i. Physical and mental capabilities;
- ii. Moral standards; and
- iii. Educational background.

Administrative Management Principles

In his book entitled “General and Industrial Management,” Fayol presented fourteen principles in three (3) general categories namely:

- i) Administration principles- Eight (8);
- ii) Human relations principles-Five (5); and
- iii) Production efficiency principle-One (1).

Principles Emphasizing Administration

The following are the eight principles emphasizing administration.

1. *Authority*: Managers have the right to give orders and their subordinates are obligated to obey and assume responsibility. Authority is important, but responsibility must be recognized as the resultant of authority.
2. *Discipline*: Organizational members should respect regulations and statements of policy. Clarity and fairness promote this respect. In addition, employees should respect their superiors since these superiors have a right to be obeyed. Fayol proposed that good discipline could be achieved by presenting agreement rules to workers as clearly and as fairly as possible.
3. *Unity of Command*: Only one superior originates orders for any given employee or manager. Subordinates should be assured that only one individual can give them orders and this should be well communicated as clearly as possible.
4. *Unity of direction*: Each work group or department should operate under one plan and director. It implies that any related group of activities and/or objectives should have one leader or plan of action. Unity of direction complements unity of command.
5. *Centralization*: The appropriate degree of centralization or decentralization depends on the situation and includes such factors as the nature of the task and the ability of subordinates. Actions that tend to reduce the authority and responsibility of subordinates by placing more authority in the hands of the superior are considered as leading to greater degree of centralization of authority to make decisions. Those that increase responsibility and authority at lower levels result in a greater degree of decentralization of authority in making decisions. This principle deals with delegation and each organization is free to decide for either centralization or decentralization of power.
6. *Scalar Chain Principle*: This means the structuring of the line of command or the flow of authority from the highest rank to the lowest rank. Definite lines of authority make authority relationships and interactions clearer throughout the organization between successive levels of management. Moreover, it is necessary for employees in different sections to work directly with each other to attain speed of action. The chain of command should be short-circuited provided that concerned parties are informed. This chain (scalar chain) is also referred to as the chain of command.
7. *Remuneration Principle*: This principle emphasizes that financial compensation should be fair and acceptable to both employees and the company and should be based on productivity. It also stresses that payment of personnel should consider factors such as the cost of living, availability

of personnel and economic conditions. This principle also rests on the assumption that wages paid should be based on the concepts of equity and satisfaction to both the worker and the company. In payment of bonuses and profits sharing, for instance, the mode of payment should be suited for a particular situation.

8. Order Principle: This principle basically stresses that there should be a place for everyone and everything. The placement of people should be based on qualifications and be clearly chartered. In other words, in addition to the neat arrangement of physical materials, there should be a device showing the place of every person in the organization and the relationship of each to the other. It implies some kind of organizational chart.

Principles Emphasizing Human Relations

The following five management principles emphasize human relations.

1. *Subordination of individual interest to general interests:* The emphasis of this principle is for every worker or employee to be motivated enough to contribute to the system effectively. It is also a guiding principle that the interests of the society should come first, those of the organization should come second, while those of the small groups and the individual should come third. The implication of this principle is that in order of priority, the society, the organization (firm) and the small group or individual should occupy the first, second and third places respectively in rank order.

2. *Equity Principle:* The distribution of work should consider each worker's effort. There should be equal application of policies and practices to all groups and individuals. This also implies that managers should supervise the employees with kindness, fairness and justice.

3. *Stability of tenure of personnel:* This is also referred to as workforce stability. Each personnel or worker should be permanent on the job after his or her performance has been assessed and judged satisfactory. This means that by respecting seniority, managers should create a sense of security among workers/employees and retain the well trained ones. The production workers or employees must have a sense of tenurial security in order to learn their jobs so that they can perform them well. Salaries and other benefits should be given according to the length of service in the organization. Employees must also have a sense of psychological security that they are not under any threat of losing their job as long as they conform to its expectations.

4. *Initiative Principle*: Subordinates should be given an opportunity to express their ideas, views, opinions, and feelings and exercise judgment in their work. Management should encourage worker initiative. Some workers in some organizations are innovators and they take challenge to perform the task with new and additional activity through self-direction and self-motivation. The importance of this principle in the organization should be recognized by both administrators and employees. It also means that there should be enhanced workers' participation in the solution of problems. Hence, workers ideas and energies should be tapped in the solution of organization problems.

5. *Espirit de Corps*: Group or team spirit and cooperation are preferable to “divide and conquer” as principles for relating to employees. In other words, there should be harmony and unity among personnel in the organization. It emphasizes that in union there is strength and aims at unifying all the divergent groups and individuals. Essentially, there should be loyalty that unites members of a group expressed in team work spirit. managers should encourage harmony and general good feelings among employees in order to increase work productivity. Team spirit would, therefore, automatically lead to effective realization of organizational goals and objectives.

Principle Emphasizing Production Efficiency

Division of Work: This is the management principle that emphasizes production efficiency. As in scientific management, diluting jobs in management as well as hourly wage employment (work) produces efficiencies of specialization. Division of work or specialization has to do with the recognition that each individual may work more effectively and efficiently on a particular job, object or process. Proper division of work leads to increased efficiency resulting from not having to change from one task to another.

In consideration of the fact that his “General Principles of Management” were first published in 1916, Fayol portrayed penetrating insight into the nature of effective management. Moreover, his belief that the principles of management should be applied somewhat differently in different situations demonstrated his understanding of the complexity of management.

Bureaucracy

The Concept of Bureaucracy

This is the last theory in the classical management thought. In this section, we shall focus on the characteristics of a bureaucratic organization as well as its advantages and disadvantages. During Taylor and Fayol's time, the western society was becoming increasingly organizational. Giant industrial organizations emerged in the 1900s, engendering a similar growth in other organizational aspects of life. The simple pre-industrial era social and political structures began to look inadequate in the industrialized society. A lot of social, political and economic friction resulted as evidenced in the increasing sense of conflict between individuals and organizations. There was a lot of labour unrest, revolutions and a rise in communism. It was against this background that **Max Weber**, a German sociologist produced some useful, durable and brilliant work on administrative system, the **bureaucracy** which has seemed indispensable since then. Weber had the idea that effectiveness could be achieved by emphasis on efficiency, stability and control.

Bureaucratic Characteristics/Principles

In an ideal bureaucracy, he envisioned characteristics that, in a sense, are principles of administration such as specialization (division of labour), a well-defined hierarchy of authority, a system of rules covering rights and duties of employees, a system of procedures for dealing with work situations, impersonality in interpersonal relations and selection and promotion based on technical competence.

The following is a description of these characteristics/principles.

- 1. Hierarchy of authority:* This arrangement applies to the organization of offices and positions. The authority is distributed in a pyramidal configuration leading to a span of control. Thus, each official is responsible for his or her subordinates' actions and decisions.
- 2. Division of labour (specialization):* There is an implied clear-cut division of labour and a high level of specialization. This principle ensures that tasks (duties) are divided into specialty areas and individual employees are assigned tasks according to their training, skills and experience. Workers should be trained to perform specific tasks according to their areas of specialization. They should perform the jobs where their productivity is likely to be high as a result of consistent performance of the same job.

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3. *Standard procedures for dealing with work situations.* The standard operating procedures are the clear, written instructions for each specialized job at every level of the hierarchy. Workers who follow them can be sure that they are on the same page as their colleagues and are doing their jobs properly.

4. *Rules and regulations:* There is a system of rules and regulations that cover the rights and duties of all the employees. These are well written, standardized and defined rules and regulations in the organization which guide the official activities of the workers. This implies that official decisions and actions must be directed by codified or written rules to ensure uniformity.

5. *Impersonality in interpersonal relations:* This also implies impartiality in work relationships. An impersonal orientation is expected from officials in their dealings with clients and other officials. Members of the organization must be subjected to strict and systematic discipline and this will eliminate personal, emotional and irrational elements among them. This is designed to result in objective and rational judgments by officials in the performance of their duties.

6. *Selection, employment and promotion based on technical competence:* This means that employment by the organization is based on technical qualifications and constitutes a lifelong career for the officials. This principle deals with the terms of services as follows:

- a. Employment is based on expertise or specialization;
- b. Promotion is given according to seniority and/or merit;
- c. Salary is pegged on rank in the hierarchy;
- d. Individual employees are free to resign; and
- e. There is a provision for retirement.

In ideal bureaucratic organizations, goals are determined by those legally empowered to do so, and the means for achieving these goals are specified and codified. They are passed down a hierarchy of competent personnel who ensure impersonal application of rules. An ideal bureaucracy is viewed as fool proof. This implies that if everyone went by the book, nothing would go wrong. In an ideal bureaucracy, anonymity exists, that is, the rights, duties, power and authority are not attached to individuals but to the office. Hence, when an individual vacates an official position, s/he ceases to wield the authority and power associated with that office.

Criticism of Weber's Bureaucratic Model

The danger of bureaucratic model is its suppression of initiative and decision making in middle and lower ranks due to over-reliance on formal controls and impersonality. The following are the drawbacks of the bureaucratic model.

1. *Dominance of authority*: Authority in bureaucracies is so ingrained, dominant and strong that many managers are unwilling to give up some of the authority when the situation warrants. Managers also attempt to acquire as much status, authority and power as possible which is commonly referred to as empire building. Weber's bureaucratic theory therefore discourages delegation of authority and decision making or any form of decentralization of authority in a particular hierarchical office. Authority is centralized on one office bearer.

2. *Inflexibility*: The bureaucratic insistence on "one best way" can be rigid even in the face of the rapidly changing internal and external environments. It is impossible to evade the much needed change in response to the fast fluctuating social, economic, political and technological environments. It is especially imperative to embrace technology currently given the prevailing epidemiological realities and inevitable climatic and environmental doldrums. Strict adherence to bureaucratic principles would discourage such important change.

3. *Excessive Red Tape*: Rules, regulations and procedures provide a rigid and limited strategy for achieving coordination. In some cases, other flexible strategies of enhancing goal achievement may be required. It is unfortunate that bureaucracy advocates for addition of more rules to cover all contingencies which results in too much red tape. Once established in a bureaucracy, it is significantly hard to eliminate ineffective rules, regulations and procedures leading to confusion and frustration. A leader should try to minimize the effect of the red tape if the goals and objectives of the organization are to be realized.

Human Relations Theory

Human Relations constituted the second major approach to administration. Human Relations movement replaced focus on structure of the organization with an emphasis on employee motivation and job satisfaction. It recognized the human factor in institutions. It was motivated by the increasing dissatisfaction with scientific management approach for treating employees as mechanistic element in the productive process. It made great effort therefore to focus on establishing the relationship between work environment and productivity. The classical approach

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was built on the premise that with efficiently designed jobs, the right incentives and proper use of managerial functions, productivity would increase. This formal, impersonal approach inevitably met with resistance from workers, hence the move towards a human relations approach, whose main contention was that man is a social animal with an affinity for group affiliation. Elton Mayo is considered the father of Human relations movement.

The critical implication of this theory is that wages are not the dominant motivator for workers but rather the interpersonal relationships within groups and their supervisor.

The Human Relations Theory has certain implications for school administration. The theory enables educational administrators to recognize the human factor in institutions. Employees/students have personal needs and talents. Recognition of individual potential not only motivates them, but also awakens them to use available resources to enhance their skills as individuals or groups.

Elton Mayo's Fundamental Principles as a Human Relations Theorist

The human relations movement according to Mayo had the following two major principles.

- i) Satisfaction: This principle stated that the organization with the most satisfied workers would be the most efficient.
- ii) Democracy: This principle stated that democracy must prevail in any organization through:
 - a) Employee participation in decision making;
 - b) Delegation of responsibilities to the workers by the administration;
 - c) Open channels of communication between employers and workers as well as among workers; and
 - d) Administration and workers could solve their differences democratically through conferences and cooperation.

According to Mayo, the attributes that proved more influential to behaviour than physical conditions were:

- a) Interpersonal relationships within groups;
- b) Relations between groups and their supervisors; and
- c) The fact that wages were not the dominant motivator for workers.

Summary of Fundamental Propositions of Human Relations Movement

The following is a summary of the fundamental propositions of the human relations theorists:

- a) Amount of work done by a person depends not much on strength or physical conditions of work, but rather on social conditions surrounding work;
- b) Non-economic rewards such as security and happiness can motivate workers more than wages;
- c) Division of labour (specialization) is not necessarily efficient. Variety especially where initiative and discretion are encouraged can stimulate interest to the point of increased productivity;
- d) Individuals perceive themselves as members of groups. Norms of behaviour emanate from standards set by groups to which workers belong not standards set by the managers;
- e) Work performance depends not just on the individual worker, but on the network of social relationships within the organization; and
- f) Managers should be sensitive to people and strive to develop human relations or social skills for working with employees.

For more on his ideas, click on video and material provided in the e-tivity.

Behavioral Science Movement

The last category of theory that we shall discuss is the behavioral theory. This theory focuses on management supporting the behaviors that foster productivity among the employees. Behavioral science theory was developed from human relations studies. It saw the Human Relations Movement as representing an incomplete view of human behavior in work situations. The Behaviorists argued that behavior of people in organization cannot be explained by human interactions alone, but also by other factors such as organizational structure, job design, and technology and management style. The main proponents of this school of thought include Chester Barnard who played a pioneering role, Abraham Maslow, Fredrick Herzberg and MacGregor.

Behavioral science movement views worker's motivation in terms of such factors as work itself, the nature of incentive system, interpersonal relations, management style, worker's needs, values and work environment. The movement therefore attempted to provide an integrated approach to management through relating it to disciplines such as anthropology, sociology and psychology.

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Barnard (1938/1940) summarizes the three basic elements of the organization as:

- a) System of cooperation;
- b) Common purpose; and
- c) Emphasis on efficiency and effectiveness

Practical Implications of Behavioral Sciences Movement

The following are the effects of the behavioral (social) science movement:

- a) It sees managers or leaders as emerging from different disciplines and not necessarily from educational institutions.
- b) It reveals that today, those who train as educational administrators are also expected to have some knowledge of social sciences such as psychology, sociology, economics and government.

The work of other behavioral theorists such as Maslow, Herzberg and McGregor are covered in the chapter on motivation in depth.

For more details on this theory, watch the video and read the material provided in the e-tivity.

THE ADMINISTRATIVE PROCESSES

The Concept of Administrative Processes

In the early 20th century, Fayol identified the administrative processes as being (POCCC i.e. planning, organizing, commanding, coordination and controlling). Since then, numerous other variations of the elements have been suggested. The better known of these variations is that of Gullick and Urwick(1935). Gullick's taxonomy, is better known or memorized in educational administration as POSDCoRB which is an abbreviation coined from the first letter of each word in the list, that is, P for planning, O for organizing, S for staffing, D for directing, Co for coordinating, R for reporting and B for budgeting. In this lesson, the processes of administration are discussed separately but it is important to note that they are not a series of discrete processes but are performed simultaneously in school situations.

The Planning Process

Planning is considered the most important function of all the other functions of the administrative process because it sets the pattern for other activities that follow. Planning process involves the setting up of business objectives and allocation of resources for achieving them. It also determines the future course of action for utilizing various resources in the best possible way. According to Fayol, planning is looking into the future and deciding what shall be done depending on the occurrence of certain events. According to Gullick, planning is the working out of the things that need to be done and the methods for doing them to accomplish organization's objectives.

The planning process involves the following steps; recognizing need for action, gathering of the necessary information, laying down objectives, determining planning premises, examining alternative course of action, evaluation of action patterns, determining secondary plans, implementation of plan and follow up/feedback.

Planning is important because of the following because it enables the school to achieve the set objectives, leads to allocation of finances for activities, enables school to choose the best course of action, determines which items or activities are of priority in the school, enables school to

determine the quality and quantity of its services, enable activities to be performed effectively and efficiently.

The Process of Organizing

Organizing can be described as the process of dividing work into units and allocating these to people and departments. Gullick defines organizing as the establishment of the formal structure of authority through which work subdivisions are arranged, defined and coordinated for the defined objective. Organizing also involves laying out the program of the school and assigning responsibilities and functions to members of staff. Hence, organizing may be seen as establishing order, function and design.

The steps of organizing include; establishing objectives, identifying and classifying work activities, grouping of activities into departments or work units (departmentation), collecting human and material resources, assigning work, responsibility and authority, monitoring the effectiveness of the plan etc.

Organizing is important because it ensures that, set objectives are achieved, work is organized effectively and efficiently under a particular unit or department, roles of each person in the organization are identified, resources (human, physical, finances) are used prudently, quality and quantity of services is provided, school resources are not wasted etc.

The process of Staffing

Staffing refers to hiring and training members of staff. Staffing also results into maintenance of favorable working conditions, e.g. provision of good wages, good health facilities and provision of good housing etc. Staffing may also be defined as the filling of the positions in the organization structure with the most suitable and capable personnel. Staffing also involves identifying work force requirements, keeping an inventory of the people available, recruiting, selecting, placing, promoting, planning their career, compensating and training (i.e. staff development). In Kenya, the Teachers' Service Commission is responsible for much of this role.

The process of organizing includes the following steps; estimating manpower requirements, recruitment, selection, placement and orientation, training and development, performance appraisal, promotion, compensation and separation.

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Staffing is important because it ensures that; the required number of personnel are hired, staff are trained and this means they are able to keep up with the latest developments in their work, favorable working conditions are maintained e.g. a good salary, a good health plan, teaching resources are provided, the most capable and skilled staff are selected, the institution or employing body is able to keep an inventory of workers etc.

The Process of Directing

Directing is sometimes referred to as commanding or stimulating. Directing is the continued supervision of workers and their work, making decisions and leading the enterprise (e.g. the head of department supervises the other teachers work to ensure they are working as expected such as using schemes of work and lesson plans to teach their lessons). Thus directing means guiding, instructing, motivating, influencing and overseeing employees work. The essential function of directing is to get employees to perform their work in order to achieve the goals.

The process of directing is guided by the following principles; harmony of objectives, maximum individual contribution, unity of command, direct supervision, motivation, effective leadership, unity of direction, effective leadership, group dynamites and comprehension.

Directing is important because it ensures that, set objectives are achieved, employees work is supervised so that if it is not up to standard, remedial or corrective action can be taken, employees cope with rather than resist change, the manager motivates subordinates by providing incentives or compensation in monetary or non-monetary terms, stability and balance in the organization are provided by the manager exercising persuasive leadership, effective communication, strict supervision and efficient motivation, resources such as human resources, equipment, finances are utilized in an efficient manner.

The Process of Coordinating

Coordinating is interrelating the parts of the total enterprise into a harmonious whole and avoiding conflict and duplications, which interfere with the entire enterprise e.g. teachers at the different levels of the school, coordinate to ensure smooth transition from one class to the next. Hence, coordination assists individual staff members to work together in a team relationship. An

often used way of coordination is having one person responsible for knowing what all others in the group are doing, so that he/she relates activities of each person to that of others.

The steps that ensure that there is effective coordination in the organization include, proper delegation of authority and responsibility at all levels of management, the entire activities of the organization are divided into departments or sections, rigid rules and regulations, procedures, policies, etc. are adhered to, there is establishment of an effective communication system, there is a proper system for reporting etc.

The coordinating process is important because it ensures that, activities of various personnel in the school are harmonized, there is teamwork toward realization of educational objectives, conflicts are eliminated, teaching is interdependent, it is the responsibility of the administrator to co-ordinate the activities of various teachers e.g. S/he needs to coordinate the activities of the various teachers teaching different subjects to one class etc.

The Process of Reporting

Reporting entails keeping all members of staff informed of what goes on so that they may be able to perform their part or role in a harmonious and coordinated way. Reporting involves keeping the subordinates and their superiors informed through records, research, inspection and memos. The head teacher is also responsible to educational authorities and society for whatever is done at the institution. Hence, it is important that records are kept and reports sent to concerned parties e.g. financial management records are provided to educational authorities, BOM and parents for their inspection.

The best practices in a management report include, setting the strategic goals and objectives, choosing the right KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) for your audience for different positions have different needs, taking customer feedback into consideration e.g. in a school situation, parents are very important, ensuring that the report is written in a way that everyone understands, making the report visually pleasing, using online dashboard tools rather than paper-based reports, ensuring records are clear , Keep on improving by regularly testing your reports.

The reporting process is important as it enables the management to, achieve set objectives, provide important information to stakeholders, ensure that all staff members perform their work

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in a harmonious and coordinated way, remove suspicion and animosity towards the school's management by keeping the schools community and stakeholders informed, give clear instructions and guidelines to members of staff, improve internal communication within the school, inspire and motivate staff and individual pupils e.g. good examination reports makes them to work even harder in order to perform better.

The Process of Budgeting

A budget is a carefully outlined plan of how the desired activities of a school will be financed. In other words, a budget is an educational programme which is expressed in financial terms. A budget for an educational organization has an educational plan with an estimate of the amount of money to be received (receipts) e.g. from fees or from an income generating project and the amount of money to be spent (expenditures) e.g. money for purchasing textbooks in order to achieve the educational objectives. It is made for a given period of time, usually one year. Hence a well formulated school budget consists of an educational plan, expenditure plan and revenue plan.

The steps of the budgeting process include, setting objectives, determining available resources, projecting future needs, matching future needs to available resources, obtaining final approval e.g. from Board of Management in a school, distributing the approved funds to the various departments and vote heads, monitoring and evaluating the budget e.g. petrol prices may increase and this means adjusting the budget.

The process of budgeting is important because it enables the management to have an accurate forecast of the expected income and expenditures during a definite period of time, ensure there is an equitable allocation of financial resources in all the services required, a basis of accounting e.g. makes it possible to ascertain whether funds have been spent effectively, quality and quantity of services e.g. buy the right quality and quantity of food for students in a boarding school, a plan for attaining the purposes of an institution, obtain approval from authorized bodies e.g. BOM to acquire and spend the monies as written in the budget, manage the institution in an economical manner etc.

ADMINISTRATIVE TASK AREAS

Administrative Task Areas

The tasks of the head teacher in schools can be subdivided into six broad administrative task areas namely:

- Curriculum and instruction.
- Staff personnel.
- Pupil personnel.
- Physical facilities.
- Public relations.
- Financial resources.

1) Curriculum and Instruction

The principal is the instructional leader in his/her school. The curriculum and instruction tasks he/she oversees includes supervising teachers' lessons, schemes of work, lesson plans, records of work, assigning classes to teachers, ensuring that the timetable is prepared and adhered to, ensuring that teaching and learning resources are provided, ensuring remedial classes are conducted, checking whether pupils books are marked , ensuring continuous assessment tests and end of term examinations are set, marked and report cards are written, providing co-curricular activities to pupils etc.

2) Staff Personnel

The administrative tasks performed by principals include, ensures his/her school is adequately staffed, ensures that in-service training is provided to staff , orientates new staff members to the school and its environment, assigns duties to teachers and support staff, ensures that teachers and support staff employed by BOM are remunerated, recommends teachers and support staff for promotion, institutes staff disciplinary action by giving verbal and written warnings to staff, informs management of the need to recruit non-teaching staff, ensures teachers and support staff

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welfare is taken care of , motivates and provides incentives to staff, deals with matters relating unionizable staff such as those belonging to e.g. KNUT, KUPPET etc.

3) Pupil Personnel

The principal is also in charge of pupil personnel administration in the following ways; admits and orientates new students, ensures that examinations and continuous assessment Tests (CATs) are administered, ensures that students welfare is taken care of e.g. health, food, deals with pupils' serious disciplinary issues, ensures guidance and counseling services are provided, ensures that pupils with learning difficulties are provided with remedial classes, ensures that gifted pupils are provided with opportunities to actualize their potentialities etc.

4) Physical Facilities

Physical facilities in a school include classes, offices, houses, dormitories, libraries, health clinics, dining halls, social halls, vehicles, playing fields, flower beds, sewerage systems etc. The principal ensures that they are provided in the school, construction of school buildings is guided by construction of building laws and regulations, safety and health standards are adhered to in school buildings, school documents e.g. title deeds, examination certificates, leaving certificates, school receipts etc are kept safely, school buildings and land/compound is well planned, that maintenance and repairs (e.g. for fences, roofs, gutters, drainage walls, overgrown trees, vehicles) is carried out, that the library, classes and dormitories are spacious and adequately furnished etc.

5) Public Relations/ School-Community Relations

Public relations are about creating a good relationship between the public and the school. In this task area, the head teacher ensures that school members participate in community affairs, requests community members to participate and contribute to school occasions and projects, ensures that parents and guardians are involved in the learning activities and discipline matters of their children, requests community members to provide security to school, employs community members in the school, allows community members to use school facilities etc.

6) Financial Resources

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The financial related tasks that are carried out by principals of schools include, collecting school funds e.g. from fees, income generating activities, electricity and water payment etc., ensures that a budget document is well drawn and that this is done by all stakeholders, ensures that budget is approved by Board of Management (BOM), obtains authority to incur expenditure (A.I.E.) from BOM, ensures that there is a tender awarding committee in accordance with government rules, ensures that goods supplied to school are of high quality and are of the right quantity that was paid for, authorizes school expenditure and payments, ensures that accounting is properly done, ensures that accounting books are internally and externally audited etc.

Challenges Experienced by Head Teachers in the Process of Executing Tasks in the Six Administrative Task Areas

In as far as curriculum and instruction is concerned, some of the challenges experienced by principals include, lack of finances to buy teaching and learning materials, late disbursement of government grants to schools, lack teachers to teach some subjects, poor examination performance by the pupils, overloading teachers with lessons to teach, some teachers may fail to plan for their lessons by e.g. not writing schemes of work and lesson plans, some teachers fail to prepare, mark and write examination reports, some teachers resent head teacher's supervision of their work etc.

Challenges in staff administration include, lack of finances to provide in-service training of staff and to pay wages to BOM staff, lack of teachers for some subjects resulting in overloading available teachers with work, some teachers are not committed to their work or are unable to work due to poor health, some staff members blame head teachers when they fail to get promoted, some staff members are dishonest e.g. the accounting clerks maybe embezzling school money, teacher unions may interfere with staff disciplinary action taken by the school etc.

Challenges experienced by principals in pupil personnel administration include, high enrolment of pupils resulting in an inadequate learning facilities and materials, congested hostels (in case of boarding schools) resulting in health problems, some pupils have disciplinary problems e.g. taking of drugs and alcohol, some pupils plan strikes in the school, lack of guidance and counselling services, lack of opportunities for gifted pupils to actualize their potentialities etc.

Challenges in physical facilities administration include, lack of finances to build and repair physical facilities, inadequate physical facilities e.g. classes, staff houses, dormitories etc, failure by contractors to follow building laws and regulations, some old school buildings may have ignored safety and health standards, some school documents such as title deeds, examination certificates and leaving certificates being misplaced, lack of school land for school expansion etc.

Challenges in public relations/school-community relations include, parents not paying school fees on time, school community may not be willing to participate or contribute to school projects e.g. fund raising projects, principal may not involve school in community affairs, uncooperative parents and guardians e.g. in learning activities or discipline matters, community members may vandalize, misuse or steal school property, some community members may be selling drugs or alcohol to students, school suppliers from the community may fail to supply goods to school or may supply poor quality goods or foodstuffs to the school, some community members may grab school land etc.

Challenges experienced by principals in financial resources administration include, parents and guardians may default on fees payment, delays in disbursement of government funds, dishonest or uncooperative accounting staff or BOM members, failure to keep proper accounting records, stakeholders may not be involved in the process of drawing the budget, some BOM members and politicians may want tenders for supplying goods and services to the school in a manner that is not transparent and accountable, head teacher or BOM may lack financial management skills e.g. auditing of school finances and this may lead to loss of school funds etc.

DEFINITIONS AND CONCEPT OF TEACHING PROFESSION

Definitions and concepts in teaching

Teacher

1. A person who has been trained as a teacher as provided for in law and registered as a teacher (code of conduct and ethics for teachers)
2. A person who helps students to acquire knowledge competency or virtue.
3. A person who teaches especially employed in a school (Wiktionary)
4. Someone whose job is to teach in a school or college. (Dictionary.com)
5. A person with accurate specific ability, intuition, education, experience skills, knowledge, and qualifications to teach a specific subject or number of subjects (Mary, 2020).

Teaching

1. A process whereby a teacher impacts skills, attitudes and values to a learner or groups of learners in a way that respects the intellectual integrity and capacity of the learners with the aim of changing the behavior of the Learner (s). (Ababio, 2020).
2. That act of taking responsibility for finding the best way to transfer knowledge to another (quora.com).
3. The process of attending to people's needs, experiences and feelings and intervening so that the Learner can learn particular things and go beyond the given level of knowledge, skills and attitudes (Smith, 2018).

A school

1. An institution registered under this Act the basic education act, that meets the basic prescribed standards, and includes institutions offering alternative approaches of multi-

grade, double-shift, mobile schooling, out of school programmes, adult and continuing education, distance or correspondence instruction, or accelerated learning and talent based institutions. (Basic Education Act, 2013)

2. An educational institution designed to provide learning spaces and learning environments for the teaching of students under the direction of teachers. ([Wikipedia](#)).
3. The peoples or stuff over school (Collins English dictionary).
4. A place where children learn enough worthwhile things to make a strong start in life, where a foundation is laid that supports learning, and where children develop the desire to learn more (Yatvin, 2012).

Skills of a good teacher

According to Momuae (2017) a good teacher should possess the following skills

- **Have good communication skills:** This helps to create a rapport and trust with their students. A teacher should be able to make learning understandable using verbal and nonverbal means.
- **Be a good listener.** This helps to further improve communication skills by understanding what each student requires. The teacher will be able to tailor the curriculum according to the learners' needs
- **Be friendly.** This enables the teacher to become more approachable. It also creates a positive learning environment. Being approachable creates trust between you and the students.
- **Be patient.** This is important because all students are unique and they have varying altitude of learning. Through patience, you'll be able to learn new tactics when engaging with students.
- **Good organizational skills.** This means the ability to meet expectations and deadlines. A teacher should also be able to prepare for the lesson beforehand.
- **Discipline skills.** A teacher should be able to maintain classroom discipline in order to promote learning.
- **Respect.** A teacher should not threaten abuse or tease a child. This can be damaging to the child's self-esteem and also your reputation as a teacher. Maintain respect with the

colleagues and school administration. Dress appropriately and avoid drinking alcohol during working hours.

Roles of a teacher

Resource specialist: S/he is the source of information for the students.

Support: S/he must provide support to the student as an advisor, leader, coach or a counselor.

Mentor: A teacher should model their behavior so as to provide a good example to his students.

Helping hand: A teacher should always be ready to accept extra tasks in the school.

Learner: The teacher should always be ready to learn something new in order to become a better person and teacher.

Teacher obligations

- Provide quality education. A teacher should be able to give high quality lessons, and give all students the opportunity to learn.
- Give supervision. They should supervise students in the same way as a caring parent would.
- Protect students' privacy. Teachers should keep any information they learn about their students' background confidential. The only legal exception is where a child is mistreated, neglected or abused.
- Respect students and observe boundaries. Teachers should avoid touching students unless there's a reason for doing so. They should avoid out of school personal relationships with the students. They should also avoid romantic relationships with their students.
- Limits of discipline. Whereas it is the duty of the teacher to maintain class discipline, spanking and other punishments are prohibited in Kenya.

What is a profession?

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1. A profession is an occupation founded upon specialized education training, the purpose of which is to supply disinterested objective counsel and service to others, for a direct and definite compensation, wholly apart from expectation of other business gain.
2. A job that needs special training or skill or a high level of education. For example, medical, legal and teaching profession (Quora.com).
3. A profession is a disciplined group of individuals who adhere to ethical standards (Professional standards councils).

The Concept of Professionalism

There are several definitions that have been provided for professionalism. Professionalism has been defined as follows:

- i) The conduct, aims or qualities that characterize or mark a profession or a professional person (Porcupile, 2015; Merriam Webster, 2020).
- ii) Professionalism is the conduct, behaviour and attitude of someone in a work or business environment (Virginia Tech, 2020).
- iii) Professionalism is the conduct of oneself during one's business affairs (Joseph, 2019).
- iv) Professionalism is the way one conducts himself/herself at work to represent oneself and his/her company in a professional way (Brooks, 2019).
- v) Professionalism is defined here as the qualities such as aims, conduct, behaviour, knowledge, skills, attitudes, opinions, and beliefs that characterize, identify or mark a profession or a professional person.

Major Milestones that Mark a Profession

The major milestones which may mark an occupation being identified as a profession include:

- i) An occupation becomes a full time occupation;
- ii) The establishment of a training school;
- iii) The establishment of a university school;
- iv) The establishment of a local association;

- v) The establishment of a national association of professional ethics; and
- vi) The establishment of state licensing law.

General Characteristics of a Profession

More comprehensive characteristics of a profession provided by Adprima (2020) include the following:

1. Professions are occupationally related social institutions established and maintained as a means of providing essential services to the individual and the society.
2. Each profession is concerned with an identified area of need or function, for instance, physical and emotional health maintenance, preservation of rights and freedoms and enhancing the opportunity to learn.
3. The profession collectively, and the professional individually, possesses a body of knowledge and a repertoire of behaviors and skills (professional culture) needed in the practice of the profession. Such knowledge, behavior and skills are not possessed by non-professionals.
4. Members of the profession are involved in decision making in the service of the client. These decisions are made in accordance with the most valid knowledge available, against a background of principles and theories, and within the context of possible impact on related conditions or decisions.
5. The profession is based on one or more under girding disciplines from which it builds its own applied knowledge and skills.
6. The profession is organized into one or more professional associations, which, within broad limits of social accountability, are granted autonomy in control of the actual work of the profession and the conditions that surround it. These conditions include admissions, educational standards, examination and licensing, career line, ethical and performance standards and professional discipline.

7. The profession has agreed upon performance standards for admission to the profession and for continuance within it.
8. Preparation for and induction into the profession is provided through a protracted preparation program, usually in a professional school on a college or university campus.
9. There is very high level of public trust and confidence in the profession and in individual practitioners, based upon the profession's demonstrated capacity to provide service markedly beyond that which would otherwise be available.
10. Individual practitioners are characterized by a strong service motivation and lifetime commitment to competence.
11. Authority to practice in any individual case derives from the client or the employing organization. Accountability for the competence of professional practice within the particular case is to the profession itself.
12. There is relative freedom from direct on the job supervision and from direct public evaluation of the individual practitioner. The professional accepts responsibility in the name of his or her profession and is accountable through his or her profession to the society.

The challenge for practicing teachers is to prove with an open, flexible and critical mind whether teaching exhibits the qualities of a profession.

Is teaching a profession?

Teaching is a profession because it has the following characteristics

1. Teachers earn their living from performing an activity that requires a certain education, skill or training. (oratefinanceinstitute.com)
2. A teacher must demonstrate a certain standard of education through a certificate or exam.
3. Teaching is guided by a code of ethics.
4. The teaching profession is guided by competence, integrity and morality.
5. A teacher must be accountable to those they serve and also to the society.

Professional Code of Ethics, Conduct and Values

Professional Code of Ethics

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The following are some definitions of professional codes of ethics:

- i) Professional ethics are principles that govern decisions and behavior of a person or a group in a working environment, for instance, an education institution (Betterteam, 2020).
- ii) A professional code of Ethics provides employees with a set of guidelines they can use to make good decisions in the workplace and allows setting of a baseline expectation for what is socially acceptable and how professionals should approach problems (Indeed Career Guide, 2020).
- iii) Professional ethics are principles that govern the behaviour of a person or a group in a business environment and provide rules on how a person should act towards other people and institutions in such an environment (Ministry of Business Innovation & Employment, 2014).
- iv) A code of ethics is a guide of principles designed to help professionals conduct business honestly and with integrity and outlines the mission and values of the business organization and how professionals are supposed to approach problems (Hayes & Drury, 2020).
- v) This text defines professional code of ethics as a mission and value based baseline and a set of guidelines and principles that govern and guide the actions, behavior and decisions of employees in their organizational decision making, interpersonal interactions and problem solution.

It is imperative to note that unlike values, professional ethics are often codified as a set of rules, which a particular group of people use. This implies that all those in a particular group, such as, public teachers will use the same professional ethics, even if their values may be unique to each individual.

Professional Code of Conduct

The following are some definitions of professional code of ethics:

- i) A code of conduct is a set of rules outlining the norms, regulations and responsibilities or proper practices of an individual, party or an organization (<https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki/>).

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- ii) A code of conduct states the rules, values, ethical principles and vision for one's business and provides one's staff with clear standards and expectations of how to do their job (Business Queensland, 2016).
- iii) A code of conduct is a list of statements that raise awareness of the standards of conduct and practices that are expected of the profession (Social Care Wales, 2017).
- iv) A code of conduct includes expectations and defines acceptable behaviours among employees (McKay, 2019).
- v) This text defines a code of conduct as an awareness document containing a list of statements of the rules, values, standards of behaviour, conduct and practices to be adhered to by members of a profession in their professional activities and engagements.

Professional Values

Professional values have attracted various definitions. The following are three of these definitions.

- i) Professional values are the guiding beliefs and principles that influence one's work behavior and are usually extensions of one's personal values such as honesty, generosity and helpfulness (Birmingham Community Healthcare, 2020).
- ii) Professional values are business-related beliefs or principles that guide professional behaviour and may reflect ethics, practices, standards and other norms within a commercial environment (Business Dictionary, 2020).
- iii) Professional values refers to professional image reflected in reliability, honesty, consistency, accountability, dress and acting appropriately to deliver work outcomes to agreed quality standards and timescales (Bradford University, 2020).
- iv) This text defines professional values as the guiding attitudes, beliefs and principles that influence the actions, behaviour and practices of professionals since they are an extension of an employee's personal values such as honesty, integrity, generosity, respect and trust among others.

Professional values include giving care, politeness, respect for others, honesty, integrity, trust, freedom, safety, knowledge, altruism, autonomy, human dignity and social justice. Nevertheless,

although some values are considered more important than others in certain professions, there are some universal values that should be, and usually are, held and practiced in all of them. These universal values are ‘first do no harm’ ‘keep it simple’ and ‘honesty is the best policy’.

Regulations That Guide the Teaching Profession in Kenya

Kenya teacher education and professional development (TEPD) program.

This is a USAID funded program for teacher trainees in Kenya that was intended to prepare them for challenges in the classroom.

Aims of the project

- 1.To develop a new competency program that will make teaching more sustainable, integrated and harmonized.
2. Enhance child centered learning.
3. Enable teachers to teach large and multi-grade classes.
4. Provide teaching and learning resources.

Code of regulations for teachers (2015)

Also known as the TSC code of regulations for teachers (2015). This is a law governing the teachers conduct under the teachers Service Commission act. It contains the following.

1. The functions, roles and responsibilities of their teachers Service Commission.
2. Laws governing the registration of teachers.
3. Development, review and maintenance of entry and performance standards.
4. Conditions for recruitment, appointment and employment of teachers.
5. Promotion of teachers
6. Salaries increments and allowances of teachers.
7. Medical benefits for teachers
8. Types of leaves available for teachers.

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9. Disciplinary guidelines.

10. Exit from the teaching service.

11. Pensions gratuities and benefits.

Below are some of the disciplinary guidelines contained in this document.

Offenses

- Immoral behavior such as sexual intercourse, sexual harassment or flirtation.
- Professional misconduct such as negligence of duty, lateness, chronic absenteeism, desertion, incitement and insubordination.
- Infamous conduct which includes drunkenness and fighting.
- Forgery.
- Embezzlement.

Penalties

- Interdiction.
- A warning letter.
- Dismissal.
- Surcharging the teacher.
- Suspension for six months
- Retiring in public interest.
- Removal from the register.

Teachers code of conduct and ethics (2015)

This is a legal document under the public officer ethics act of 2003. It spells out ethical standards for teachers and employees of the teachers Service Commission.

It contains details of how teachers should conduct themselves as public officers, so as to maintain the dignity, integrity, and nobility of the teaching profession. It also outlines the responsibility of teachers to their standards and guidelines on behaviors of teachers in the classroom, to parents and their co-workers.

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Below is a summary of expected teachers conduct as outlined in this document.

- Maintain a neat and decent standard of dressing.
- Observe official working hours, be punctual, and meet deadlines.
- Not absent themselves from duty without proper authorization or a valid reason.
- Maintain professional records.
- Provide fast, friendly and efficient service and be courteous to all.
- Avoid being in a position in which personal interests conflict with duties as a teacher.
- Not to participate in tenders which conflict with their personal interest.
- Keep confidential information and documents entrusted to them.
- Maintain political neutrality. A teacher should not publicly support a candidate in an election.
- Surrender all public or institutional properties when vacating an office or leaving a station.
- A teacher should not contest in an election while in office. Those who wish to do so must retire or resign at least six months before the election date.
- A teacher should ensure fair conduct of both internal and external exams without cheating. He or she should evaluate learners honestly.
- A teacher should avoid flirting with learners, making sexual requests, or performing sexual intercourse with them.
- A teacher should not send a learner to their personal residence for any reason.
- One should not cover up cases of sexual abuse against a learner.
- A student should not be released from school for any reason without informing the parent.
- A child should not be released from school earlier than 6:00 AM or later than 12:00 PM unless it is an emergency.
- A teacher should not engage in holiday tuition.
- One should not involve in a prescribed group or Association e.g., mungiki.

Benefits of Codes of Conduct

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The code of conduct for employees benefits the professional individual and the professional organization in several ways. The following are some of these benefits:

1. The code of conduct for employees guides them on how they should behave at the work place, strengthens their value system, ensures their career growth and benefits the organization in the long run.
2. The codes of conduct for professionals benefit the public as they build confidence in professional trustworthiness
3. The professional codes of conduct benefit clients as they provide greater transparency and certainty about how their affairs will be handled
4. Professional codes of conduct benefit members of the profession as they provide a supporting framework for resisting pressure to act inappropriately and for making acceptable decisions in what may be 'grey areas'.
5. Professional codes of conduct benefit the profession as a whole as they provide a common understanding of acceptable practice which builds collegiality and allows for fairer disciplinary procedures.
6. Professional codes of conduct benefit others dealing with the profession as the profession will be seen as more reliable and easier to deal with.

Basic Education Act, 2013

This is constitutional document that governs the running of institutions of basic education. Basic education Includes preprimary, primary and secondary schools. It also includes teacher and vocational colleges and adult basic education.

The document Outlines roles of education boards at the national, county and school level. It also outlines roles of the county government and sponsors in the running of schools. In addition, it provides guidelines on running of private schools and special needs schools.

Highlights of the basic Education Act include;

- The right of every child to free a compulsory basic education.

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- Promotion of peace, integration, coexistence and tolerance within the institutions.
- Elimination of corporal punishment and any cruel and inhuman treatment of the child.
- Protection of marginalized persons and those with disabilities.
- Transparency and cost-effective use of resources.

Professional Development

Professional development is learning to earn or maintain professional credentials such as academic degrees to formal coursework, attending conferences and informal learning opportunities situated in practice (Wikipedia). It is earning professional credentials and keeping oneself professionally updated.

Professional Learning Activities

There are a number of professional learning activities that can contribute to teachers' and school administrators' professional growth and development. Previously, professional development focused on individual development, workshops, in-service and external delivery systems. Currently, the stress is on school-based activities such as coaching, partnerships and team group development. The following are some professional learning and development activities.

1. Action Research

Professional development becomes more meaningful and effective when teachers become active in their professional learning (Archibald et al., 2011). This occurs when teachers connect education best practices to classroom application (Garet et al., 2001). In undertaking action research, educators begin by asking how current practice might be improved. Teachers, for instance, might teach a concept in different ways to determine the technique which has the greatest effect on student learning.

2. Book Study /Book Study Groups

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Over the past decades, a number of researchers have attempted to describe the reading habits of teachers. Book study groups can be effective form of professional development that educators at all levels can use to facilitate their professional growth.

3. Classroom and School Visitation

Learning walks also referred to as data walks, walk throughs, learning visits, or targeted learning walks can be defined as ongoing, structured classroom visits by senior staff members and other colleagues, which gather data primarily through observation and interaction with students. Applied in areas of education such as classroom teaching, learning walks are not intended for summative performance measurement. Rather, they are designed to support professional learning. They are also intended to encourage collegial conversations. Teachers visit the classrooms of colleagues to observe innovative teaching practices and expand and refine their own personal pedagogy.

4. Collaborative Curriculum Development (CCD)

Collaborative Curriculum Development (CCD) provides a unique chance for school teachers to delve deeply into their subject matter. By working cooperatively, teachers can design new planning materials, teaching methods, resource materials and assessment tools..

5. Conference Audio/Video Tapes

Conference audio tapes provide teachers who are unable to attend a county, national or international conferences with an opportunity to learn new ideas from experts. It has been claimed that recording obtains the fullest account of taught lessons to develop the teacher's self-reflective competence. An analysis of relevant literature reveals that audio and video recordings can support teachers' development and practice of reflection in practical ways and through deepening reflection, promoting critical reflection and facilitating constructive dialogue with others. Moreover, audio and video recording can be a time saving measure for teachers who find it easier to record their reflections than to write them.

6. Conferences and Workshops

Conferences can offer very effective professional development opportunities particularly when they are part of teachers' ongoing professional development plan. Continuous professional development may take various forms and can be in the form of face-to- face programmes or distance learning programmes, can be informal in the form of lectures, workshops, seminars, and

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conferences as well as through formal options, such as, certified training programmes or other qualifying course.

7. Community or Service Organizations

Community or service organizations provide an opportunity for teachers and school managers to develop leadership skills and gain vital knowledge related to their role and community context. Undertaking community service benefits student teachers personally, academically and professionally. They suggest that community service learning can be readily reconceptualized as a transition strategy for first year in teacher education. Some examples of community/service organizations include the church, service clubs, scouts, Girl Guides and sporting groups.

8. Curriculum Mapping

Curriculum maps are tools to organize teaching or instruction which outline a sequence for delivering content and provide a clear scope for what must be taught to all students as specified in the national curriculum. Curriculum mapping is a way of constructing the route and enabling teachers to develop the knowledge and skills to navigate the travel. It is a method by which teachers thoroughly analyze the standards within their curriculum and understand how the curriculum can be taught and mastered across the school year

9. Data Analysis

It has been observed that when teachers become aware of specific student data directly related to their approach of teaching, it could inform them about possible strengths, weaknesses or challenges (Dam, Janssen & Driel, 2018). Educators utilize data or information to inform their professional practice, that is, to make decisions about what to teach, how to teach it and how to determine whether students have learnt what was taught. Unfortunately, teachers generally have little time at their disposal and encounter significant problems in the interpretation and use of data for change.

10. Examining Student Work

The work of students constitutes teachers' critical sources of information about how a student is learning, developing, acquiring new knowledge and applying new skill sets. Student work includes such items as writing samples, projects, oral reports and pictures. Thinking analytically and critically about the students' work can give teachers greater insights into teaching and learning.

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11. Education Exchange
12. Peer- Coaching
13. Online Professional Development Programs
14. Communication Networks and Strategies
15. Focused Conversations
16. Hosting a Student Teacher
17. Integrated Curriculum Planning: Team teaching across subjects
18. Internet Research
19. Journaling
20. Professional Books and Journals
21. Mentoring and Mentorship
22. Leadership Development Programs
23. Lesson Study: Study lesson of colleague teacher and identify areas of improvement.
24. Professional Development Schools: Collaborate with university
24. Professional Organizations: KNUT and KEWOTA provide publications or dvt programs.
25. School Professional Development Workshops: For educational staff and managers.

Professional Learning Opportunities

Professional Learning

Teachers engage in professional learning to stimulate their thinking and professional knowledge and to ensure that their practice is critically informed and current. During instances when a wide range of high quality, sustained professional learning experiences are undertaken, teachers are more likely to inspire students and provide high quality teaching and learning experiences, enabling learners to achieve their best. It is important that professional learning provides rich opportunities for teachers to develop and enhance their professional knowledge, attitude and practice in order to progress pedagogical quality and school improvement.

Professional Learning Opportunities

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Teachers should utilize each and every opportunity at their disposal to enhance their professional knowledge, skills and attitudes during their day to day life. This is due to the fact that the manner in which a teacher conducts his/her teaching responsibilities is predicted by the union of personality traits and acquired knowledge. The following are some of the formal professional learning and informal professional learning opportunities:

- 1) Coaching (learning through people);
- 2) Challenging assignments (learning on-the-job); self-study(self-directed learning);
- 3) Job rotation/ or secondments (learning on-the-job);
- 4) Community involvement (self-directed learning);
- 5) Special projects (learning on-the-job and self- directed learning);
- 6) Research projects (learning on-the-job and self-directed learning);
- 7) Task force or committees (learning on-the-job and self- directed learning).
- 8) Guest speaker series (self-directed learning);
- 9) Professional forums (learning through people and self-directed learning).
- 10) Internet workshop training (learning through training and learning on-the job);
- 11) Action learning (Learning through people and self-directed learning).
- 12) Experiential, action or enquiry-based learning;
- 13) Professional dialogue with colleagues, other professionals, parents and learners; and
- 14) Focused professional reading and research.

Performance Appraisal

Performance appraisal has attracted various definitions from several authors, scholars and researchers. The following are some of those definitions.

- i. Performance appraisal is a systematic evaluation of the individual with respect to his/her performance on the job and his/her potential for development (Beach, 1965).
- ii. Performance appraisal is a regular review of an employee's job performance and overall contribution to the company (Silver, 2020).
- iii. Performance appraisal is a systematic review of employee's meaningful job behaviour in respect to their effectiveness in meeting their job requirements and responsibilities (Douglas et al., 1985).

Types of Performance Appraisal

Most performance appraisal is top-down, meaning that supervisors evaluate their staff with no input from the supervisee (subject). However, other types of performance appraisals exist. The following are some of these types of performance appraisals.

1. Self -assessment: Individuals rate their job performance and behavior.
2. Peer assessment: An individual's work group rates his/her performance.
3. Three Hundred and Sixty (360) Degree Feedback Assessment: This kind of appraisal includes input from an individual, supervisors and peers. It is also called multisource performance appraisal.
4. Negotiated Appraisal: This is a newer trend that utilizes mediator and attempts to moderate the adversarial nature of performance evaluations by allowing the appraised to present first. It also focuses on what the individual is doing right before any criticism is given. This structure tends to be useful during conflicts between subordinates and supervisors.

Objectives of Performance Appraisal

The following are the objectives of performance appraisal as summed up by Management Study Guide (2020) and Medhi (2020):

1. Performance appraisal facilitates goal setting which is integral to systemic evaluation;
2. Performance appraisal provides frequent feedback for increased job performance;
3. Performance appraisal simplifies promotion awarding decisions and review and retention of the promotional and other training programs.
4. Performance appraisal encourages quality and quantity work performance;
5. Performance appraisal allows identification of poor performing employees appropriate counsel;
6. Performance appraisal allows determination of training and development needs;
7. Performance appraisal assists in creating a plan to improve employee performance; and
8. Performance appraisal enhances suitable employee recognition.
9. To maintain records in order to determine compensation packages, wage structure, salaries raises and so on.

10. To identify the strengths and weaknesses of employees to place the right workers on the right job;
11. To assess and maintain the talents in a person for further growth and development; and
12. It serves as a basis for influencing working habits of the employees.

Objectives of Performance Management Systems

The objectives of performance management system as stated in Medhi (2020) include:

1. Setting the right expectations for managers and employees;
2. Effective communication between individuals and teams;
3. Setting performance standards; and
4. Determining individual training and performance plans.

Basic Functions of Performance Appraisal System

The performance appraisal system serves a number of functions.

1. Developmental function

The developmental function aims to develop the employees who are effective in their work. Identification of the need for staff training is related to the identification of employees/workers who do not achieve the results as they should. In this case the performance appraisal system of employees is used to improve their work.

2. Administrative function

This function is reflected in the use of the information collected during performance appraisal to make various administrative decisions, such as, calculation of wages, salary increment, promotions, confirmations, dismissal, identification of inadequate performance.

3. Stabilizing function

This function is based on connecting employees with the goals of the organization (Cleveland, Murphy and Williams, 1989). This function is reflected in the planning of human resources, identification of organizational training needs for employees.

4. Documentary function

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This function is related to the identification of criteria, which are representing measure for assessing the validity of performance appraisal system of employees, then to the large number of documents or records of human resources management, which are used to make decisions and also on express adherence to the legislation, rules and regulations of labour and labour relations. They constitute part of the data bank of the company's human resources department.

Advantages and Benefits of Performance Appraisal

Many benefits are associated with performance appraisal. The following are some of these advantages/benefits:

1. Promotion

Performance appraisal helps the managers to determine the promotion programs for efficient employees. In this regard, inefficient workers can be dismissed or demoted in case.

2. Compensation

Performance appraisal helps in chalking out compensation packages for employees. Merit rating is possible through performance appraisal. Performance appraisal tries to give worth to a performance. A compensation package which includes bonuses, high salary rates, extra benefits, allowances, and pre-requisites are dependent on performance appraisal. The criteria should be merit rather than seniority.

3. Employees Development

The systemic procedure of performance appraisal helps the supervisors to frame training policies and programs. It helps to analyze strengths and weaknesses of employees so that new jobs can be designed for efficient employees. It also helps in framing future development programs.

4. Selection Validation

Performance appraisal helps the supervisors to understand the validity and importance of the selection procedure. The supervisors come to know the validity and thereby the strengths and weaknesses of the selection procedure. It acts as a pretest of the selection techniques and procedure. Future changes in selection methods can be made in this regard.

5. Communication

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Effective communication between employees and employers is very important for an organization. Through performance appraisal, communication can be sought for in the following ways:

- a. Through performance appraisal, employers can understand and accept skills of workers;
- b. The workers can also understand and create a trust and confidence in superiors;
- c. It helps in maintaining cordial and congenial labor management relationship; and
- d. It develops the spirit of work and boosts the morale of employees.

These factors ensure effective communication

6. Motivation

Performance appraisal serves as a motivation tool. Through evaluating performance of employees, a person's efficiency can be determined if the targets are achieved. This significantly motivates a person for better job and helps him/her to improve his/her performance in the future.

Performance Appraisal Criticism

1. Distrust of the appraisal can lead to issues between employees and supervisors or a situation in which employees merely tailor their input to please their employer.
2. Performance appraisals can lead to the adoption of unreasonable goals that demoralize workers or incentivize them to engage in unethical practices.
3. It is believed by some labor experts that use of performance appraisals has led to lower utilization of merit-based and performance-based compensation.
4. Performance appraisals may lead to unfair evaluations in which employees are judged not by their accomplishments but by their likeability. They can also lead to managers giving under-performing staff good evaluation to avoid souring their relationship.
5. Unreliable raters can introduce a number of biases that skew appraisal results towards preferred characteristics or ones that reflect the rater's preferences.
6. Performance appraisals that work well in one culture or job function may not be useful in another.
7. Performance appraisal is unable to release individual worker's potential and emphasize his/her contribution to the working environment.

8. The workers' fundamental psychological processes operate against performance appraisal which generates undue anxiety both for the manager and the employees.

Difficulties/Draw Backs of Performance Appraisals

Performance appraisal experiences some difficulties or drawbacks. The drawbacks of performance appraisal are as follows:

1. No matter how well defined the dimensions for appraising performance on quantitative goals are, judgments on performance are usually subjective and impressionistic.
2. Due to the inadequate information supplied about subtleties (distinction) of performance, education managers using them to compare employees for the purpose of determining salary increases often make arbitrary judgments.
3. Ratings by different supervisors, and especially those in different units, are usually incompatible. What is excellent work in one unit may be unacceptable in another in the same company.
4. When salary increases are allocated on the basis of a curve of normal distribution, which is in-turn based on rating of results rather than on behavior, competent employees may not only be denied increases, but may also become de-motivated.
5. Trying to base promotion and lay off decisions on appraisal data leaves the decisions open to acrimonious debate. Appraisal data is inadequate, for instance, to support promotion and layoff decisions.
6. Though managers are urged to give feedback freely and often, there are no in-built mechanisms for ensuring that they do so. Delay in feedback creates both frustration, when good performance is not quickly recognized, and anger, when judgment is rendered for inadequacies long past.
7. There are few effective established mechanisms to cope with either the sense of inadequacy managers have about appraising workers, or the paralysis and procrastination that result from guilt about playing good.

Furthermore, in an article prepared by Gray (2007), titled "Performance Appraisals Don't Work", the following are five reasons why performance appraisals fail:

- i) Many performance appraisal programmes are implemented without appropriate training for the managers giving the appraisals;
- ii) Performance appraisal encourages mediocrity by encouraging safe behavior as opposed to risk-taking because managers set unchallenging goals to ensure they meet them;
- iii) Most work in organizations is the result of a group effort rather than individual work so individual performance appraisal is not a meaningful way to measure performance;
- iv) Supervisor bias can cause inaccuracies in the appraisal feedback; and
- v) Performance appraisal does not provide protection from legal issues dealing with discrimination and, when not done well, it can actually be a detriment to the organization when faced with legal challenges by its employees.

Kenya Teaching Standards (Kts)

Standard 1: Teacher promotes professionalism

Competency Indicators

The teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 1.1 Professionally engage and communicating with learners, parents, colleagues and models; high standards of teaching characterized by collegiality, honesty, integrity, fairness, and accountability
- 1.2 Contributes to collaborative, inclusive, and welcoming school through participation in activities and partnerships with communities
- 1.3 Create an inclusive learning environment that supports the social, physical, intellectual, cultural, and emotional development of learners
- 1.4 Commit to lifelong learning and continually engage in self-reflection, professional inquiry, and professional learning in subject-area content, pedagogy, assessment, technology, health and well-being; and cultural responsiveness
- 1.5 Access a broad range of professional learning opportunities from multiple sources including coaches, mentors, colleagues, and communities of learning
- 1.6 Stay current in educational theory and innovations in instruction, assessment, program planning, and classroom management and their application in the classroom

- 1.7 Interprets the relevant Teachers Service Commission Act, the Code of Regulations for Teachers and Code of Conduct and Ethics
- 1.8 Conform with confidentiality requirements associated with their work, including the recording, storing, access, release, and handling of confidentiality information
- 1.9 Interpret governance structures of Basic Education Institutions
- 1.10 Interpret the Rights of learners as provided for various Charters, Basic Education Act 2013, the constitution of Kenya 2010 and other legal document and current trends in Education

Standard 2: Teacher demonstrates pedagogical content knowledge and understanding of the competency based curriculum (CBC) implementation

Competency Indicators:

The Teacher demonstrates:

- 2.1 knowledge of Basic Education Curriculum Framework (BECF) the core competencies; competency indicators; and how to integrate them into the learning areas and across grade levels
- 2.2 understanding of the competency based education and broad 21st century learners outcomes and support systems
- 2.3 knowledge and capability to plan teaching with the end in mind using a Backward instructional Design Model
- 2.4 ability to identify and nurture learners talents
- 2.5 ability to organize the content into an effective learning and teaching progressive and uses knowledge of the content and teaching strategies to develop and implement engaging learners learning activities
- 2.6 ability to design and implements instruction and integrates core competencies in Basic Education Curriculum
- 2.7 understanding about how learners learn to plan a variety of instructional strategies and resources to respond to learners diverse needs
- 2.8 ability to integrate the pedagogy of Community Service learning in his/teaching learning area/subject
- 2.9 appreciation of the experiences the learner bring to class, create trusting, respectful climate with learners

- 2.10 ability to evaluate and improve learning resources to support the teaching of a content area
- 2.11 ability to utilize resources which reflect diversity of learners, their knowledge, attributes and capabilities
- 2.12 ability to provide learners with a variety of information resources as well as the technological tools to mediate and enhance engagement

Standard 3: Teacher has competence in assessment of learners

Competency Indicators

The Teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 3.1 Design assessment for learning or formative assessment and uses information from this assessment on learners performance to modify and differentiate teaching and learning activities
- 3.2 Engage learners actively in assessment process ; in order to develop their capacity to co-construct criteria for success, self-monitor progress and provide descriptive feedback to learners that is prompt and specific
- 3.3 Design assessment as learning enabling learners to actively engage as a critical assessor to make sense of what they are learning, monitors their learning, use feedback from self-monitoring to make adaptations where necessary
- 3.4 Facilitate assessment as learning through helping learners develop skills for reflecting on and monitoring their own learning
- 3.5 Design assessment of learning to confirm what learners know and can do, to demonstrate if the learners have achieved curriculum outcomes
- 3.6 Embed assessment in all levels of lesson planning, ensures assessments are aligned to learning outcomes and uses the assessment to provide accurate and comprehensive statements of learners proficiency in meeting Basic Education Curriculum outcomes
- 3.7 Design assessment activities, tasks and strategies, for example: performance tasks, anecdotal records, reflective journals, portfolios, peer assessment, dramatizations, projects, interviews, surveys, self-assessments, observations, rubrics, rating scales, among others

3.8 Apply a range of strategies for reporting to learners' achievements and knows how to develop accurate records to inform and communicate student progress in timely and respectable manner to learners, parents and guardians

Standard 4: Teacher demonstrates understanding of inclusive education practices

Competency Indicators

The Teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 4.1 design a learning environment that is responsive to the physical, cognitive, social, cultural and emotional aspects to ensure participation and success of all learners
- 4.2 involve learners in establishing and maintaining classroom procedures and routines, and ensures discipline issues are addressed promptly, fairly and respectfully
- 4.3 Design a learning environment where learners have access to both material and human resources to promote learning
- 4.4 Create inclusive learning environment where learners with special needs have opportunities to demonstrate their learning in their own way, using appropriate resources support, both human and material including assistive technology that accommodate their needs and learn at their own pace
- 4.5 Appreciate that all learners can be successful and supports each other to actualize full potential
- 4.6 Appreciate that learners are individually different with diverse skills, abilities, talents and interests
- 4.7 Establish and implement inclusive and interactions to engage and support all learners in learning activities
- 4.8 Integrate strategies that ensure a safe, responsive and ethical use of technology in learning
- 4.9 Develop enriched experiences and environment to support the to support the gifted and talented learners

Standard 5: Teacher promotes comprehensive school health and safety

Competency Indicators

The teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 5.1 conceptualize health literacy skills, social determinants of health, and comprehensive school health
- 5.2 recognize infectious diseases and their sources to reduce learners exposure to these health conditions through education
- 5.3 utilize stress reduction strategies to support learners with emotional, health and stress challenges
- 5.4 apply knowledge about sexuality health education and HIV and Aids and is able to teach learners about risky sexual behaviour
- 5.5 apply knowledge about drug abuse, drug addiction, and teaches drug education to learnersto their health and well-being
- 5.6 apply knowledge about environment health, and teaches learners to keep health environments including disposal and staying green
- 5.7 apply knowledge about personal health hygiene and medical conditions associated with unhygienic c.....body such as obesity and teaches learners to maintain active health and hygienic lifestyle
- 5.8 apply knowledge about nutrition and health eating, teach health risks associated consumption of un....cancer, heart conditions associated with unhealthy foods and teaches learners how to consume healthy food
- 5.9 apply knowledge about effects of bullying on learners and teaches learners to build a caring and r....health relationship
- 5.10 apply basic skills to handle life saving measures such as breathing emergencies, resuscitation and cardiopulmonary techniques, bleeding and shock management, splinting, burns and scalds, and First Aid
- 5.11 apply appropriate skills to manage firefighting equipment and handle fire disasters

Standard 6: The teacher demonstrates financial literacy

Competency indicators

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The Teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 6.1 articulate financial matters including financial management, terminologies, concepts and principles
- 6.2 apply various financial planning techniques such as budgeting
- 6.3 analyze and interpret financial management statements and reports such as the balance sheet, income and expenditure statement and asset register
- 6.4 Procure and dispose goods and services as required by the relevant public procurement and Assets Disposal Act.
- 6.5 Apply stores management and accounting procedures that ensure proper stock control systems are established and maintained in the learning institution for the purposes of accountability

Standard 7: The teacher promotes instructional leadership and administration

Competency indicators

The Teacher demonstrates ability to:

- 7.1 develop and implement a shared vision for instruction that supports all learners
- 7.2 lead and manage change
- 7.3 build a collaborative school culture for instructional improvement
- 7.4 implement high quality instruction
- 7.5 facilitate high quality job-embedded professional development
- 7.6 utilize assessment data to improve learning and achievement
- 7.7 lead and build inclusive school learning environment
- 7.8 lead and practice distributed leadership

EMP 401: EDUCATIONAL MANAGEMENT AND LEADERSHIP
COMMUNICATION

Introduction

The word communication is derived from the Latin word “communis” which means common. Hence, in order for people to communicate effectively, common understanding which results from exchange of ideas and information is essential. The significance of communication in every organization cannot be underestimated. Being able to communicate effectively is one of the most important life skills that a person needs to learn. No enterprise can effectively attain its prescribed goals and objectives without it and an organization whose communication is not effective is bound to collapse sooner or later.

Definitions of Communication

There are as many definitions of communication as there are scholars. The following are some of the definitions of communication:-

1. Communication is the process of transmitting information and common understanding from one person to another (Keyton, 2011).

2. Communication refers to the process of exchanging information between and/or among individuals, groups, institutions, and/or organizations in oral, written or in sign forms through any available media (Nwogbaga, Nwankwo & Onwa, 2015)
3. Communication is a process of creating and sharing Ideas, information, views, facts and feelings among people to reach a common understanding (Toppr, 2020).
4. Communication is the transfer of information and knowledge from one person to another which is accomplished in the communication process in which the source encodes a thought into a message which is transmitted through a channel to a receiver who decodes the message (Hicks & Gullett, 1981).
5. Communication is the process of conveying information from one person known as the sender to another person known as the receiver (Weick & Browing, 1986).
6. Communication is the transference of information to produce greater understanding (CFI, 2020).
7. Communication refers to the exchange of ideas, emotions and opinion through words, letters or symbols between two or more people (Ince & Gul, 2001).
8. Communication is the process of interchanging thoughts, feelings and information (Waweru & Ngugi, 2002).
9. Communication is the mutual exchange of information and understanding by any effective means, and unless the flow of communication goes both ways, no real communication takes place (D, Souza, 1989).
10. Communication is simply the act of transferring information from one person, group or place to another, and every communication involves (at least) one sender, a message and a recipient (Skills You Need, 2020).

In considerations of the foregoing definitions, communication is here defined as the purposeful passage, exchange, transfer, transmission or conveyance of valuable information, messages, ideas, thoughts, feelings and understanding by any effective means from one person, group of persons or place to another.

No person or group can exist without communication. Before there is any successful headway in any organization, an effective communication system must be put in place. Effective communication is a key element in every human organization all over the world and it's relied upon in ensuring that predetermined outcomes are achieved (Enyia & Orokor, 2016). It is only through transference of meaning from one person to another that information and ideas can be conveyed. Communication is, however, more than imparting meaning. In a group, for instance, if one member speaks German and the others do not understand German, the individual speaking German will not understand the communication. Hence, communication must include both the transference and understanding of meaning.

The Communication Process

The communication process refers to a series of actions or steps taken in order to communicate successfully and involves several components. These components include the sender, encoding, message, channel, receiver, decoding and feedback. David Berlo's communication model in Hicks & Gullet (1981) provides an expanded list of components as follows:

1. The source
2. Encoder
3. Message
4. Channel

5. Decoder
6. Feedback
7. Noise

1. Source

Communication commences with the sender who after generating an idea encodes it in a way that can be easily comprehended by the receiver. The source or sender is therefore the originator or initiator of the communication process. It is the party in the communication process that sends the message. A newspaper, magazine or journal can also be sources. One initiates the message when s/he has a thought, need, feelings, ideas or information s/he wishes to transmit to another person or group of persons.

2. Encoding

This stage involves putting a message into a format that can be sent and that can be easily understood or decoded by the receiver. Encoding has also been conceived as the process of converting thoughts and ideas into communication. The sender encodes the idea by selecting words, symbols, or gestures with which to compose a message. To be able to transmit mental perceptions or thoughts, the source encodes ideas, that is, s/he organizes ideas into a code or set of symbols such as words, pictures, maps, posts. Language is the most common and popular code that is used to express mental perceptions.

3. The message

The idea or purpose is expressed as a message. It is the outcome of encoding which takes the form of verbal, nonverbal, or written language. A message is simply the information that is being conveyed from the sender to the receiver. It is the verbal or nonverbal content being conveyed from the sender to the receiver. A message is the actual physical product such as printed words

in, for instance, a letter, a graphic drawing, facial expression, body movement or a gesture. A message can also be in form of audible expressions such as spoken words. Hence, messages can be transmitted verbally (orally), nonverbally or in written form.

4. The channel

The channel is the medium used to relay or transmit the message from the source to the receiver. The message is sent through a medium or channel which is the carrier of the communication. A channel therefore connects the sender to the receiver. The source of the message may decide either to use the formal or informal channels to transmit messages. Verbal communication channels include face-to-face communication space such as meetings and video conferencing while written communications include letters, reports, emails, instant messaging and social media posts. The most commonly used channels involve the use of sight or sound. Television, radio, telegram, memo, fax machine and newspaper constitute other channels of communication.

5. Decoder- Receiver

The receiver is the person to whom the message is intended and to whom it is transmitted. Every receiver who enters into a communication process brings with them their own ideas and feelings that influence their understanding of a message and their response to it. Before the message can be received, the symbols in it must be translated into a form that can be understood by the receiver. This implies that the receiver decodes the message and attaches a certain meaning which is an exact or an approximation of the message the source wished to convey. Successful decoding of a message is as much a skill as encoding it and to accurately decode a message, one needs to take time to read through it carefully or to listen actively to it. The message is more successfully transmitted when the sender and the receiver attach similar meanings to the symbols that compose the message.

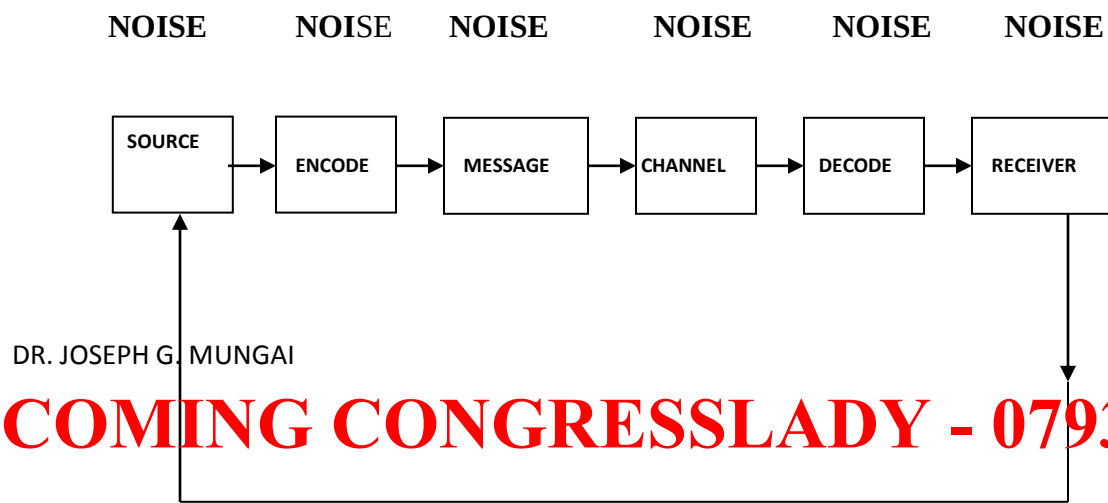
6. The feedback

Feedback occurs when the receiver responds to the sender's message and returns the message to the sender. Therefore, the message generated by the receiver in response to the sender's original message is known as feedback and is essential to ensure that the message has been effectively encoded, transmitted, decoded and understood. The audience of a communication will likely give you feedback as soon as it has seen or heard the message and this feedback might include verbal or nonverbal reactions. Feedback is in fact the check on how successful we have been in transmitting our message as originally intended.

The Noise

In communication studies, noise refers to anything that distorts or interferes with the communication process between the sender and the receiver. It can be external (physical sound) or internal (mental disturbance) and it can disrupt the communication at process at any point. Similarly, noise is viewed as anything that distracts, interferes or reduces the accuracy or fidelity of the message. It is also viewed as anything that has a disturbing influence on the message being conveyed and can occur at the sender's end, during transmission or at the receiver's end. It can occur when the channel of communication is noisy such as a radio or telephone or when one is trying to transmit a message in a noisy environment such as a market place or bus station. Since noise hinders communication, the sender should choose a channel that is free from noise.

Model of the Communication Process



FEEDBACK

NOISE

Source: David K. Berlo in Hicks & Gullett (1981:P.322).

Functions of Communication

Communication serves the following seven major functions within a group or organization.

1. Control and Regulation
2. Motivation Expression
3. Emotional Expression or therapeutic function
4. Informative function
5. Persuasive function
6. Instructive function
7. Aesthetic function

1. Control and Regulation

Communication serves to control and regulate members' behaviour in several ways. Organizations have hierarchies and formal guideline that employees are required to follow. When employees communicate any job-related grievance to their immediate boss, follow their job description or comply with company policies, communication is performing a control function. Informal communication, however, also controls behavior. When the work group, for instance, tease or harass a member who whose output is always high and makes the rest of the group members feel weak, ineffective or bad, they are informally communicating with and controlling the group members' behavior.

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2. Motivation

Communication fosters motivation by clarifying to employees what they must do, how well they are doing it, and what they can do to improve performance if it's subpar. The formation of specific goals, feedback on progress toward the goals and reward for desired behavior all stimulate motivation and require effective communication.

1. Emotional Expression and Social Interactions

The work group is the primary source for social interactions for many employees. Communication is a fundamental mechanism by which members of a group shows their satisfaction and frustrations. Communication, therefore, provides a venue for emotional expression of feelings and fulfillment of social needs. In addition, it has been noted that communication is used to produce social relationships, develop bonds, intimacy, relationships, express preferences, desires, needs, wants, decisions, goals and strengths used for giving and getting information encouragement.

2. Information

Communication provides the information that individuals and groups need to make decisions by transmitting the data needed to identify and evaluate choices. This communication facilitates the process of making decisions.

3. Instructive Function

Many times, older people who hold important information and those in higher rank communicate to instruct people on what to do, and when and where to do them, and on why and how to do them.

4. Persuasive Function

This involves influencing the opinion of others to believe and accept your stand or claim on an issue or problem. In such circumstances, one thinks of strategies on how to persuade people to change their perspective or opinion.

5. Aesthetic Function

People use communication for pleasure and enjoyment.

Formal and Informal Communication

Formal Communication

Formal communication is official and includes both vertically and horizontally transmitted information which is channeled through the chains of command of the organization. It is a type of communication that is preplanned. It is the flow of official information through proper, predefined organizational channels and routes and this information flow is controlled and requires deliberate efforts to be properly communicated. It is the flow of official information through proper, predefined organizational channels and routes and this information flow is controlled and requires deliberate efforts to be properly communicated.

The formal communication types are as follows:

- i) Downwards communication: This is vertical communication that flows down the chain of command such as orders, directives, coaching, counselling, disciplinary actions, and general information; and
- ii) Upward communication is vertical communication that flows up the chain of command such as reports, concerns, questions, statuses, and general communication;
- iii) Horizontal/Lateral/Sideways Communication is one between and among members of equal ranks/position in the organization.

iv) Matrix (diagonal) communication doesn't follow the organizational chain of command but superimposes it. It is considered formal since it has been preapproved and agreed upon by people in organizational authority positions. Matrix communication includes project communication, taskforce communication and committee communication. Project communication is based on pre-established and agreed upon project team membership, which can include members from multiple departments and multiple levels.

Formal communication if effectively utilized is very important in realization of organizational goals and objectives. At times, however, formal communication may be ineffective in addressing organizational/management problems for the following reasons:

- i) Fear of reprisal: People are afraid to speak their mind;
- ii) Filters: Workers feel their ideas/concerns are modified as they are conveyed; and
- iii) Time: Managers give the impression that they do not have the time to listen to employees whereas they hold critical information.

The challenge to the organizational management is to minimize the effects of these attributes on formal communication. The management should encourage all members of their organizations to share the valuable information they may be possessing. Suppression of such information should be avoided at all costs.

Direction of Communication Flow in Formal Organizations

Information can flow in four directions namely downward communication, upward communication, lateral or horizontal communication and diagonal or crosswise communication.

1. Downwards Communication informal Organizations

In downwards communication, information, directives and instructions are passed down from those in management positions to those in lower positions or ranks. It is when organizational

managers and leaders share information with lower-level employees. The five types of downward communication include the following:

- i) Instructions about specific tasks
- ii) Rationale about why the task needs to be done and how it relates to other tasks
- iii) Information about organizational procedures and practices
- iv) Feedback about the individual's performance level
- v) Information about the need for individual commitment to the organizational goal
- vi) Goal assignment

Canary (2011) has identified the general purposes of downward communication as follows:

- i) Implementation of goals, strategies and objectives: Communicating new strategies and goals provides information about specific targets and expected behaviours;
- ii) Job instructions and rationale: These are instructions on how to do a specific task and how the job relates to other activities of the educational organization.;
- iii) Procedures and practices: These are the messages defining the organization's rules, policies; regulations, benefits and structural arrangements in order some degree of uniformity in organizational practices;
- iv) Performance feedback: Departmental progress reports, individual performance appraisals, and other means are used to tell departments or individuals how well they are doing with respect to performance standards and goals; and
- v) Socialization: Every organization tries to motivate staff members to adopt the institution's mission and cultural values and to participate in special ceremonies, such as, camping, picnics and environmental conservation activities.

Downward communication doesn't have to be oral face-to-face contact. When management sends a letter or email to employees' homes to advise them of the organization's new sick leave policy, it is using downwards communication. Downward communication is also passed down through memos, directions, policies and program of action. In an educational situation, for instance, information can be passed down from the Ministry of Education Officials, the Teachers Service Commission or the County Directors of Education to the teachers through the principal. In a school also, the principal can communicate downwards to either the teaching or support staff in lower positions through the deputy principal and the heads of departments. Downwards communication in a school can also originate from the head of department to teachers belonging to that particular department regarding a specific instructional issue.

2. Upwards Communication in Formal Organizations

Information that flows from employees in lower positions in the organization or group to those in higher levels in the group or organization is referred to as upward communication. In other words, it flows from members of staff in the lower ranks to those in the senior management positions. It is used to provide feedback to higher-ups, inform them of problems such as an impending strike from pupils through teachers, deputy principal, to principal and finally to the Board of Management. Canary (2011) summarizes the information communicated upwards as follows:

- i) Problems and exceptions: Description of serious problems and exceptions to routine performance in order to make the manager aware of the difficulties;
- ii) Suggestions for improvement: These messages are ideas for improving task-related procedures to increase the efficiency or quality of organization's members;

- iii) Performance reports: These messages include periodic reports that inform the leader how individual organization's members and departments are performing;
- iv) Grievances and disputes: These messages are employee complaints and conflicts that travel up the school's organizational hierarchy for a hearing and possible resolution. If the grievance procedure is backed up by the presence of a collective bargaining agreement, the members of the organization are even more encouraged to express true feelings; and
- v) Financial and accounting information: The messages pertain to costs, accounts receivable, interests on investments, tax levies and other matters of interest to the board, the central administration and the government.

3. Horizontal (Lateral/Sideways) Communication in Formal Organizations

Horizontal communication involves the exchange of information across departments at the same level in an organization, that is, peer-to-peer communication and the purpose of most horizontal communication is to request support or coordinate activities. It occurs between members of equal positions or ranks in the organizational hierarchy. In other words, lateral communication occurs among members of the same workgroup, among members of workgroups at the same level, among managers at the same level, or among any horizontally equivalent personnel. This is, for instance, so when members of the same work group or level in the school such as heads of department communicate with each other.

Canary (2011) summarizes the categories of horizontal communication as follows:

- i) Intradepartmental problem solving: These messages take place between members of the same department in a school or education zone in a school-wide organizational system and concern task accomplishment;

- ii) Interdepartmental coordination: Interdepartmental messages facilitate the accomplishment of joint projects or tasks in a school system or education zone in a school-wide organizational system; and
- iii) Staff advice to line departments: These messages often originate from specialists in academic areas, finance, or computer service to campus-level managers seeking assistance in these areas.

The major purpose of horizontal communication is coordinating educational activities at the same level. Principals, For instance, communicate so that their activities or curriculum emphasis will be similar in different schools. Worth noting is that coordination through the transfer of written information often fails to bear fruits. Consequently, written messages are frequently supplemented by conferences of peers in hopes that a more personal informal exchange of ideas will facilitate efforts at coordination. Heads of department, in horizontal communication can, for instance, give guidelines and expectations of the departments from teachers such as regarding deadlines on marking of exams. Hence, horizontal communication is as important as downwards and upwards communication since activities in the school, for instance, are coordinated in such a way that duplication of tasks is not only avoided but also helps to maximize the achievement of the set goals and objectives.

Lateral (horizontal) communication can, from the manager's view point, be good or bad. Since strict adherence to the formal vertical structure for all communication can impede the efficient and accurate transfer of information, lateral communication can be beneficial. In such cases, it occurs with the knowledge of the superiors and their support. However, they can create dysfunctional conflicts when:

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- i. Formal vertical channels are breached;
- ii. Members go above or around their superiors to get things done; or
- iii. Bosses find out that actions have been taken or decisions made without their knowledge.

Moreover, some problems may arise if one manager is unwilling or unmotivated to share information or sees efforts to work communally as threatening his/her position in the organizational hierarchy. All in all, horizontal communication complements both downwards and upwards communication in enhancing realization of school goals and objective.

4. Diagonal (Crosswise) Communication

Diagonal communication is cross-functional communication between employees at different levels of the organizational hierarchy or group. It occurs when people working at the same level interact with those working at a higher or lower level of organizational hierarchy and across boundaries of their reporting relationships. Whenever communication goes from lower level employee in one department to a higher level manager in another department, the sender's manager should be made part of the loop. This is because the latter may be put in an embarrassing situation and appear incompetent if s/he isn't aware of everything happening in his/her department and consequently, trust may be lost and careers damaged by not paying attention to key communication protocols. Diagonal (matrix) communication is increasingly common in large educational institutions with matrix or project based structures. It includes project communication, taskforce communication and committee communication. It may overcome some of the barriers to communication within an educational organization such as reducing information distortion or misinterpretation by encouraging communication between relevant parties.

The advantages and limitations of diagonal communication are summarized as follows:

Advantages of Diagonal Communication

1. Coordination: This crosswise communication serves the important purpose of coordination through meetings, formal conferences, lunch hour meetings, general notices and so on.
2. Practicability: It's practical since all communication takes place strictly on the lines of organizational hierarchy, that is, downwards and upwards.
3. Morale boosting: By providing opportunities to lower level workers to interact with managers in informal meetings, it boosts their morale and further commitment to the organization. More and more organizations are encouraging crosswise communication.

Limitations of Diagonal Communication

1. Fear of infringement: The superiors may feel that their formal authority is infringed and threatened since his/her subordinate has been given undue attention and importance.
2. Resistance to compliance: The superior may not implement subordinates' suggestions since s/he has not been consulted.
3. Anarchy: Lack of accepted procedures may lead to internal anarchy and external animosity.

Informal communication

Informal communication is a form of communication which is opposite of formal communication and takes into account the socio-interactive characteristics of the individual worker in the organization. The informal communication system remains a thriving competitor to formal communication systems. This is because the formal communication channels do not carry all the information that employees need making interactive informal communications dominant

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in the day-to-day life and activities of the individual workers and work groups. Informal communication is multidimensional, moves freely within the organization and is not bound by pre-defined channels and communication routes. It refers to all communication in an organization that is unofficial and quickly transmitted. Sometimes this type of communication originates from lack of open formal channels of communication in the organization. Informal communication falls outside the control of the organization's management and is more flexible and reliable than the conventional official communication coming from the top management.

The grapevine

Grapevine communication happens in every organization irrespective of size implying that it occurs in small, medium and complex organizations (Smarp, 2020). It can be very helpful or very destructive to the organization (Wanjau, 2005). Workers need to appreciate that when false and unconfirmed information is being circulated through the grapevine, peoples' reputations, careers and lives can be endangered and destroyed very easily. It can also be very helpful in that it can inform school managers of the things that are informally taking place in the school, for instance, an impending strike. This information can assist the school authorities to take the necessary actions to avert or prevent the strike. The management can also gauge the reactions of the employees regarding certain pending execution of an action. One can, for instance, pronounce via grapevine that the salary increase would be below average this year. If the increase turns out to be average, most employees would be relieved and satisfied. This is to psychologically prepare the workers to be satisfied with the average offer.

One can also use grapevine to measure the expected response of employees to an announcement before transmitting it through formal channels. If the reaction (response) is negative, management can sometimes modify its plans. Management might, for instance, want to see how

seriously morale would be affected by announcing a two day vacation without pay for all employees. The idea is then fed into the grapevine and reactions to the plan can be gauged by the tone of the rumors it creates. Grapevine can also be destructive, full of distortion, inaccurate, incorrect and incomplete. Rumors, gossip or scandals about the school principal, for instance, having an illicit relationship with a student can be very demoralizing, lead to low productivity and low self-esteem. It can even lead to harsh disciplinary measures from the employer on the victim in spite of such unfounded information lacking any credibility.

All in all, the grapevine acts both as a filter and a feedback mechanism, picking up the issues that employees consider important relevant. The grapevine is particularly valuable for translating formal communication into their own group jargon. Managers can on the other hand possibly analyze grapevine information and predict its flow given that only a small portion of individuals (around ten percent) actively pass on information.

Informal communication in the workplace is the one often called the grapevine and generally begins with employees through social relations. Employee-driven communication is an informal, organic interaction that reduces the inherent communication loss that occurs in the formal organizational communication. This is the grapevine that features distinct and unique characteristics that contrasts formal communication networks. The grapevine is the major informal communication pathway and operates both in internal and external informal channels. During informal conversational interaction, rumors and gossip are interchanged.

Observations about Grapevine

It has been observed that:

- i) Grapevine gossip and rumor are all informal communication means and occur as a response to reduction of uncertainty;
- ii) Gossip and rumor exist in conditions of threat, crisis, alarm, fear, instability and/or upheaval;
- iii) Gossip and rumor have evidenced insignificant long-term impact on the organization in which they occur; and
- iv) The grapevine makes an impressive impact on the organization.

Grapevine participant labels have been described as follows:

- i) Liaisons are those who actively participate in the grapevine by contributing in the flow of information and those who share organizational information with more than one person;
- ii) Isolates are those who do not hear the complete information half of the time and so end up hearing part of the information; and
- iii) Dead-enders are those who do not hear complete information more than two-thirds of the time and hence transmit less than one-half of the complete information or distorted information as they try to fill the gaps.

Types of Grapevine Communication

The types of grapevine communication are as follows:

- i) Single Strand Chain: This involves the passing of information through a line of persons to the ultimate recipient;
- ii) Gossip Chain: In this chain, one person seeks and tells the information to everyone. The gossip chain is just like the wheel where one person stays at the center and passes information to other employees;

iii) Probability Chain: This chain is a random process in which someone transmits the information to others in accordance to the laws of probability and then these other receivers passes the information to other employees; and

iv) Cluster Chain: In this chain, a person tells the information to the selected people who may in turn pass the information to other selected people.

Characteristics of the Grapevine

1. Rapid Communication

Grapevine communication makes news spreads like wildfire (Samiksha, 2020; TBC, 2020).

2. Information Distortion

The Grapevine is notorious for distorting information so much that the information received from this source is often referred to as a rumour (TBC, 2020).

Other characteristics of grapevine communication identified by Samiksha (2020), TBC (2020) and Wisdom Jobs (2020) are as follows:

1. Its formed through social relations
2. It follows uncertain path
3. It un-official channel
4. Not controlled by management
5. Its perceive to be more reliable by most employees than information from management
6. It's flexible due to lack of formalities
7. Its orally communicated and driven by self-interest of group members
8. Influential to some extent
9. Its spontaneous
10. Its incomplete to some extent and has no records

Keith Davis in Waweru & Ngugi (2002) summarizes characteristics of the grapevine as follows:

1. Recent news provokes the most talk.
2. People talk about things that affect their work.
3. People talk about people they know.
4. Members of the grapevine work near each other;
5. People who contact each other in regular work relationships tend to be on the same grapevine.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Grapevine Communication

The advantages and disadvantages of grapevine communication are as follows:

Advantages of Grapevine Communication

1. Speed: Grapevine communication is highly rapid and can be used to send messages very quickly. As soon as an employee gets to know some confidential information, s/he becomes inquisitive and passes the details to close peers who in turn pass it to others hastening its circulation.
2. Valuable feedback: Grapevine provides valuable feedback to the management if it's used intelligently. The leadership gets to know the reactions of their subordinates on their policies. Hence, the feedback is quickly obtained in comparison to formal communication channels.
3. Grapevine communication creates a sense of bond and unity among the employees who share and discuss their views with each other. Thus grapevine enhances group cohesion.
4. Check on emotions: Grapevine communication is an indicator of employees' interest in their work because the grapevine serves as an emotional outlet for workers. It serves as an emotional supportive value.

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5. The grapevine communication knowledge base serves as a supplement in those cases where formal communication does not work.
6. Morale booster: Grapevine communication can act as a morale booster because it can be used effectively by the management for transmitting good and positive ideas.

Disadvantages of Grapevine Communication

1. Rumours: Grapevine communication can carry partial, malicious and damaging rumours which can create a suspicious and tense environment in the company. It does not clearly depict the complete state of affairs.
2. Message distortion: At times, details of a message are lost as it is subject to filtering by many people. Sometimes people may add new details. The grapevine is not always trustworthy as it does not follow official path of communication and is heavily spread by gossips and unconfirmed reports.
3. Affects productivity: Grapevine at times can seriously hamper the development or productivity of a company as employees spend more time talking rather than working.
4. Hostility and poor interpersonal relations: The grapevine may encourage hostility and ill feelings against the organizational leadership due to unfounded claims and circulation of hate and inciting information.
5. Difficult to control: Grapevine carries messages so quickly that it is difficult to control or regulate communication flow.

Ways to Make Grapevine Beneficial to the Organization

The ways of making grapevine beneficial to the organization are as follows:

- i) Providing the real news to the grapevine initiators;

- ii) Considering grapevine as a pulse feeling tool;
- iii) Contradicting the false rumour;
- iv) Allowing workers in the decision-making process; and
- v) Developing a good organizational climate

Types of Communication

Five types of communication include verbal, non-verbal, written and visual. However, the three common ways of communicating that are generally relied upon in organizations include but not limited to oral (verbal), non-verbal and written communication.

1. Oral Communication

Oral communication is non-verbal and non-written. It involves the use of language to transfer information through speaking and is the most common types often used during presentations, video conferences, phone calls, meetings and one-on-one conversations. Oral communication, while primarily referring to spoken verbal communication, can also employ visual aids and nonverbal elements to support the conveyance of meaning.

Advantages of Verbal (Oral) Communication

A number of advantages of verbal communication have been identified. The following are the advantages of verbal communication.

1. It's less expensive: It saves money as no gadgets or stationery are required.
2. Information reaches the audience immediately and feedback is immediate.
3. Information, ideas, thoughts and messages are transmitted very fast and feedback is given immediately.
4. Personal contact: Oral communication is more effective and it enhances personal contact that is essential and valuable for smooth working.

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5. Participants in oral exchange are able to gauge the importance of the information being conveyed due to the emphasis intonation.
6. Useful in difficult situation and emergent situations.
7. Co-operative spirit: Oral communication has a human touch as it generates a friendly and cooperative spirit.
8. Useful in secret issues: Oral communication is very useful for very secretive and confidential matters
9. Persuasive: In oral communication, the speaker can win over the other person to his/her point of view.
10. Useful for all kinds of audience: It is useful for addressing literate, semi-illiterate and illiterate masses.

Disadvantages of Oral communication

Several disadvantages of verbal communication have been identified. The following are the disadvantages of oral communication:

1. Distortion is apparent where many people are involved in passage of information.
2. No legality: It has no scope from legal point of view as there is no visible proof or evidence unless recorded either confidentially or voluntarily.
3. Lack of accountability: The speaker or listener cannot be held accountable for any vocal message as anyone can deny having said or heard anything.
4. Low reference value: It cannot act as a reference unless recorded.
5. Greater scope for errors: There is greater chance of misunderstanding due to the verbal nature of exchange. Unfamiliar words, insults and abusive language can lead to a misunderstanding.
6. Abusive Language (insults) cannot be undone after they have been spoken.

7. Easily forgotten: What is conveyed orally cannot be remembered for a long time since human memory is short and therefore easily forgotten.
8. Not useful for long distances: This kind communication is not practically effective especially if the network access is limited or communication gadgets are faulty.

2. Non-Verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication is non-oral and non-written. It involves what we do while speaking which often says more than the actual words. It is the use of body language, gestures and facial expressions to convey information to others. It also includes posture, eye contact, touch, hand movements such as handshake and signs such waving.

The following are some forms of non-verbal communication in form of symbolic language:

i) Action

It is possible to use action to convey a particular message. As the saying goes, “Actions speak louder than words.” An act of Kindness shows concern even though the one doing the action may not actually say anything. Likewise, the receiver easily understands an act of cruelty portraying clearly the message that “One ought to be cautious with the one doing the action as s/he is not a friend.” Hence, both actions of kindness and cruelty relay hidden messages even though the words may not have been spoken.

ii) Silence

Silence is a subtle but powerful form of communication. The presence of a principal, for instance, may make a noisy class to keep quiet even if the principal does not verbally tell the class anything. His/her silence can, for example, indicate the seriousness of their behavior. However, silence can be misunderstood which can lead to dire consequences.

iii) Physical Signs

Physical signs include traffic lights or traffic signs showing that the road is slippery, posters on political messages, slogans, or advertisement of products. Physical signs in the school may, for instance, include “Do not step on grass,” “Danger” or “Silence” depending on the message that needs to be conveyed. The physical signs are made to warn, caution or instruct someone.

3. Written Communication

Writing is one personal activity that serves the communication purpose. Written communication is one of the most important and frequently used modes of communication in organizations. It involves use of some technology, such as, a book and a pen, a computer or a mobile phone, which enables us to convey the information. This type of communication entails the act of writing, typing or printing symbols like letters and numbers to convey information, for instance, through books, pamphlets and blogs.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Written Communication

The advantages and disadvantages of written communication are as follows:

Advantages of Written Communication

1. Easy to preserve: Written communication is tangible and verifiable.
2. Easy presentation of complex subject matter: It is the best way of presenting any complex matter easily and attractively. It is suitable for lengthy and complex communication.
3. Permanent records: Records of information are available.
4. Messages can be stored indefinitely.
5. The message can be used as a future reference.
6. There is enhanced logic, clarity and carefulness.

7. Prevents wastage of time and money since people can communicate without necessarily incurring financial and time costs
8. Delegation of authority: It is impossible to delegate power and authority without a written document.
9. Longevity: Written documents can be preserved for a long time.
10. Easy to verify: Preserved documents can be used to verify information and messages if any misunderstandings arise.
11. Controlling tool: Written communication can help to control organizational activity.
12. No opportunity for distorting or misinterpreting the information. There is no opportunity or possibility of distorting or misinterpreting the messages since adequate care and time are invested in preparing written documents.
13. Effective communication: Written communication helps to make communication more effective since its dependable than other forms of communication.
14. Maintaining Image: Written communication helps to maintain the image of both employee and the organization especially if it's done according to the recommended guidelines.

Disadvantages of Written Communication

1. Written communication is time consuming.
2. Written communication is expensive since items like paper, ink, pen, computer, typewriter, printer and a large number of employees are required.
3. Red Taoism: It may take time to approve a written document which may undergo various approval stages.
4. Feedback is not immediate. Written communication sometimes experiences delayed response.

5. It may be misinterpreted and unlike in oral communication, it is impossible to clarify the message immediately.
6. Unsuitable for certain groups of people such as the illiterates or persons with visual disability.
7. Lack of flexibility: It is not easy to change written documents at any time.
8. Delayed decision making: It may take time to communicate with all the parties concerned delaying the decision making especially if members come from far and as they ponder about what they may contribute in writing to the decision making process

4. Visual Communication

Visual communication is the act of using visual aids such as photographs, placards, illustrations, art, drawings, sketches, charts and graphs to convey information. Visuals are usually used as an aid during presentations to provide helpful context alongside written and/or verbal communication since they facilitate some members of the audience to consume ideas and information more easily due to different learning capabilities, speeds and styles.

5. Electronic Communication

Electronic communication is the type of communication which uses electronic media to transmit information or messages such as using computer systems, e-mail, telephone, video calling, video conferencing, satellite network, fax machine etc.. It is some form of digital communication.

Merits of Electronic Communication

The following are the advantages of electronic communication:

- i) Speedy transmission: It requires only a few seconds to communicate through electronic media because it supports quick transmission.

- ii) Wide coverage: The world has become a global village and communication around the group requires the shortest time possible.
- iii) Cheap or low cost: Electronic communication saves time and money. Text messages (SMS) are cheaper than the traditional letter.
- iv) Exchange of feedback: Electronic communication allows the instant exchange of feedback making it perfect communication.
- v) Managing Global Operation: Due to advancement of electronic media, business managers can easily control operation across the globe. Video, teleconferencing, e-mail and mobile phones communication are helping managers in this regard.

Demerits of Electronic Communication

The following are the disadvantages of electronic communication:

- i) Data Volume: The volume of telecommunication information is increasing at such a fast rate that business people are unable to absorb it within the relevant time limit.
- ii) Cost of Development: Electronic communication requires huge investment for infrastructural development. Frequent change in technology also demands further investments.
- iii) Legal Status: Data or information, if fixed, may be distorted and will cause zero value in the eye of law.
- iv) Undelivered Data: Data may not be retrieved due to system error or fault with technology. Hence, the required service will be delayed.
- v) Dependency: Technology is changing every day and therefore poor countries face the problems as they cannot afford the new or advanced technology. Hence, poor countries have to depend on the developed countries for global connectivity.

vi) Security threats: It gives room for hacking, cyber-attack or any other form of computer security threat.

The E-mail

Nowadays, email is one of the most used information and communication technologies by organizations. An email is a system of sending messages by electronic means.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Email Communication

Email is still among the most widely used communication tool in the work today. However, while email is still the go to medium for a lot of people, companies find that its disadvantages overtake its advantages if they do not take steps of improving email communication.

Advantages of Email Communication

1. Email is a free tool. Once you are online, there are no further charges that you need to spend in order to send and retrieve messages.
2. Email is quick: Emails are delivered extremely fast when compared to traditional post.
3. Email is simple. It is easy to use. Once your account is set up, composing, sending and receiving messages is simple.
4. Email allow for easy referencing. Messages that have been sent and received can be stored and searched through safely and easily.
5. Webmail means emails can be sent and received anywhere as long as there is internet connection and can be sent all the time throughout the year.
6. Email is paperless hence less environmental pollution.
7. Email allow for mass messaging. You can send a message to several recipients.

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8. Email allow for instant access of information and files.

Disadvantages of Email Communication

1. Email could potentially cause information overload. Some messages may be dismissed or left unread, especially if there are a lot of incoming messages and the email alert system is not available.
2. Email lacks a personal touch. Some messages are better transmitted in oral and written form, for instance, as a physically tangible letter.
3. Email can be disruptive to work since going through all emails require a bit of time. Email alert system can reduce this disruption.
4. Email cannot be ignored for a long time. There is no guarantee that the email will be read until the user logs on and checks their mail. It requires constant maintenance to ensure that your inbox does not become unmanageable in the long run.
5. Email can cause misunderstandings. Since email does not include non-verbal communication, recipients may misinterpret the sender's message.
6. Email messages can contain viruses. It's imperative to be aware of this possibility so that you are careful when opening messages from people you do not know, or when downloading attachments.
7. Emails require timely responses. While some people tend to disregard messages, those that require responses should be replied as soon as they are received and read. If not, urgent and important messages may be left unattended.
8. Email should be kept short and brief. This is especially difficult if you are one to send messages that are too long.
9. Spam: There are always possibilities of receiving unsolicited emails or junk mail.

10. Phishing: Sometimes fraudsters send emails to a user falsely claiming to be a legitimate company to scam the user into providing credit card or bank account numbers, passwords or other personal information on a bogus website and consequently utilizing the details for identity theft.

Mobile Phones

Mobile phones are also known as cell phones, cellular phones or simply mobile handsets. A mobile phone is a phone that one can carry and use to make or receive calls wherever one is. It is a wireless handheld device that allows users to make and receive calls.

Merits of using Mobile Phones

Some merits of mobile phones are as follows:

1. Mobile phones can be used in almost all regions of Kenya including rural areas where there are no fixed telephone lines.
2. The network has an answering service that stores the messages for the user when the mobile phone is switched off or out of range.
3. Mobile phones enable people to get assistance during emergencies.
4. One can send typed messages very cheaply through the text messaging services (SMS) available with mobiles.
5. It enables financial transactions through Mpesa, Mobile money and mobile banking.
6. It can be used for tracking offenders associated with fraud, murder or any other kind of crime.
7. Data transfer where one can send credentials, videos, photos or even documents is possible via the phones internet applications.

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8. Mobile phones also serve as an alarm or reminder.
9. Safety: The GPRS application in the phone can help you trace your way back home or help the authorities to locate you if you happen to loose direction.
10. Mobile phone can be used as form of entertainment since you can play music, watch videos, play games and so on.

Demerits of Using Mobile phones

Some demerits of mobile phones are as follows:

1. Interruptions: Ringing and incoming messages can interrupt important discussions especially during staff meetings.
2. Distraction: Phones at times compel people to make calls, text or even video call and watch video while engaged in an important work, activity or driving.
3. Isolation: Phones have made some people to be isolated from group discussions or learning activities as they are actively engaged in chatting.
4. Health problems: Some health problems associated with phone use include eye cancer, skin cancer via network waves, infertility related to WIFI utilization and sleeplessness which causes chronic fatigue during the day.
5. Mobile phone use can expose people to cyber bullying more often.
6. Cell phone technologies can create addictive tendencies in people by spending a lot of time on the phone than on any other essential activities.
7. There are issues of sexual abuse, exploitation and child pornography with mobile phones.
8. Mobile phones use causes higher levels of electronic waste.
9. Cell phone batteries can be danger especially when the phone overheats due to overcharge or overuse and can cause burns to sensitive skin or cause flammable items to ignite.

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10. New cell phones can be very expensive in terms of purchase and the situation worsens especially since robbers target the expensive gadgets

The internet

As an umbrella term that includes the associated terms cyberspace and the web, the internet refers to the actual network and the exchange of data between computers. It is a world-wide collection of interconnected networks. The internet is an electronic communications network that connects computer networks and organizational computer facilities around the world.

Markham (2003) contends that the internet can be used as follows:

- i) Medium of communication: It acts as a channel of communication through which people can exchange information;
- ii) Network of computers: The internet collapse's physical distances between people thus creating the potential for collectives and collaborations that were not possible before due to absence of internet technology; and
- iii) Context of social interaction: The internet is a unique discursive milieu that facilitates ability to witness and analyze the structure of talk, the negotiation of meaning and identity, the development of relationships and communities, and the construction of social structures as these occur discursively.

Advantages and Disadvantages of the Internet Communication

The integrated summary of the general advantages and disadvantages of internet communication are as follows:

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Advantages of Internet Communication

1. Speed and time: Through the internet, time and money are saved. This is because it is much cheaper and quicker to transfer information around.
2. Job creation: Internet has led to creation of new and exciting jobs.
3. Globalization: The internet has a huge audience throughout the world. It has indeed brought people closer, and also helped in economic growth.
4. Cost effective: It is so cheap to send an email to a different country than to make a phone call. The internet has also helped to systematize business practices helping businesses to cut cost.
5. Educational resources and Improvement of education sector: The internet is very rich with educational resources of all kinds.
6. More business opportunities: ICT has made it easier for businesses to be automated allowing customers to contact them 24/7.
7. Eliminates the cultural gap: The internet has helped to bridge the gap between people from different nations who can easily communicate with each other, allowing the exchange of views, ideas and information.
8. Immediate Feedback: It is possible to get feedback immediately from the receiver due to the speed at which information is transmitted in the internet.
9. Entertainment: Entertainment is another popular reason for which people prefer the internet games, movies, music and chatting for fun and amusement.
10. E-Commerce: Buying and selling on the internet is known as electronic commerce. Every single product and service can be available at our doorsteps because of e-commerce and it is possible across the globe via internet.

11. E-Services: The internet has increased accessibility to services such as online banking, job searching, purchasing, ticket booking, hotel reservation guidance and tip service. The internet allows services at a cheap rate overcoming distances and time impediments.
12. Software downloading: A large number of software such as games, videos, music, movies, funny clips and other entertainment software can be downloaded free of cost.
13. The internet is a source of valuable volumes of data and can be used for low-cost marketing, online surveys and online chatting among others.

Disadvantages of Internet Communication

1. Unemployment: Even though the internet has improved many sectors, it has resulted in unemployment through outsourcing, downsizing and redundancies. Robots have replaced workers in the factories, for instance.
2. Electricity blackouts or interruptions limit the use of computers in general and the internet in particular.
3. Lack of Privacy and theft of personal information: Confidential information such as credit card and bank account details may be accessed by criminals who may use it for destructive, fraudulent and spurious purposes.
4. Illegal or inappropriate materials can be found on the internet..
5. It is expensive in terms of the money spent on the telephone, internet and electricity.
6. The addiction to online social networks can disturb a person's way of living and professional activity.
7. Lack of job security: Since technology keeps on changing, job security has become a problem. This means that IT experts need to be continuously updated to keep up with the changes if they want to retain their jobs.

8. Overruling cultures: While the internet has made the universe a global village, some cultures have consumed others.
9. Copyright: Some people have illegally downloaded music or other copyrighted material for free.
10. Spamming and virus spreading are other challenges associated with the internet. It is not uncommon to receive unsolicited data through the internet. At the same time, some criminals use the internet for spreading computer viruses which may wipe out important computerized data and information.
11. Information obesity. The internet leads to information overload which frequently leads to omission in selecting information for cognitive processes.

Tele/videoconferencing

A teleconference or teleseminar is a remote but live exchange and mass articulation of information between two persons or among many persons by use of information exchange/transmission gadgets that are connected by a telecommunication system.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Tele/videoconferencing

The integrated summary of the advantages and disadvantages of teleconferencing are as follows:

Advantages of Teleconferencing

- 1) Teleconferencing saves travel time.
- 2) Teleconferencing saves travel expenses.
- 3) Teleconferencing is efficient in record keeping
- 4) Teleconferencing cuts conference costs.
- 5) Teleconferencing is Flexible: The flexibility of teleconferencing ensures that meetings are held as often as possible with no extra costs being incurred.

- 6) Teleconferencing encourages productivity: In teleconferencing, workers at different hierarchical positions communicate constantly and frequently which translates to effective information sharing and prompt actions.
- 7) Teleconferencing is one of the most reliable ways of convening meetings. This reliability has increased exponentially over the years due to advancement in technology.
- 8) Teleconference discourages socializing and therefore meetings are shorter and more oriented to the primary purpose of the meeting.
- 9) Teleconference participants are generally better prepared than for face to face meeting.
- 10) Teleconference group members participate more equally in well moderated teleconferences than in a face to face meeting.

Disadvantages of Tele/videoconferencing

- 1) Teleconferencing is prone to technical challenges.
- 2) Teleconferencing is less effective in transmitting nonverbal communication.
- 3) Teleconferencing has space Limitations: The fact that teleconferencing occurs on a screen implies that a lot of valuable information is disregarded due to limited space..
- 4) Teleconferencing discourages team dynamics.
- 5) Teleconferencing eliminates informal interactions.
- 6) Teleconferencing affects professionalism because participants are often forced to multitask.

In spite of the fact that there are considerable shortcomings associated with teleconferencing, it remains the single most important conferencing technology that allows meetings to proceed inexpensively, punctually, timely and when and where actual meetings cannot be held due to unavoidable circumstances..

Barriers to Effective Communication

1. Semantic Distortion or Problems

Many communication problems are created by semantics or the varying meaning people attach to words. Likewise, the symbols in form of words and non-verbal behavior used in communication can take on different meanings for different people and tend to be defined according to varying circumstances. Consequently, there is the possibility that a person will misinterpret the intended meaning of the sender. Semantic barriers to communication are the symbolic obstacles that distort the sent message in some other way than intended making the message difficult to understand.

2. Selective Attention/listening/Perception

Selective listening is a listening technique that filters and summarizes to achieve comprehension and hear what one wants to hear. Selective listening is a more negative type in which the listener is more biased to what they are hearing. It occurs when the listener thinks they have heard the main points or have got the gist of what the speaker wants to say. They filter out what they perceive as being of key importance and then stop listening or become distracted. Bias can be based on preconceived ideas or emotionally difficult communications. Selective listening is a symptom of failing communication.

3. Unclassified Assumptions

Sometimes a sender assumes that the receiver knows some basic things and, therefore, s/he proceeds to communicate the complex subject matter which could hinder effective transmission of the message. Communication may also have certain assumptions which are subject to different interpretations and such information transmission based on assumptions is bad communication.

If workers, for instance, assume that managers will pay them financial rewards if they work

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overtime, they are wrong unless there is a clear indication by the management in this regard . When a message is communicated, there might be a difference in the assumptions formed by the receiver and the assumptions intended to reach the receiver. Hence, doubts must not be entertained by the sender of the message. There are sometimes unclarified assumptions underlying the message that hinder it from being effectively communicated.

4. Time Pressure and Timing of Communication

Communication barriers can also exist because people are under time pressure which results to ineffective communication or lack of it. Choosing the appropriate time is also important in order to communicate effectively. It is a fact that the examination time table, for instance, should be communicated early enough to guide students in revising for the exams. Time pressure is a type of psychological stress that occurs when a person has less time available to complete a task or obtain a result. The scarcity of time could be real or perceived. Time becomes a communication barrier when there is role overload which is the situation in which a worker has been assigned so many roles/tasks than s/he can actually perform. This denies the worker sufficient time to comprehensively report about performance either individually or as a group. Time also becomes a physical barrier when people have to communicate across different time zones in different countries.

5. Poorly Written/Expressed Messages

The writer of the message may also fail to communicate effectively due to use of poorly chosen words, omissions, lack of coherence, poor organization of ideas, awkward sentence structure, platitudes, unnecessary jargons, and a failure to clarify the implications of the message. It is therefore important for the writer to ensure that the written message is clear and written in a language which the recipients will easily understand. One can do this by choosing the right style,

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vocabulary, layout, and length in order to make the transmitted message comprehensible. A good communicator using printed words must therefore ensure quality writing is upheld in preparing the communication.

6. Value Judgment

A value judgment is an overall judgment of something based upon a quick perception of its merit. In instances where value judgments are made too hastily, the receiver hears only that part of the message that s/he wishes to hear. To illustrate this point, a manager may begin to read an announcement about a Child Care Center to be sponsored by the company. A value judgment may be made quickly that this program is just another resources initiative to keep people happy. With such a quick value judgment, the manager will block out the information that childcare facilities often reduce absenteeism and turn over, thus increasing productivity and contributing to the corporate social responsibility of the organization. Value judgments must be avoided if messages are to be communicated effectively.

7. Poor Message Transmission

Poor transmission of a message may lead to information loss. Furthermore, the medium used to communicate the message may be faulty. The telephone, for instance, may be producing distractive noises within it and this may prevent one from hearing the message clearly and correctly. It is undoubtedly vital to transmit valuable if not all organizational information effectively if the goals and objectives of these entities are to be accomplished or realized.

8. Poor Messages Retention

Information retention is extremely vital during a communication interaction. Poor message retention is a cause of communication barrier since human memory is limited leading to poor

information retention due to forgetting. Message retention basically means continued possession, holding to and remembering information by the receiver that has been transmitted by the sender. Selective retention has been defined as the process whereby people more accurately remember messages that are closer to their interests, values and beliefs, than those that are in contrast with their values and beliefs, selecting what to keep in memory, thereby narrowing the information flow.

9. Status Difference Between Sender and Receiver

Social status refers to the relative rank or standing that an individual has in the eyes of others which can influence how his/her communication is received. A mere difference between people becomes a status difference when status beliefs develop that associate greater social esteem and competence with people in one category than those in another. These beliefs become widely disseminated throughout a population. It has been noted that the status or position in the hierarchy of the organization is one of the fundamental barriers that obstructs free flow of information. A manager fears that communicating freely with the subordinates, being superior to them, in the formal organization would undermine his/her position.

10. Credibility of the Sender

The trustworthiness of a communication regardless of format is heavily influenced by the perceived credibility of the source of that communication which describes the sender's positive characteristics that affect the receiver's acceptance of a message. Credibility comprises the objective and subjective components of the believability of a source of the message. It has also been opined that lack of source familiarity or credibility can derail communications especially when humor such as joke, sarcasm or irony are involved.

The more trustworthy the source or sender of a message is, the greater the probability that the message will get through clearly. In contrast, when the sender of the message has low credibility, many of the messages will be ignored. Currently however, credibility has become a widespread problem in business and Management. The problem from the perspective of communication is that many truthful and important messages may be ignored because of the low reputation of the sender. Corrupt leaders, for instance, may not effectively transmit messages as they may not be trusted by the intended recipients.

Other barriers to effective communication include:

11. Unsuitable Messages and Poor Listening Skills and Assumptions
12. Filtering of Negative Information
13. Selective Perception
14. Emotions
15. Information Overload
16. Lack of Opportunities for Communication
17. Gender Styles
17. The Reference Group
18. Physical Limitations (Barriers)
19. Language Barrier
20. Stereotyping
21. Non-Verbal Cues
22. Halo Effect

Techniques for Enhancing Communication Effectiveness

The major techniques for enhancing communication effectiveness are discussed as follows:

1) Clarity and competence

In order to communicate effectively, it is necessary to know the audience for whom the message is directed or meant. It is also important to maintain clarity and conscience. The message to be

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conveyed must be absolutely clear in the mind of the communicators because if you do not understand an idea, you can never express it to someone. The message should be adequate and appropriate to the purpose of communication which should be clearly defined. In conclusion, the message should be clear and have clarity of purpose, clarity of outcome, and it should be presented in an appropriate form of transmission.

2) Use of feedback

The aim of organizational communication is to improve the realization of the goals of both the organization and its employees. Hence, feedback should satisfy individual's information needs regarding the extent to which their goals and objectives are being realized. Feedback should promote change through interpersonal influence. This implies that since one of the most important functions of communication is to influence people's behaviour, this should be achieved through the people's response to the influence oriented communication. In spite of all effort, communication may fail simply because the receiver somehow fails to provide valuable feedback or the sender fails to interpret feedback correctly.

3) Active listening

Good communication requires understanding the need, learning to listen, managing passive communication and knowing your audience. When someone talks, we hear but too often we do not listen. Listening is an active search for meaning, whereas hearing is passive. In a conversation between two people, the sender and the receiver think listening is more difficult and it is usually more satisfying to talk than to listen. Listening is more tiring than thinking and demands intellectual efforts. Becoming an engaged listener such as focusing fully to the speaker is a good communication technique. A good communicator listens more and talks less.

4) Language simplification

Communication is effective when the message is received and understood. Since language can be an obstacle to effective communication, a manager should seek to structure messages in ways that will make them clearer and understandable. The words in a communication should be chosen carefully. The manager needs to simplify his/her language and consider the audience to whom the message is directed, so that the language will be compatible with the receiver.

5) Constrain Emotions

Emotions can severely cloud and distort the transference of meaning. Emotional upset may lead to misconstruing or misinterpreting messages or information. Also, one may fail to express clearly and accurately outgoing messages when extremely emotional. The best approach is to defer further communication until composure is regained. Emotions such as the feelings of anger, anxiety or pride can adversely affect our communication if they are not appropriately controlled and constrained. The importance of taking a moment to calm down before engaging in serious communication has been underscored. Emotional barriers to communication are usually due to lack of emotional awareness or control often referred to as emotional intelligence. By better understanding our inner emotions, we can communicate more effectively with others in the workplace and in our daily lives.

6) Effective use of Grapevine

Informal communication is also known as grapevine communication. The grapevine informal channel of communication helps to improve managerial decisions and make communication more effective. Thus, formal channels of communication must be supplemented with the use of grapevine. Since, grapevine communication cannot be eliminated in formal organizations, managers should make use of it to enhance achievement of organizational goals and objectives.

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Managers can use the grapevine, for instance, to transmit information rapidly, to test the reaction to various decisions before the formal final communication, and as a valuable source of feedback when the manager is a grapevine member.

7) Watching Non-verbal cues

It is important to learn the basics of nonverbal communication, such as, adopting the appropriate posture, eye contact and avoiding slouching in order to communicate clearly. Use of the appropriate body language, hand gestures facial expressions and emotions is also advisable if you have to communicate effectively. Non-verbal messages carry a great deal of weight. It is important for the source of a communication to pay attention to non-verbal signals and improve on how s/he reads and interprets them such as being aware of individual differences. The body language such as facial expressions, eye movement and hand gesture should be aligned with the verbal communication being transmitted if it is to be effective.

8) Self-assertion

Assertiveness is a core or healthy way of communicating and the ability to speak up for ourselves in an honest and respectful way. Assertiveness is the ability of an individual to express his/her opinion in an honest and open manner, while expressing his/her emotions, thoughts, and the right of the other person. It is the happy medium between aggression and deference (passiveness). Someone who communicates assertively is polite but firm, expressive but calm, direct and honest. Assertive people are able to say clearly what they want to say and who are empathic, respectful and who can say no when its right to do so.

9. Participation

Participatory communication is an approach based on dialogue which allows the sharing of information, perceptions and opinions among the various communication stakeholders and

thereby facilitating effective information exchange and therefore empowerment. To be able to communicate effectively, one should be able to recognize the need to employ interpersonal relationship skills to encourage the participation of any service users, such as, education service users. The importance of participation of all actors in the communication process is underscored if the exchange of information is to be effective. In a school situation, for instance, group work and team work activities encourage communication, cooperation and collaboration and help staff and student personnel talk more and effectively express themselves with peers. These group interactions inevitably lead to the realization of school goals and objectives especially from an instructional perspective.

10. Observe Principles and Skills of Effective Communication

Effective communication is a process of exchanging ideas, thoughts, knowledge and information such that the purpose or intention is fulfilled in the best way possible. Characteristics of an effective communication include clear, correct, complete, precise and reliable messages and sender's courtesy and recipient consideration. Observing the principles of effective communication is probably the encompassing technique of ensuring that messages are communicated effectively. There are very many principles of effective communication that have been identified. Some of these principles include but not limited to:

- i) Adjusting to the medium;
- ii) Being clear, curious and persuasive;
- iii) Listening carefully and understanding the audience;
- iv) Simplifying messages and identifying perfect communication time;
- v) Starting with safety and reducing threat;
- vi) Building trust and creating congruence between verbal and nonverbal messages; and

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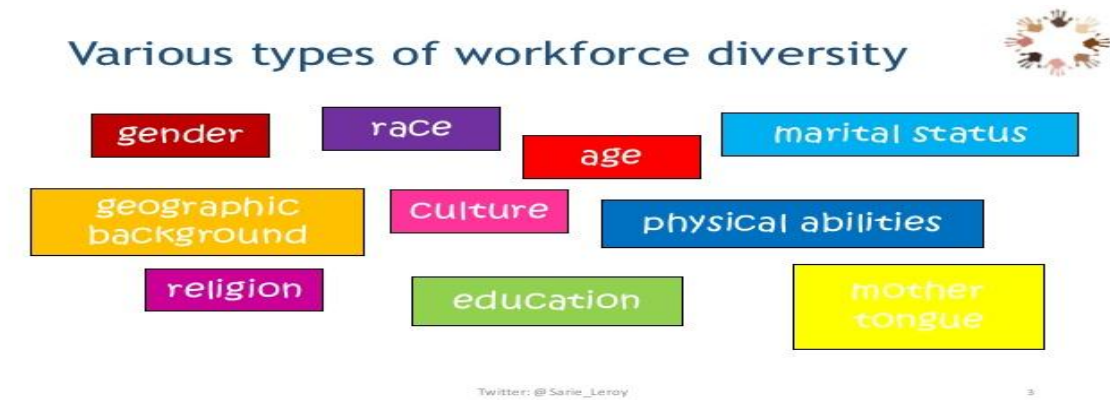
vii) Being personable, confident and empathetic and using the correct medium.

Importance of Effective School Communication

- i. Effective organizational communication benefits include:
- ii. Increased productivity;
- iii. Higher quality of services and products;
- iv. Greater levels of trust and commitment;
- v. Increased employee engagement and higher levels of creativity;
- vi. Greater employee job satisfaction and morale;
- vii. Better workplace relationships;
- viii. Greater acceptance of change;
- ix. Decreased absenteeism;
- x. Reduced staff turnover;
- xi. Less industrial unrest; and
- xii. Reduced costs.

Culturally diverse workplace

Schools like any other organization are bound to have personnel from diverse cultural orientations. Diversity in the work environment promotes acceptance, respect, and teamwork despite differences in race, age, gender, native language, political beliefs, religion, sexual orientation, or communication styles among employees. School leaders and employees therefore need to appreciate diversity in the workplace.



Ethics

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Benefits of cultural diversity in the workplace

- Increases people interpersonal skills because people from different cultures when working together can easily understand others' views.
- Increases teamwork as a result of increased interpersonal skills.
- Expands innovation and creativity. Indeed, employees of different backgrounds can help out a lot when it's time to create a new project. Also, it means different solutions to a common problem.
- Have a large range of languages spoken. Thus, staffers can attract international guests while employees in the company can benefit from learning new language(s) and thereby expand their knowledge.
- Grows company credibility because having people from various backgrounds can make the company more attractive to potential guests and future workers.
- Increases productivity on the complex tasks. Indeed, a multicultural working environment leads to more effective implementation of the tasks with different people involvement. According to studies, teams with diverse skill sets and knowledge levels, as well as ethnicity and culture, would perform better than those with the same skill sets.

Challenges of cultural diversity

1. Communication barriers

Different languages and cultural backgrounds increase the difficulty in communication between workers at workplace. And ineffective communication would result in confusion, lack of teamwork and low morale.

2. Direct and indirect discrimination among employees have been reported in companies with cultural diversity workforce. Not just employees but employers can be involved in discrimination issue. For example, some employers just focus on hiring minority but don't provide career progression for them. Discrimination issues can cause higher corporate costs, lower retention rate and affect working productivity.

3. Training challenges: There is no single course that can sufficiently prepare employees for interaction with different cultures in the world. How to conduct the training while controlling the training costs is also a challenge in a culturally diverse work place?

4. Mistrust and Tension: Employees from diverse cultures often hold mistrust about others some of which are unfounded and this may cause tension.

5. Reduced cohesiveness: With increased tension, there is a likelihood of low levels of cohesiveness and this may affect the productivity levels.

6. Stereotypes and unexamined assumptions: Most people hold certain unexplained beliefs about other persons based on aspects like gender, religion or tribe. These beliefs can lead to tension at the work place and adversely affect employee productivity

CONCEPT OF LEADERSHIP

It is impossible to think about effective realization of organizational goals and objectives without effective leadership. Hence, it is important to understand the concept of leadership. The definitions of leadership have attracted binding or common phrases such as giving purpose to collective action, mobilizing people and resources towards common goals and influencing and motivating followers towards goal accomplishment. The following are some definitions of leadership.

Definitions of Leadership

1. Leadership is a particular type of power relationship characterized by a group member's perception that another group member has the right to prescribe behaviour patterns for the former regarding his/her activity as a group member (Kenneth F. Janda in Hoy and Miskel (1987).
2. Leadership is a social exchange based on the relationship between leader and follower (Chan & Chan, 2005).
3. Leadership is the nature of the influencing process and its resultant outcomes that occur between the leader and followers, and how this influencing process is explained by the leader's dispositional characteristics and behaviours, follower perceptions and attributions of the leader and the context in which the influencing process occurs (Antonakis, 2004).
4. Leadership is a social process that results in the attainment of shared goals and is often a function of the current situation (Van Vugt, 2006).

5. Leadership is a dynamic process where leaders mobilize others to get extraordinary things done. To do so, leaders engage five practices: model the way, inspire a shared vision, challenge the process, enable others to act, and encourage the heart (Kouzes & Posner, 2007).
6. Leadership is the initiation of a new structure or procedure for accomplishing an organization's goals and objectives or for changing an organization's goals and objectives (James Lipman in Hoy and Miskel (1987).
7. The leader is the individual in the group given the task-relevant group activities-Fred F Fiedler.
8. Leadership refers to selecting, equipping, training and influencing one or more followers who have diverse gifts, abilities and skills, and focuses the followers to the organization's mission and objectives causing the followers to willingly and enthusiastically expend spiritual, emotional and physical energy in a concerted coordinated effort to achieve the organizational mission and objectives (Winston & Patterson, 2006).

Components and Types of Leadership

Several components of leadership have been identified. Leadership is viewed as:

- i. An attribute of personality (symbolic leadership).
- ii. A status, title or position recognized in a formal organizational chart (formal leadership).
- iii. Functional role performed in an organized group (functional leadership).

Hence, leadership is exercised by the people occupying formal positions as well as others who wield a lot of influence and power, yet they do not occupy formal positions of leadership. Leadership also implies the existence of followers for without them, there would not be any leadership. The components of leadership constitute three elements namely:

- i. An attribute of an office or position;

- ii. A characteristic of a person; and
- iii. A category of actual behaviour

Types of Leadership

These types of leadership include:

- 1) Formal leadership
- 2) Symbolic leadership
- 3) Functional leadership

Formal leadership

Formal leadership derives its strength from having official within an organizational structure.

The leader in a formal organization is the person who occupies a formal leadership position

Knezevich (1975:83) observes that:

The individual occupying given status in the organization or holding a specific title or office or placed in a certain position in the hierarchy or granted special authority in the formal chart of organization is automatically considered a leader. This recognition may disappear when he vacates status, title, position or office.

Therefore, in a school situation, the principal, the deputy principal or head of department occupy formal leadership positions.

Symbolic leadership

Symbolic leadership is leadership which refers to, and is based on, the category of meaning. This meaning becomes tangible and therefore can be experienced in the form of symbols. Earlier writers and researchers have conceived leadership as an attribute of personality. Symbolic leadership practices that are used to influence followers in organizations include symbols, such

as, myths and metaphors, stories and tales, rituals and ceremonies. According to Knezevich (1975:82), symbolic view of leadership postulates that:

“Leaders are born not made,” that is, some have it, some don’t. The leader stimulates and unifies the activities of others along certain paths because of the ways s/he looks and his/her personality. This is charismatic approach to leadership and bears a strong kinship to trait psychology.

Neuberger (1995/2002) states that the concept of symbolic leadership implies the following:

- i) Leadership as symbolized: This means that past leadership behaviour resulted in structures, rules and procedures as well as organizational practices that guide the behaviour of followers. It means that leaders can use past experiences to resolve current issues by using symbolic and mythical forms;
- ii) Leadership as symbolic: Leaders change the meaning of the existing aspects of the organizational world or offer new meaning for new facts. Thus, leaders influence their followers through their actions and reward systems, organizational principles and rules, work content and practices.

Functional Leadership

Leadership can also be viewed in terms of the functions one is performing or is expected to perform in the group. In other words, the criterion for leadership is based on what the leader does to help the group define its goals, achieve its objectives or maintain its strengths as a body. Unless a person can fulfill one or more of these group functions, s/he is not a functional leader no matter how charming his personality or how impressive the title of his/her position.

Functional leadership is therefore an attempt to conceptualize leadership in terms of the functions the leader is performing rather than considering:

- i. His/her personal attributes and/or characteristics.
- ii. The position one is occupying in the organization.

According to Knezevich (1975), leadership emerges as a group phenomenon in relation to the function the person is performing that is regarded essential in organized groups. Theoretically, functional leadership focuses on how leadership occurs within an organization rather than a collection of traits that characterize an individual (Spradlin, 2017). In functional leadership, the leader's main job is to see that whatever is necessary to group needs is taken care of. Thus, a leader can be said to have done their job well when they have contributed to group effectiveness and cohesion.

Theories of Leadership

Leadership theories may also be referred to as leadership approaches. Some leadership theories have tended to stress the personal characteristics, others stress the situation while others attempt to identify and concentrate on leadership behaviour. There are five categories of leadership which represent the following theories.

1. Traits Theories of Leadership

The traits theory is sometimes referred to as the Great Man's theory. The traits theory postulates that leaders are born and not made. Traits are actually the mental, physical and social characteristics of a leader. According to this theory, effective leaders have in common a pattern of personal heredity attributes, characteristics, qualities or traits that support their ability to mobilize others toward a shared vision. The general leadership traits include dimensions of

personality and motives, sets of skills and capabilities, and behaviours and social relationships. Specifically, leadership constitutes possession of immense ability to communicate, commanding voice and an imposing personality. The trait theory concentrated on the following factors:

- i. Physical factors such as age, height, weight, physique, health and appearance;
- ii. Ability factors such as fluency of speech, tone of voice, academic performance, intelligence, judgment and decision, insight and initiative; and
- iii. Personality attributes such as integrity, emotional control, self-confidence and popularity.

Attempts have been made to identify traits consistently associated with leadership. Six traits on which leaders differ from non-leaders include:

- i. Drive and ambition;
- ii. Honesty and integrity;
- iii. The desire to lead and influence others;
- iv. Self-confidence;
- v. Intelligence; and
- vi. In-depth technical knowledge related to their area of responsibility.

Stogdill in Hoy and Miskel (1987) summarizes some of the personal factors associated with the trait theory of leadership. These factors include the following:

- i. Capacity (intelligence, alertness, verbal facility, originality, judgment);
- ii. Achievement (scholarship, knowledge, athletic or accomplishment);
- iii. Responsibility (dependability, initiative, persistence, aggressiveness, self-confidence, desire to excel);
- iv. Participation (activity, sociability, cooperation, adaptability); and
- v. Status (socio-economic position, popularity).

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Earlier studies on traits associated with leadership were trying to isolate unique traits that could differentiate leaders from non-leaders. These studies discouraged many for lack of successful researchers. However, the studies continued to be conducted as industrial psychologists were still interested in improving the selection of managers. The emphasis shifted from comparing the traits of leaders and non-leaders to the focus on traits that resulted to leader effectiveness. Hence, the trait studies henceforth tended to focus on the relationship between traits and leadership effectiveness of managers (Hoy and Miskel, 1987).

The following are the traits, identified in several later studies that led to leader effectiveness (Stogdill in Hoy and Miskel, 1987):

- i. A strong drive for responsibility and task completion;
- ii. Vigour and persistence in pursuit of goals;
- iii. Venture, originality and soresness;
- iv. Drive to exercise initiative in social setting;
- v. Self-confidence and sense of personal identity;
- vi. Willingness to accept consequences of decision and action;
- vii. Readiness to tolerate frustration and delay;
- viii. Ability to influence other person's behaviour; and
- ix. Capacity to structure interaction system to the purpose at hand.

Drawbacks of the Trait Theory

The four limitations of the trait theory of leadership as include:

- i. There are no universal traits that predict about leadership in all situations;

- ii. The predicted traits are in “weak” situation rather than “strong” situations. That is, in strong situation, leaders have little opportunity to express (display) interest dispositional tendencies.
- iii. The cause and effect are not separated by evidence provided, for instance, does self-confidence create leadership, or does success as a leader build self-confidence.
- iv. Traits tend to predict the appearance of leadership rather than distinguish between effective and ineffective leaders. That is, an individual may exhibit traits associated with leadership by others yet s/he may be unsuccessful as a leader in accomplishing organizational goals and objectives.

2. Situational Theories of Leadership

The situational theory of leadership posits that no single leadership is best but rather depends on which type of leadership and strategies are best suited to the task and the prevailing situation. This theory refutes the claim made by the trait theory that leaders can be identified by portraying a set of traits or characteristics unique to them. It advances that traits alone do not make or cause a person to be a leader. It affirms that leaders are made but not born. It argues that a particular situation or environment will dictate the kind of leadership suited to it. Hence, a person may be an effective leader in one situation or environment, but an ineffective one in another). Situational theories of leadership work on the assumption that the most effective style of leadership changes from situation to situation and to be most effective, a leader must be able to adapt his/her style and approach to diverse circumstances.

According to Hoy and Miskel (1987), the following are the situational variables or determinants of leadership that have been postulated:

- 1) Structural properties of the organization (size, hierarchical structure, formalization);
- 2) Organizational climate (openness, participation, group atmosphere);
- 3) Role characteristics (position power, type and differentiation of task, procedural roles); and
- 4) Subordinate characteristics (knowledge and experience, tolerance for ambiguity, responsibility and power).

3. Contingency Theories of Leadership

This theory holds that traits, situations and the task to be performed all combine to determine leadership. This implies that leadership is a combination of three elements. Contingency theories tried to predict which types of leadership style/s will be most effective in different types of situations. Contingency approaches hypothesized that there are no universally acceptable styles of leadership. A leadership style may prove valid in one situation, yet ineffective in another. Hence, discrete factors in the situation influence leadership. Leadership must change with the situation or the situation must change to accommodate the kind of leadership exercised. According to the contingency theorists, it is necessary to specify the conditions or situational variables that moderate the relationship between leader traits or behaviours and performance criterion. Fiedler's Contingency Model and House's Path-Goal Model exemplify contingency theories of leadership.

i. Fiedler's Contingency Model

Fiedler's contingency model was developed by an Australian psychologist Fred Edward Fiedler in his landmark 1964 article, "A Contingency Model of Leadership Effectiveness". His model emphasizes the importance of both the leader's personality and the situation in which that leader

operates. His model proposed that effective group performance depends on the proper match between the leader's style of interacting with his/her subordinates and the degree to which the situation gives control and influence to the leader. Fiedler identifies two situational variables in his contingency theory.

The situation in which the leader operates is the first key variable and is characterized by the following three factors:

- a) Leader-member relations: It deals with the general atmosphere of the group and the feelings it has about the leader. In particular, it focuses on the degree of confidence, loyalty, trust and respect subordinates have for their leader.
- b) Task structure-It relates to task clarity and the means to task accomplishment. In particular, it focuses on the degree to which the subordinates' assignments are structured or unstructured or the degree to which the subordinates' tasks are clear or ambiguous.
- c) Position power- It relates to the amount of reward-punishment authority the leader has over members of the group. In particular, it deals with the degree of influence a leader has over power variables such as hiring, firing, discipline, promotions and salary increases. This is the amount of power attached to the leader's position.

The second variable in Fiedler's contingency model is the leader. Fiedler suggests two (2) basic leader orientations as follows:

- a) Relationship oriented-The leader is more variant and people-oriented.
- b) Task oriented-The leader is concerned with task completion

Essentially, Fiedler contends that leadership performance depends as much upon the organization as it depends upon the leader's own attributes. Moreover, except perhaps for the unusual case, it is simply not meaningful to speak of an effective or an ineffective leader. Instead, we can only

speak of a leader's tendency to be effective in one situation and ineffective in another. If the wish is to increase organizational and group effectiveness, then effective training of leaders is as essential as building an organizational environment in which the leader can perform well.

a. House's Path-Goal Theory

One of the most respected approaches to leadership is the path-goal theory. This theory was developed by Robert House. The Path-Goal model can best be thought of as a process in which leaders select specific behaviours that are best suited to the employees' needs and their working environment so that they may guide employees through their path in the obtainment of their daily work goals or activities. The goal is to increase employees' motivation, empowerment and satisfaction so they become productive members of the organization. This theory points that it is the leader's job to assist his/her followers in attaining their goals and to provide the direction or support or both needed to ensure that their goals are compatible with the overall objectives of the group or the organization. The term path-goal is derived from the belief that effective leaders clarify the path to help their followers get from where they are to the achievement of their work goals and make the journey along easier by reducing roadblocks and pit falls. The path-goal model, therefore, integrates the concepts of leader behaviour and situational favorableness with a unique definition of effectiveness.

4. Behavioral Leadership Theory

The behavioral leadership theory focuses on how leaders behave and assumes that these traits can be copied by other leaders. Sometimes called the style theory, it suggests that leaders aren't born successful, but can be created based on learnable behaviour. Behavioral theories of leadership focus heavily on the actions of a leader. It suggests that the best predictor of

leadership success is viewing how a leader acts. Action rather than qualities are the focal points of behavioral learning theory. Patterns of behaviour are observed and categorized as “styles of leadership” in this theory. Some of the styles of leadership include task-oriented leaders, people-oriented leaders, country club leaders, status-quo leaders and dictatorial leaders among others. At the end of the day, the actions and actual behaviours of a leader are what define leadership success in this theory.

Other theories of leadership include functional leadership theory and group dynamics leadership theory

Styles of Leadership and Management

The method or style of leadership used by a manager influences his/her effectiveness as a leader and affects the achievement of organizational goals and objectives. Hence, it is imperative that managers should gain knowledge of the various leadership styles that have been used in organizational management. This appreciation will enable the managers to comprehend the strengths and weaknesses associated with each specific style and make a rational choice and execution. The following are some of the leadership styles that have been identified by various scholars.

1. Autocratic/authoritarian leadership style

This style centralizes power and authority in the management and purposes to achieve high productivity in the organization. It does not involve workers in decision making processes. Being task-oriented, the management uses workers as machines to effect productivity. It dictates in order to accomplish the determined organizational goals and coerces the workers to perform the roles they are given. An autocratic leader more often than not has absolute power and as a result, s/he tends to be dictatorial and sidelines others on all organizational matters. The authoritative

leader wields a lot of power over the subordinates since s/he is in a position to use rewards, praise, or fear of criticism or punishment. Autocratic leadership is characterized by individual control and little input from group members. Autocratic leaders typically make choices based on their ideas and judgments and rarely accept advice from followers while at the same time exhibiting absolute authoritarian control over the group.

Characteristics of an Autocratic Leader

The characteristics of authoritarian leaders are as follows:

- 1) They are strong-willed, domineering and to some extent aggressive.
- 2) They must have their own way, which for them seems to be the only way.
- 3) They look upon subordinates more as functionaries than as persons, and the best subordinates in their estimation, follow directions without questions.
- 4) Ordinarily they are not ready to listen to views and suggestions of others.
- 5) They do not engage in equal relationships with workers or employees, that is, “adult to adult engagement”. They also do not like to see employees getting close to see each other. To them such cliques of workers might endanger their authority.
- 6) They have business like and task-oriented attitudes.
- 7) They generally blame poor results on the inability of others to carry out instructions correctly

Characteristics of an Organization with Autocratic Leadership

An organization with autocratic leadership exhibits the following characteristics:

- 1) Power and authority are centralized on the leader.
- 2) The leader tends to be dictatorial, that is, s/he gives orders and instructions to the employees and expects them to obey without questioning. Violation of orders is heavily punished.

- 3) The leader sets policy and structures, interprets and modifies tasks as s/he wants.
- 4) The leader does not consult his/her followers on important matters, for instance, on policies, rules, definition of tasks, task structure and so on.
- 5) The leader makes decisions without any consultations.
- 6) Rules are very harsh.
- 7) Employees are closely supervised, controlled and directed.
- 8) There is top-down communication flow.
- 9) There is little consideration for employees' needs and interests, for instance, when assigning tasks.

Advantages of Autocratic Leadership

The following are the merits of autocratic leadership:

- 1) Decisions are made very first since the leader does not consult or consider employees' opinions, needs, desires and interests.
- 2) Work is accomplished quickly because the employees are expected to perform work without questioning. Employees are harshly dealt with when they fail to perform work as expected.
- 3) Autocratic leadership is suitable for uncommitted workers especially those who neglect their work or absent themselves from work frequently.

Disadvantages of Autocratic Leadership

The following are the demerits of autocratic leadership.

- 1) It creates low work morale. The workers feel frustrated and demoralized since the leader has little or no regard for their needs and interests.
- 2) Workers are expected to give unquestionable support to the leader whether they agree with him or not and failure to support the leader results in punishment.

- 3) Leaders tend to over control and over direct employees even when it is not necessary. This may lead to feelings of dissatisfaction and employees may even rebel against the leader.
- 4) The leader sets policies, regulations, structure and also sets and modifies tasks without consulting members of the organization. This may result in harsh rules, policies and working conditions.
- 5) Decisions reached may be poor since the leader do not consult employees even though s/he may lack information, expertise, skill and knowledge on the matter. This may, for instance, be in the case excluding the technician's input in buying some electronic gadgets that may require the technician's expertise.
- 6) Turnover of staff may result hindering the achievement of organizational goals and objectives. In a school situation, for instance, students may fail to learn effectively due to frequent transfers and turnover of staff which may consequently result to poor academic achievement.

2. Democratic (Participative) Leadership or Management Style

The democratic leadership style is also referred to as the participative leadership style. A democratic leader is one who invites participation of others in in the organization as part of the decision making process. This style first considers the needs, interests, rights, and freedom of the workers. The employees (workers) are given substantial amount of freedom and say and are involved in decision-making. They are also involved in all other matters concerning the organization and as a result of this involvement, the leader receives more cooperation from employees in the achievement of organizational objectives. In this leadership style, the management influences the subordinates, but it does not determine their thinking. It offers

suggestions rather than issue orders. The management acts as a facilitator and providers of information rather than being authoritarian and praises rather than criticizes workers.

Characteristics of Democratic (Participative) Leadership or Management

The characteristics of participative leaders are as follows:

- 1) They are generally concerned with maintaining group effectiveness as well as task completion.
- 2) They encourage members in their groups to express their ideas and feelings because they believe that such a climate leads to creativity and commitment.
- 3) If they encounter resistance or conflict, they allow them to surface and seek the help of those groups in removing resistance or resolving the conflict.
- 4) They encourage joint decision-making as well as shared goal setting.
- 5) They rarely set policies without explaining the reasons, and proposing them to their groups, when they can, for suggestions and criticism.
- 6) They believe that responsibility for getting a job done depends as much as on the group as upon themselves. They try to disseminate this attitude and have it shared by all group members.
- 7) They allow group members a good deal of freedom in their work once they have shown their ability to do it.
- 8) They keep looking for better ways of doing things, and are open to change when they are convinced that such changes seem called for and would lead to greater effectiveness.
- 9) They believe in the effectiveness of group work. They also believe that groups of concerned individuals working together have greater potential than when those same group members work as individuals.

Characteristics of an organization with Democratic Leadership or Management

A democratic organization exhibits the following characteristics:

1. A democratic leader is chosen through popular election or is appointed because of ability and qualifications.
2. The people's basic needs, rights and freedoms are guaranteed and respected by the organization; hence, the leader is able to obtain workers cooperation in achieving organizational goals and objectives.
3. The democratic leader recognizes the fact that his/her followers are capable of making good decisions and suggestions based on their training and experiences. Hence, s/he allows them to participate in decision making. It is therefore assumed that workers will support decisions that they have helped to make and that consequently this will lead to accomplishment of organizational goals and objectives.
4. Ideas are exchanged between a democratic leader and his/her workers and also among the workers themselves. A democratic organization is more likely to be better organized and more effectively run than an autocratic one since ideas are contributed by many people. In democratic leadership, power and authority are decentralized unlike in autocratic leadership style. This implies that power and authority are derived from both the leader and the led.
5. The followers are consulted on important matters concerning decisions, policies, rules, structure, definition of tasks and so on. They are also generally informed about their working conditions.
6. There is a good and harmonious inter-personal relations between the leader and workers. The morale is high and there is job satisfaction. Workers also do not over depend on the leader.

7. Decisions on organizational matters are reached after necessary consultations and communication with various sections and people in the organization

Advantages of Democratic Leadership or Management Style

The following are the advantages of democratic (participative) leadership style.

1. The workers' job morale is high
2. There is commitment and team effort towards accomplishment of organizational goals and objectives.
3. The employees are allowed to participate in decision making and their ideas are appreciated and considered in all matters.
4. Inter-personal relations between the manager and the workers are good and cordial.
5. Organizational communication is good and effective.
6. There is considerable delegation of authority and decision making.

Disadvantages of Democratic Leadership or Management Style

The demerits of participative leadership style are as follows:

1. The employees with weak self- motivation and poor work morale may relax.
2. The organizational decisions may be delayed due to too many consultations.
3. Production may be low if there are too many considerations, for instance, if teachers request to teach their preferred subjects and not the ones the school authorities would prefer.
4. Students may fail examinations if, for example, weak teachers are not controlled and directed to some extent to ensure schemes of work and lesson plans are well written.
5. Poor decisions resulting from taking into account everyone's wishes may lead to low productivity.

3. Laissez Faire Leadership or Management Style

This leadership style is also referred to as delegative, free rein or free style of leadership. It is a style that assesses the unique talents of each employee, and assigns responsibilities accordingly. As long as the actions of an employee are not adversely affecting the organization, they are allowed to apply their skills and ideas to complete their tasks how they deem fit. This style implies that everybody may do as they want. There is no leader in an organization that adopts this style. This kind of organization avoids the use of power and the management's role is limited. Moreover, it binds itself to no code of regulations. It makes extensive use of unnecessary committees. These committees set goals which no one feels bound to adhere to, since there is no hierarchy of authority, the leader is merely a symbol.

In this style of leadership, the symbolic leader does not provide external motivation as in the case of autocratic or democratic leadership. The workers are instead left to motivate themselves based on their needs, interests, wants and desires. They are given a goal and left mostly on their own to achieve it using their ingenuity

Characteristics of an Organization with Laissez Faire Leadership or Management

The following are the characteristics of an organization with a laissez Faire leader.

1. The leader has very little authority and power and s/he tends to be very tolerant.
2. There are very few rules and regulations and there is no code of conduct for workers.
3. The leader assumes the role of group member rather than that of a leader, that is, the employees see him/her as being on the same organizational level and consequently s/he has very little influence on them.
4. The leader does not provide external motivation but instead the workers are left to motivate themselves according to their ability, needs, interests and desires.

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5. Employees tend to work independently of the leader and there are also very few committed workers. At best, the leader only assigns tasks and leaves employees to accomplish them on their own.
6. Accomplishment of task goals depends on individual effort, expertise and knowledge.

Advantages of Laissez Faire Leadership or Management Style

The following are the merits of Laissez Faire leadership style.

1. Mature people feel free to do what they want to do and this increases workers' independence, expression and allows them to function as group members.
2. Conscientious workers provide their own motivation in creativity, invention, discovery, exploration and so on, since they work independently without unnecessary control to achieve self-actualization.
3. Decisions are easily accepted since every worker's decision is assumed to be the best for the group.

Disadvantages of Laissez Faire Leadership or Management Style

The demerits of Laissez Faire Leadership style are summarized as follows:

1. Lack of a strong leader can result in lack of direction and control and can easily result in chaos and conflicts.
2. Workers can easily become frustrated, insecure and demoralized due to lack of guidance from the leader.
3. Organizational goals may never be realized.
4. There is high rate of unhealthy competition among workers or members of the group.

4. Traditional leadership Style

Traditional leadership is a style where power is given to the leader based on traditions of the past. Current examples would be kings, dictators and many of today's business leaders. In the past, almost all leaders were considered traditional and their power was tied to their past leaders. Many of these leaders inherited their power from their predecessors. Today, traditional leaders rise to power through large organizations.

5. Transactional Leadership Style

Transactional or telling leadership involves motivating and directing followers primarily through appealing to their own self-interest. The power of transactional leaders comes from their formal authority and responsibility in the organization. The main goal of the follower is to obey the instructions of the leader. The transactional leadership style is more concerned with maintaining the normal flow of operations. The leader believes in motivating the workers through a system of rewards and punishment. In this kind of leadership, the exchange between the leader and the follower takes place to achieve routine performance goals. It's a kind of an inflexible leadership style. Transactional leadership exhibits the following characteristics:

- a. It offers extrinsic motivation;
- b. It encourages practicality;
- c. Its resistant to change;
- d. It discourages independent thinking;
- e. It rewards performance;
- f. It constrains thinking;
- g. It is passive;

- h. It is directive;
- i. It emphasizes corporate structure; and
- j. It emphasizes self-interest.

This style combines the nomothetic and ideographic leadership styles. It balances personal needs with organizational demands within a given situation.

6. Transformational Leadership Style

A transformational leader goes beyond managing day-to-day operations and crafts strategies for taking the organization or department to the next level of performance and success such as through team building, motivating and collaboration with employees at different levels to accomplish change for the better. Transformational leadership focuses on increasing employee motivation and engagement and attempts to link employees' sense of self with organizational values.

. Transformational leadership serves to enhance the motivation, morale and job performance of followers through a variety of mechanisms. These mechanisms include:

- i) Connecting the followers' sense of identity and self to a project and to the collective identity of the organization.
- ii) Being a role model for followers in order to inspire them and to raise their interest in the project.
- iii) Challenging followers to take greater ownership for their work, and understanding the strengths and weaknesses of followers, which allows the leader to align followers with tasks that enhance their performance.

The characteristics of transformational leadership include idealized influence, inspirational motivation, individualized motivation and intellectual stimulation. Transformational leaders are strong in the abilities to adapt to different situations, share a collective consciousness, self-manage and be inspirational while leading a group of employees. Transformational leadership is when leader's behavior influence followers and inspire them to perform beyond their perceived capabilities.

7. Strategic Leadership Style

Strategic leadership style refers to a manager's potential to express a strategic vision for the organization, or a part of the organization, and to motivate and persuade others to acquire that vision. Strategic leadership can also be defined as utilizing strategy in the management of employees. It is the potential to influence organizational members and to execute organizational change. Strategic leaders encourage the employees in an organization to follow their own ideas. Strategic leaders make great use of reward and incentive system for encouraging productivity and quality employees to show much better performance for their organization. Strategic leadership requires the potential to foresee and comprehend the work environment. It requires objectivity and potential to look at the broader picture.

Some qualities of effective strategic leadership include:

- i. Loyalty to their vision through their words and actions;
- ii. Keeping themselves updated about what is happening within the organizations;
- iii. Judicious and skillful use of power to develop consent for their ideas rather imposing their ideas upon others;
- iv. Possession of wider perspective and outlook with knowledge about many things beyond own specialty;

- v. Motivated beyond money and power towards vision pursuit and goal achievement;
- vi. Compassionate and understanding of subordinates' views and feelings and decide accordingly;
- vii. Self-control against distracting moods and desires;
- viii. Social skills with a great possession of friendliness and warmth;
- ix. Readiness to delegate and authorize to motivate employees to whom authority is delegated;
- x. Articulacy to communicate the vision of where the organization should head; and
- xi. Constancy and reliability by conveying their vision constantly until it becomes a component of organizational culture.

Disadvantages of strategic leadership style include:

- i. It's a very complex process involving continuous assessment of critical elements such as external environment, short-term and long term objectives, organizational structure, strategic control etc.;
- ii. Time consuming in terms of preparing, researching and communicating the strategic management process;
- iii. Difficult to implement requiring a clearly communicated plan, implemented in a way that requires full attention, active participation, and accountability of leaders and other members of the organization; and
- iv. Requires skillful planning to meet the complexity of its demands, with an organization needing to anticipate the future which involves various degrees of change as well as risks.

Other kinds of leadership styles include charismatic leadership style, nomothetic leadership style, idiographic leadership style, pacesetter leadership style, coaching leadership style, affiliative leadership style, and creative leadership style

Leadership Authority and Power

Authority and power are two distinct elements that are closely associated with leadership of every organization.

Leadership Authority

The term authority has been defined in various ways. However, the definitions are closely linked. The following are some of these definitions:

1. Authority is the right to give an order or direction to a person or group of persons who is/are obligated to obey because of this right (Wengrzn, 2020)
2. Authority is the right to give orders, make decisions and enforce obedience and implies rules, command, dominance or charge (Gharbi, 2018).
3. Wanjau (2005) provides the following definitions of authority.
 - i) Authority is the right to commit resources in particular courses of organizational action.
 - ii) Authority is the probability that certain specific commands, or all commands, from a given source will be obeyed by a given group of persons.
 - iii) Authority is the right conferred on an individual to make decisions and ensure that these decisions are followed.

This text defines authority as the recognized and respected right conferred on an individual to commit resources, issue certain specific commands, instructions and directives, and to make

decisions aimed at ensuring certain courses of actions are executed to accomplish organizational goals and objectives.

Types of Authority

The following is a discussion of each of these types of authority.

a) Formal Authority

This kind of authority emanates from one's legal position in the organization. It has its source in the constitution, the education acts, court decisions and so on. The person in this formal leadership position has authority to issue commands and directives to other workers in accordance to the rules and regulations. It is expected that when one joins an organization, then s/he is expected to obey his/her superior within certain acceptable limits. Formal authority usually flows from those in leadership positions to those in lower ranks.

Formal authority results from the official appointment to a position. The command, directives and instructions of the school principal, for instance, are obeyed because the rules and the law state that s/he is competent to issue such commands, directives and instructions. In Kenya, the law governing all aspects of education is based on the constitution and the education acts. The 2013 basic education act of parliament, for instance, guides provision of basic education in Kenya and its governance (Republic of Kenya, 2013). In educational institutions, there are circulars, memos, bulletins, and instructions which the members are supposed to abide by. The school principals have formal authority by virtue of occupying the position of the school head. Other teachers, pupils and essential staff are expected to obey his/her directives and instructions under certain acceptable limits. Nevertheless, it is significant to note that teachers, students and essential staff are not expected to agree to the principal's demands if these demands are unacceptable. Such demands may include luring students into a sexual relationship. Bearers of

formal authority also need to possess some informal authority. Rankin (2017), for instance, observes that a leader holding formal authority only without informal authority will have more management problems than the one endowed with both.

b) Charismatic Authority

Charismatic authority is influence legitimized by leaders' exceptional personal qualities which inspire loyalty and obedience from followers. Charismatic authority emanates from informal attributes such as unique personal qualities and characteristics or the charisma of an individual. These features include physical factors such as strength or beauty, knowledge, ability, skill, status, age and sex. Charismatic authority stems from appealing personal characteristic such as knowledge, ability, status, role, personality, age, seniority, sex and skill. Charismatic leaders' authority is legitimized through the overwhelming devotion vowed to them by their followers. Britannica (2020) asserts that the charismatic leader by virtue of the extraordinary personal qualities attributed to him/her is able to create a group of followers who are willing to break established rules.

Moreover, charismatic authority tends to be non-rational, affective or emotional. It rests heavily on the leader's personal qualities and characteristics. In a school, for instance, there are some members who do not possess legal authority over school matters but because of their personality and status in the community, they have greater influence on matters affecting education in Kenya. Whenever such informal authority coincides with formal authority, the school benefits considerably.

c) Traditional Authority

Traditional authority refers to a form of leadership in which authority derives from traditional beliefs and customs. Obedience is owed to the traditionally sanctioned position of authority and inherits the authority established by past custom. Hence, this authority emanates from traditions, beliefs and culture. Traditional authority is anchored in an established belief in the sanctity of the status of those exercising authority in the past. Obedience is owed to the traditionally sanctioned position of authority and the person who occupies the position inherits the authority established by custom. In traditional African societies, for instance, medicine men, circumcisers, midwives and so on were obeyed without any questioning. They were believed to possess certain special inherited gifts and talents that constituted the basis of their traditional authority. People adhere to traditional authority because they have/are invested in the past and feel to perpetuate it.

d) Legal Authority (Laws, Statutes, Decrees, Constitution, Court Decision)

Legal authority is any published source of law that presents the legal rules, legal doctrine, or legal reasoning that may be used as the basis for legal decisions. Authority also includes the weight or degree of persuasiveness of the legal information. The source of this authority is the law and can only be changed by formally correct procedures. Obedience is to the laws that specify to whom and to the extent of compliance. Primary legal authorities are authorized statements of the law by government institutions. Examples of primary sources of legal authority include administrative rule, code, constitution, court opinion, court rule, regulation, session law, and statute. Secondary authorities are statements about the law and explain, interpret, develop, locate or update primary authorities. Treaties, law review articles, restatements of the law are types of secondary authorities. Legal authority can further be divided into the following:

i) Line Authority

Line authority stipulates the relationship between the manager and the employees with the former having direct supervisory authority over the latter within a top down communication framework.

ii) Staff Authority

Staff authority is the provision of advice and other services to line managers. Examples of staff positions are accounting, finance, purchasing, management information systems and taxation. Similarly, staff authority belongs to those individuals or groups in an organization who provide expert advice and services to line managers.

e) Functional Authority

Functional authority is permission to issue directions to people not under line supervision to deal with specified activities or certain aspects of an organization. It is authority that is given to either a line or staff manager to do a specific job and ceases when the particular task has been completed. This authority is one that is limited to the function one is performing at a given time or situation. This kind of authority emanates from one's competence or technical skills. Functional authority is that right which is delegated to an individual or a department to control specified functional processes, practices, policies or other matters about activities undertaken by persons in other departments.

f) Acceptance Authority

Acceptance theory of authority states that a manager's authority rests on workers' acceptance of his rights to give orders, directives and instructions and expect compliance. The acceptance of the manager's authority by the subordinates thus vests the latter with authority. The flow of

authority takes the form of request by top managers. If this request is accepted by subordinates, managers exercise authority and vice versa. Hence, acceptance authority can be viewed as a subordinates' resource or residing with them. Although any manager may have legal authority, the subordinates possess authority too. Unless the subordinates accept the legal authority of superiors, then the superiors have no authority over them. They can reject his/her decisions, commands, directives, and instructions. In order for the subordinates to accept the authority of the manager, then the decisions, commands, directives or instructions that they receive must be within their "zones of acceptance", and vice-versa. The challenge is for the manager to seek acceptance of his/her subordinates.

g) Situational Authority

The situational theory of leadership postulates that effective leaders are those who are able to adapt their style to the situation and look at cues such as the type of task, the nature of the group and other factors that might contribute to getting the job done. Hence, in some cases, situations dictate what people do and such leadership is endowed with situational authority. If a student in a boarding school, for instance, gets seriously sick at night in the absence of the principal and the deputy principal, any teacher or other member of staff assumes authority and acts.

Leadership Power

Power is an important dimension in leadership just like authority. The following are some definitions of power:

1. Leadership power is the influence that leaders have over their followers by persuading the followers to support their efforts and do as they ask (Indeed Career Guide, 2020).

2. Power is an entity's or individual's ability to control or direct others to get them to comply with what the entity or the individual wants (Lumen, 2020).
3. Wanjau (2005) provides the following two definitions of power.
 - i) Power is the capacity or ability to make things happen in order to get results.
 - ii) Power can also be defined as the ability to employ sanctions or force or to give rewards in an effort to have something or make others do something.

In this text, power is defined as the ability of a leader to make things happen through coercion, imposition of sanctions, or through offering rewards in order to stimulate employees to act or behave appropriately towards the realization of the required results, in this case the organizational goals and objectives.

Types of Leadership Power

The following is a detailed description and discussion of these types of power bases.

a) Coercive Power

Coercive power is being dependent on fear. It is the ability of a manager to force an employee to follow an order by threatening the employee with punishment if the employee does not comply with the order. One reacts to this kind of power out of fear of negative results that might result if one fails to comply. Coercive power is obtained through threatening others. It is conveyed through fear of losing one's job, being demoted, receiving poor performance review or having prime projects taken away. This kind of power is primarily based on use of forceful means to make others obey. The holder of this power has the ability to inflict punishment or negative consequences on another person. S/he may cause this through physical means such as corporal punishment. This kind of power may be exhibited through use of physical strength, verbal facility or ability to grant or withhold emotional support. In a school situation, detention,

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suspension and expulsion are some of the techniques that can make students comply with school management's orders, rules, directives and policies. On the other hand threats of being demoted, transferred and reprimand are some of the forceful means that can be used on staff to make them comply with the demands of the school management.

b) Reward power

Reward power is the opposite of coercive power. It is the use of rewards to get an employee to follow an instruction or order. This power comes from one's ability to withhold the reward for noncompliance. Hence, reward power is conveyed through rewarding individuals for compliance with one's wishes. This may be done through giving bonuses, salary raises, promotions, extra time off from work, fringe benefits and other kinds of beneficial allowances. People comply with the wishes or directives of another person because doing so produces positive effects or benefits. Hence, one who can distribute rewards that others view as valuable has power over them and is therefore able to induce others to comply with what s/he wants. These rewards can be anything that another person values. This is the type of positive power which the manager or the school head has and uses to withhold, grant or/and increase rewards.

c) Legitimate power

Legitimate power is the power you derive from your formal position or office in the organization's hierarchy of authority and is based on perception and reality. It is based on the reality that that a manager holds a particular position in an organization and the perception that by holding that position, the manager has the capacity to exert control over employees. Legitimate power emanates from occupation of a position of power in an organization such as being the chief executive or manager or a key member of a team. Accordingly, positions of authority include coercive and reward powers but it is broader since it includes acceptance of the

authority of a position by members of an organization. This kind of power is perceived by the subordinates as essential to the potential leader. It is a value internalized in the leader. The leader is acceptable because s/he has legitimate right to influence others.

d) Expert power

This is a kind of personal power. Expert power is the perception that a certain person has an elevated level of knowledge, skill set and expertise that others in an organization do not have. This perception leads to more influence within the expert's workplace or area of jurisdiction. Similarly, expert power is influence wielded as a result of unique and rare expertise, special skill/s, knowledge or experience. In the same tone, a person who possesses knowledge, skills, and/or expertise has "expert power" over others who require it or want to benefit from it. Expertise has become one of the most powerful sources of influence as the world has become more technologically oriented.

As we gain knowledge, skills and experience in particular areas, we begin to gather expert power that can be utilized to get others to help us meet our goals (Quick Base, 2020). It is almost impossible in one's lifetime not to have engaged some experts in solving certain real life challenges. A principal's school secretary, for instance, may have expert power over his/her boss if the boss does not possess computer knowledge and skills and has to rely on the secretary to retrieve vital information from the computer. Hence, such a principal has legitimate power but lacks expert power under certain circumstances. A leader should therefore strive to possess both legitimate and expert power to be able to influence his/her subordinates towards the achievement of organizational goals and objectives.

e) Referent power

Referent power is the result of a person's perceived attractiveness, worthiness and right to others' respect. It originates from being trusted and respected. One can gain this kind of power when others trust what s/he does and gains respect from followers for how s/he handles situations. The base of referent power is identification with a person who has desirable resources or personal traits. Referent power develops out of the admiration of another person and a desire to be like that person. The admired person is thus said to have referent power over the admirer. Referent power explains why celebrities are paid a lot of money to endorse products in commercials. If you are articulate, domineering, physically imposing or charismatic in an organization, for instance, then you possess personal characteristics that may attract others to follow you and do what you want them to do.

f) Informational Power

Informational power is defined by Raven as the use of information by a supervisor to convince the subordinate to acquiesce. Information power is derived from information knowledge, which is an asset, which a leader possesses to strategically influence the behaviour, attitudes, and values in their favour. It is therefore based upon the persuasiveness or content of a communication and is independent of the influencing individual. A leader possessing such valuable information can make the subordinates do what the leader wants to be accomplished with a promise of divulging the valuable information.

Organizational Motivation

The term motivation is derived from the ancient Latin word 'Movere' which means to move. However, since the concept is used in the study of employee motivation in work settings, this definition is clearly inadequate (Waweru & Ngugi, 2002). The term motivation has been defined in several ways as follows:

1. Motivation is a process that starts with physiological and psychological deficiencies or needs that activates behavior or drive that is aimed at a goal or incentive (Malau, 2005).
2. Motivation is a condition inside us that desires a change, either in the self or the environment (Reeve, 2017).
3. Motivation is that which energizes, directs and sustains human behavior (Waweru & Ngugi, 2002)

Motivation is defined in this text as an individual's strong, complex and constantly fluctuating biological, social and psychological state of deprivation that arouses, guides and sustains his/her actions and behaviours within appropriate trajectories to fulfill goal-directed needs and wants.

The motivation process

The motivation process concerns those processes which produces goal-directed behavior whose basic elements are behaviour (series of activities motivated by desire to achieve a goal), drives/motives (primary energizers of behaviour) and goals (attaining a goal tends to restore physiological or psychological balance). Hence, the motivation process progresses through a series of activities driven by desires/needs/wants which constitutes the starting point of motivation. These drives/motives in turn help in acquiring goals. They generate search behaviour to achieve particular goals that will satisfy the need and lead to reduced tension. It is important to note the following:

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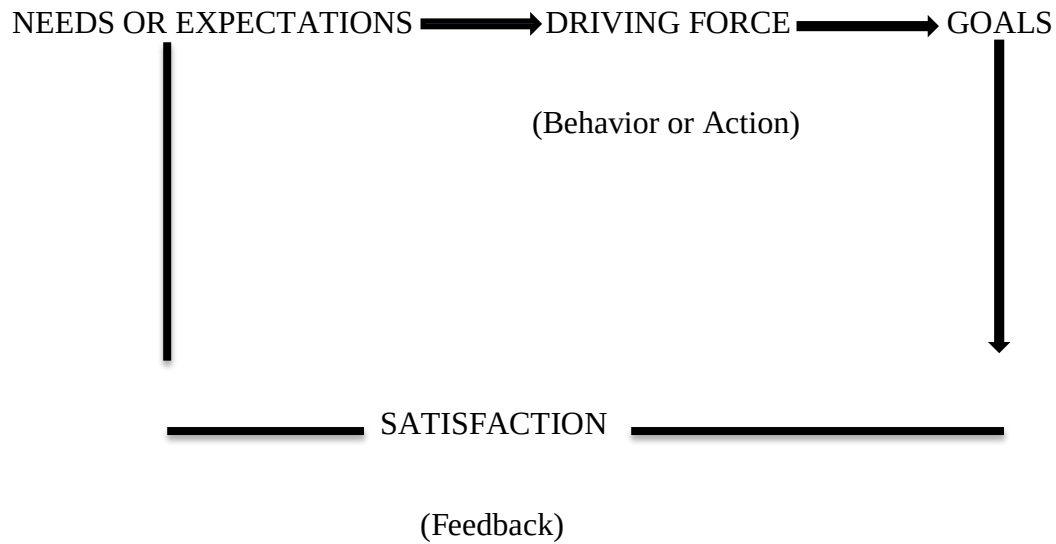
- i) Drives or motives are action-oriented and facilitate goal attainment. They are personal and internal.
- ii) Incentives are found at the end of the motivation cycle. They alleviate a need and thereby reduce the drive (motive).
- iii) Incentives are external to a person. A good example is where;
 - a. Need is water after deprivation of body cells;
 - b. Drive is feeling thirsty; and
 - c. Incentive is acquisition of water to replenish the cells.

It is also important to note that:

- i) A motive is a drive or expression of a person's needs, hence personal and internal.
- ii) Incentives are external and are made part of the work environment by the management in order to encourage workers to perform tasks.

Although motivation models sometimes differ in certain aspects, they tend to share basic assumptions about how behavior is energized, directed and sustained through time. The following is a generalized model of the basic motivational process.

Figure 1: The Motivation Process



Frustration and Motivation

Frustration is the blocking or thwarting of attainment of the desired goal. The strength of frustration in a situation is related to the magnitude of the need that is being thwarted. Frustration leads to defense mechanisms. The following are some of these defense mechanisms.

1. Aggression

This is where goal attainment has been blocked and individual results to hostile behavior. This may be directed against the object or person who s/he feels is the cause of the frustration.

2. Rationalization

This is making excuses for the inability to accomplish a goal when one tends to give an excuse for failure. For instance; one could say “it was my boss’s fault”.

3. Regression

This is a situation whereby an individual adopts childish or aggressive behavior after failing to accomplish a given task. A person, for instance, who cannot start his/her own car proceeds to bang its door or kicks it.

4. Fixation

A person exhibits the same behavior pattern over and over again although experience has shown that it can accomplish nothing. A person, for instance, who has been severely punished over a certain behavior, may become fixated, that is, obsessed with the behaviour irrespective of the repeated punishment.

5. Resignation

This occurs after prolonged frustration, when an individual loses hope for accomplishing his/her goal in a particular situation and decides to withdraw from reality.

6. Denial

Denial occurs when one refuses to accept reality or facts. One blocks external events or circumstances from his/her mind so that s/he don't have to deal with the emotional impact, that is, one avoids the painful feelings or events.

7. Repression

This is the unconscious hiding of unsavory thoughts, painful memories or irrational beliefs that can upset someone in the hope of forgetting them instead of facing them.

8. Displacement

This entails directing strong emotions and frustrations towards a person or object that doesn't feel threatening to satisfy an impulse to react without risking significant consequences.

9. Sublimation

This is a positive defense mechanism since people who rely on it choose to redirect strong emotions or feelings into an object or activity that is appropriate and safe.

10. Reaction formation

People who rely on this defense mechanism recognize how they feel but chose to behave in the opposite manner of their instincts. A person who reacts in this way, for instance, may feel they should not express negative emotions such as anger or frustration but instead react in an overly positive way.

11. Compartmentalization

Separating your life into independent sectors may feel like a way to protect many elements of it. This is, for instance, when you choose not to discuss personal issues at work, you block off, or compartmentalize that element of your life.

12. Intellectualization

This is focusing on quantitative facts by choosing to remove all emotion from one's responses when hit with a trying situation. This is, for instance, when a person who is let go from a job choose to spend their days creating spreadsheets of job opportunities and leads.

13. Projection

Some thoughts or feelings you have about another person may make you uncomfortable. If you project those feelings, you are misattributing to the other person. For instance, you may dislike your new co-worker, but instead of accepting that, you choose to tell yourself that they dislike you. You see in their actions the things you wish you could do or say.

Significance of the Elements of the Motivation Process

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The significance of the elements of the motivation process is as follows:

1. Motives/drives energize and sustain behavior. These motives arouse a person to act.
2. Motives direct and regulate behavior. The motivated behavior moves in a specific direction.

The behavior of an organism is purposeful and persistent.

3. Behavior is selective. The behavior of the motivated organism does not move in a haphazard way. It is directed towards a selective goal which the individual sets for himself/herself. A student, for instance; who is motivated to secure higher grades in the examination concentrates on his/her goal.

Functions of Organizational Motivation

The following are the functions of motivation:

1. Motivation puts human resources into action. Every organization requires physical, financial and human resources to accomplish its goals. It is through motivation that human resources can be utilized to the maximum or to the fullest. This can be done by building willingness in employees to work.
2. Motivation improves level of efficiency of employees. To acquire the best work performance from the employees, the gap between ability and willingness has to be filled which helps in improving their level of performance. This will result into:
 - i) Increased productivity.
 - ii) Reduced cost of operations.
 - iii) Improved overall efficiency.
3. Motivation leads to achievement of organizational goals. The goals of an enterprise can be achieved only when the following factors take place:
 - i) There is best possible utilization of resources.

- ii) There is cooperative work environment.
- iii) The employees are goal-directed and they act in a purposive manner.
- iv) Coordination and cooperation takes place simultaneously which can be effectively done through motivation.

4. Motivation builds friendly relationship. Motivation is an important attribute which brings about employees' satisfaction. This can be done by keeping in mind and framing an incentive plan for the benefit of the employees. In order to build a cordial and friendly atmosphere in the organization, the manager should initiate the following:

- i. Monetary and non-monetary incentives.
- ii. Employees' promotional opportunities.
- iii. Disincentives for inefficient employees.

These initiatives would help in:

- i. Enhancing effective cooperation which brings about stability.
- ii. Reducing industrial dispute and unrest in employees
- iii. Eradicating resistance to change since the employees will be adaptable to the changes.
- iv. Providing a smooth and sound concern in which individual interests will coincide with organizational interests.
- v. Maximizing profit through increased productivity.

5. Motivation leads to stability of workforce. Stability of workforce is very imperative from the point of view of reputation and goodwill of concern. The employees can remain loyal the point of view of reputation and good will of the organization. The employees can remain loyal to the

enterprise only when they have a feeling of participation in its management. The skills and efficiency of employees will always be of advantage to both employers and employees.

Early Theories of Motivation

The 1950s decade was a fruitful period in the development of motivation concepts. Three specific theories were formulated during this period, which though now heavily criticized and their validity called into question, are probably still the best known explanations of employee motivation. These theories are as follows:

- i) Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory;
- ii) McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y; and
- iii) Motivation-hygiene theory by Herzberg.

Understanding of these theories is important for the following reasons:

- i) They represent a foundation from which contemporary theories have developed; and
- ii) Practicing managers regularly use these theories and their terminologies in explaining employee motivation.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Need Motivation Theory

Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory is a motivational theory consisting of five-tier model of human needs, often depicted as hierarchical levels within a pyramid. This theory puts forward the idea that individuals move through a fundamental number of hierarchical motivations, in a unique order, based both upon the physiological and psychological needs. The hierarchy of needs theory is probably the best known approach to motivation. This theory was developed by Abraham Maslow. He wanted to understand the factors which motivated people to work. He looked at the needs people have. Maslow believed that man can work out a better world for mankind as well as for himself or herself. He examined the traditional approach to pain,

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avoidance, pleasure seeking and tension reduction as the major sources of motivating behavior.

He hypothesized that within every human being, there exists a hierarchy of five categories of needs. He argued that as one general type of need is satisfied, another higher order need will emerge and become operative. These needs are broadly classified into two divisions namely:

i. Deficit Needs

The deficit needs include the physiological/basic needs, the safety/security needs and the love/affiliation/belongingness needs.

ii. Growth needs

These needs are associated with an individual's self-development and growth. These needs include self-esteem and self-actualization.

Maslow's Hierarchical Needs

1. Physiological Needs

These are the most potent (powerful) needs. When these needs are deprived for a long period, all other needs fail to appear, and hence one is motivated to do something else. A boy who is deprived of food, for instance, will be motivated to do something to get food. In order to motivate our children to complete their school assignments, we sometimes deprive them of their own privileges such as pocket money and freedom. Physiological needs are actually the fairly apparent basic things that are vital to our survival, such as, food to satisfy hunger, water to satisfy thirst, shelter, sex, sleep, clothes and other bodily needs.

2. Safety (Security) Needs

When physiological needs are successfully fulfilled, then safety needs become dominant. This category of needs is mainly concerned with maintaining order and security. These needs include security and protection from physical and emotional harm. The individual wants more assurance

of job security and protection from physical danger. It is the need for self-preservation and the individual is concerned about the future. A school teacher, for instance, wants to keep his teaching job in order to provide for self and the family. Banking of money, purchase of buildings, land and other investments also makes ones future secure. In schools, formation of welfare groups, cooperative societies also ensures ones secured future.

3. Belongingness, Affiliation and love needs

These are also called social needs. They are needs of making intimate relationships with other members of the society or becoming an accepted member of the society or organization. Human beings need social company. They need other people with whom they can interact and relate their problems to. In other words, people have a desire for association and belonging and want to be accepted by others and earn their approval. These needs include, therefore, the need for affection, a sense of belonging, acceptance and friendship. A school teacher, for instance, naturally wants to make friends, and that is why s/he joins clubs or societies. These needs are dependent on the fulfillment and satisfaction of previous categories of needs.

4. The esteem needs

This needs category can be divided into two as follows:

i) Intrinsic factors

These include needs of autonomy, self-belief, self-respect, self-regard, self-evaluation and achievement.

ii) Extrinsic factors

These needs relate to respect from others and include status, reputation, social acceptance and success, fame, competence, high standards of excellence, feelings of superiority, recognition, attention, control, power and prestige. Failure to gratify self-esteem needs can produce

personality disturbance, that is, inferiority complex results and one may become a social misfit. In a school situation, creating favorable working conditions may help the teaching and essential staff realize their self-esteem needs. A teacher, for instance, must also feel that his/her services are recognized and is respected as an accomplished worker as a social being. If this is not satisfied, the teacher may become destructive. S/he might restrict himself/herself in work restriction and unnecessary arguments with co-workers or the principal of the school.

5. Self –actualization

This is the highest need in the hierarchy. It refers to the realization of a person's full potential, self-fulfillment, seeking personal growth and peak experiences. It is the drive to become what one is capable of becoming. "It is the need to fulfill one's individual nature in all aspects, that is, being what one can be." It arises immediately after the needs for self-esteem have been fulfilled. People who have already fulfilled previous needs now have the desire to acquire competence in their professions. They want to feel important and confident. These needs include growth, achieving one's highest potential and self-fulfillment. A self-actualizing person wants to be and must be free from restraints of the society.

Self-actualized individuals enjoy their jobs and feel satisfied in their social relations in the family, society and their jobs. The following are characteristics of self-actualized individuals.

- i) They demonstrate an efficient perception of reality and acceptance.
- ii) They accept themselves and others.
- iii) They appreciate "basic goods of life."
- iv) They have a sense of humor.
- v) They are democratic in outlook.
- vi) They are achievement-oriented.

Realization and fulfillment of these needs can be enhanced in organizations by:

- i) Recommending individuals to high positions of responsibility.
- ii) Allowing members to participate and contribute creatively in seminars and workshops.
- iii) Giving challenging work to give opportunities for personal growth and advancement.

In a school situation, for instance, a teacher wants to be conversant and feel happy about his/her job. When such a teacher feels satisfied, then as Maslow puts it, s/he has maximized his/her potential. Self-actualized teachers want to be the best in achieving their own personal goals and facilitating the organization's achievement of its goals. They, for instance, feel satisfied if they effectively contribute towards good academic performance of the school in national examinations.

Herzberg's Hygiene-Motivation Theory

This theory is also called two factor theory, dual factor theory, motivation-hygiene theory and motivation-maintenance theory. It was developed by Frederick Herzberg, a psychologist, who was interested in the correlation between employee attitude and workplace motivation. He developed this theory in 1959 by interviewing over 200 professionals. The motivation-hygiene theory is a theory of external motivation because the manager/leader controls the factors which produce job satisfaction or job dissatisfaction. In the belief that an individual's relation to work is basic and that one's attitude towards work can very well determine success or failure, Herzberg investigated what people wanted from their jobs. He conducted a study to determine job factors that were present when the employees felt exceptionally happy or unhappy with their jobs. He asked the workers to describe, in detail, situations in which they felt exceptionally good or

exceptionally bad about their jobs. Interviews conducted with workers revealed two sets of factors originating from two hypotheses stated as follows:

- i) The factors that were present when job satisfaction was produced were separate and distinct from the factors that led to job dissatisfaction.
- ii) The opposite of job satisfaction is no job satisfaction and not job dissatisfaction.

Interviews conducted during the study led to the discovery that “reports of feeling happy were not brought about by the absence of factors that cause dissatisfaction, but instead by the presence of the factors classified as ‘satisfiers’, ‘motivators’ or ‘intrinsic factors’”. Herzberg, therefore, perceived motivational and hygiene factors to be separated into two dimensions affecting separate aspects of job satisfaction. This belief was different from the traditional approach of viewing job satisfaction and job dissatisfaction as opposite ends of the same continuum (Herzberg, 1966). Hygiene factors prevent dissatisfaction but they do not lead to satisfaction. They are necessary only to avoid bad feelings at work. On the other hand, motivators are the real factors that motivate employees at the work place.

Motivation Factors

These factors are also referred to as job satisfaction factors, satisfiers, motivators or intrinsic factors. The following are the factors that promote satisfaction on the part of employees:

- i) Achievement
- ii) Recognition
- iii) Characteristic of the work itself-interesting work
- iv) Responsibility
- v) Advancement
- vi) Growth.

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When these factors fall below an acceptable, they contribute very little to job dissatisfaction but do not prevent job satisfaction. Feelings of unhappiness were not brought about by the absence of the satisfier factors, but by the absence of ‘dissatisfiers’, ‘maintenance’ or ‘extrinsic’ factors. Satisfiers relate to what an employee does.

Hygiene Factors

These set of factors are also called “dissatisfiers”, “maintenance factors” or extrinsic factors”. Hygiene factors describe the employee’s relationship to the context or environment in which s/he performs his/her work. Herzberg’s hygiene factors are as follows:

- i) Company policy and administration
- ii) Technical supervision
- iii) Inter-personal relations with the supervisor
- iv) Working conditions
- v) The salary
- vi) Relationship with subordinates
- vii) Status within the organization
- viii) Relationship with peers
- ix) Security

When hygiene factors fall below what employee considers an acceptable level, s/he becomes dissatisfied. At or above, the acceptable level, dissatisfaction is removed. This leads to a neutral state. Hygiene factors help man to avoid unpleasantness whereas the motivators make people happy with their jobs. Neither will remedying the causes of dissatisfaction create satisfaction nor will adding the factors of job satisfaction eliminate job dissatisfaction..

Herzberg proposed that his findings indicated the existence of a continuum. The opposite of job satisfaction is no job satisfaction and the opposite of job dissatisfaction is no job dissatisfaction. Managers who seek to improve factors that can create job dissatisfaction, therefore, may bring about peace but not necessarily motivation. They will be placating their work force rather than motivating them. Motivation of workers in their job can only be realized by allocating them interesting and challenging tasks, giving them responsibility, achieving and advancing. These are the characteristics that workers find intrinsically rewarding.

Douglas McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y

In the 1960s, a social psychologist called Douglas McGregor developed two contrasting theories that explained how managers' beliefs about what motivates their people can affect their management style. In other words, Douglas McGregor (1960) proposed two distinct views, attitudes, and assumptions about human beings. Theory X represents the first set of views, attitudes and assumptions about human beings and is basically negative. The second set of views, attitudes and assumptions about human beings is basically positive and is referred to as theory Y. McGregor tries to look at the interaction between the individual and the organization. His Theory X and Theory Y are the views, assumptions and attitudes organizational managers hold about workers or employees.

1. McGregor's Theory X

The following are the assumptions of theory X oriented managers.

- i. Workers/Employees inherently dislike work and where possible they will attempt to avoid it. To them it is distasteful.
- ii. Due to the fact that human beings dislike work, they must be coerced, controlled, directed, pushed or threatened with punishment in order to get them to work.

- iii. Employees (workers) shirk responsibility, are not ambitious, prefer to be directed and want security above all other factors associated with work.
- iv. Most people have little capacity for creativity and zeal in solving organizational problems.
- v. Motivation occurs only at the physiological and safety levels.

Advantages and Disadvantages of McGregor's Theory X

Advantages of McGregor's Theory X

- 1. No delays in decision-making
- 2. Employees do not absent themselves from work unnecessarily

Disadvantages of McGregor's Theory X

McGregor's theory X has the following disadvantages:

- 1. Manager has a negative attitude towards workers
- 2. Rigid rules exist in the organization
- 3. It assumes workers are immature, irresponsible and need external controls and close supervision.
- 4. Needs, feelings, opinions and interests occupy a secondary position in the organization while performance efficiency is emphasized.
- 5. There are poor interpersonal relations between managers and the workers.
- 6. Emphasis is on centralization of authority and hence there are no consultations over decisions.
- 7. There is low work output due to threat, external controls and negative attitudes.

2. McGregor's Theory Y

The following are the assumptions of theory Y oriented managers.

- i. Workers (employees) can view work as being as natural as rest or play if the working conditions are favorable. This implies that the expenditure of physical and mental effort is as natural as rest or play.
- ii. External control and the threat of punishment are not the only means of stimulating employees to work.
- iii. A person who is committed to objectives will exercise self-direction, self-control and self-discipline. These self-initiated qualities are often indispensable in achieving organizational goals and objectives.
- iv. The average person under proper conditions learns not only to accept but also to seek responsibility.
- v. Creativity, ingenuity, and imagination in the solution of organizational problems is widely but not narrowly distributed in the population.
- vi. Under the conditions of modern industrial life, the intellectual potentialities of the average human beings are only partially utilized.

Theory Y is an establishment of an environment in which employees can best achieve their own goals and objectives. Hence, the workers have to exercise a large degree of internal motivation. Emphasis of Theory Y is internal motivation which implies that all employees will be motivated by self-esteem and self-actualization needs while on the job and hence exercise self-control.

Advantages and Disadvantages of McGregor's Theory Y

Advantages of McGregor's Theory Y

McGregor's theory Y has the following advantages:

1. Employees are motivated and committed and hence there is high work output.
2. Managers exhibit positive attitude towards employees.
3. The administrator assumes that creativity is widely distributed in people and not just a selected few.
4. There are no rigid rules and regulations but workers are left to self-direct and self-control themselves.
5. There is decentralization of authority which further motivates self-directed and self-controlled workers.
6. There exist good interpersonal relations between the managers and employees, thus less conflicts and high productivity.
7. Management assumes that workers are not passive to organizational needs and goals but an unsupportive environment makes them so.

Disadvantages of McGregor's Theory Y

McGregor's Theory Y has the following disadvantages:

6. Too many consultations may lead to delays in decision making.
7. Managers may be viewed as weak due to many consultations and persuasions.

Qualities of Effective Leadership

The following are some qualities of effective leaders:

- i. Share their vision;
- ii. Lead by example;

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- iii. Demonstrate integrity;
- iv. Communicate effectively;
- v. Make hard decisions;
- vi. Recognize success;
- vii. Empower others; and
- viii. Motivate and inspire others.

Collaborative and Inclusive Learning Environments

Collaborative Learning Environments

Collaborative learning is a situation in which two or more people learn or attempt to learn something together. It refers to methodologies and environments in which learners engage in a common task where each individual depends on and is accountable to each other.

Elements of Collaborative Learning

- i. Positive interdependence: It means the group has a clear task or goal so everyone knows the expected outcome and that the efforts of the group will cause them to either sink or swim together;
- ii. Individual and group accountability: The group is accountable for achieving its goals and each member must be accountable for contributing a fair share of work toward the group's goals;
- iii. Interpersonal and small group skills: These skills are required to function as part of the group. They include knowing how to motivate and being motivated to provide effective leadership, make decisions, build trust, communicate and manage conflict, appreciating group members and completing the tasks;

- iv. Face-to-face interactive feedback: This means that the students promote each other's success by sharing resources. They help, support, encourage and praise each other's effort; and
- v. Group processing: Group members engaging in group processing need to feel free to express concerns as well as to celebrate accomplishments. The group should regularly discuss how well they are achieving their goals and maintaining effective working relationships.

Advantages of Collaborative Learning Environment

- i. Peer learning: In group learning students will learn from fellow students;
- ii. It improves critical thinking: Interactive sharing of ideas, opinions and feedback includes a critique as well as interpretation of the opinions or ideas expressed;
- iii. It enhances problem solving: Each group member is expected to help in solving the problem in order to complete the task;
- iv. It improves communication skills: Working in teams to learn will encourage people to improve their communication skills; and
- v. It improves cultural awareness: By people from different cultures working together in a group task, their differences will be highlighted improving people's cultural awareness.

Disadvantages of Collaborative Learning Environment

- i. People learn at different speeds which is why group work can sometimes take longer than individual learning;
- ii. Someone may decide to be in charge of the group which should be discouraged in collaborative learning. This can sometimes create group tension;

- iii. Some groups may struggle to complete the task if they do not have group/team working skills; and
- iv. Social loafers or introverts may struggle. Social loafing is a situation where someone in a group working situation puts in less effort than the rest of the team while introverts can also struggle in groups to get their voices heard.

Inclusive Learning Environments

An inclusive classroom is one that creates a supportive environment for all learners, including those with learning differences and one that can also challenge and engage gifted and talented learners by building a more responsive learning environment. It is an environment in which every learner feels valued. Inclusive learning environment strategies include:

- i. Examining your assumptions;
- ii. Learning and using students' names;
- iii. Utilizing more inclusive language;
- iv. Using multiple and diverse examples;
- v. Establishing ground rules for interaction;
- vi. Examining the curriculum to make it more inclusive;
- vii. Striving to be fair to all students; and
- viii. Being mindful of low ability cues.

An inclusive learning environment:

- i. Respects students' diversity;
- ii. Enables all students to take part in learning and fulfill their potential;

- iii. Ensures different students' learning needs and preferences are met regardless of their backgrounds, learning styles or abilities.

Benefits of Inclusive Learning Environment

- i. It tailors teaching for all irrespective of their individual learning differences: One can do this by having differentiated instruction, use of multisensory instruction, individualized instruction etc.;
- ii. It makes differences less different: Inclusion gives children an opportunity to talk about how everyone learns in their own way and that they have more in common than they thought;
- iii. It provides support to all students: An inclusive class often brings specialists such as speech therapists, reading specialist and other service providers into the classroom; and
- iv. It creates high expectations for all students: Differentiated instruction and co-teaching in a general education classroom make it easier for students to be taught the same materials irrespective of their individual learning differences.

Leadership Ethics

Ethical leadership is defined as leadership demonstrating and promoting normatively appropriate conduct through personal actions and interpersonal relations. Being an ethical leader means inspiring, motivating and holding employees to a certain standard of integrity and accountability. It is about walking the walk and talking the talk. In doing so, a leader can powerfully boost employee performance by keeping the team's morale high. Some basic leadership characteristics include justice, respect for others, honesty, being humane, focus on team building, value-driven decision-making, encouragement of initiative, leadership by example, valuing awareness and intolerance for ethical violations.

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Diversity Leadership

Diversity leadership mean recognizing that cultural preferences differ and adapting strategies and processes that work for more group members. While we are more curious and interested in others and their preferences, it is also important for leaders to know their own cultural views.

Leadership promotion of Diversity

- i. Establish shared ownership: Accountability is essential for diversity and inclusion because it sets expectations and demands results.
- ii. Action Item: Own the words and the vision. Keep yourself accountable for progress, but also encourage others to contribute their vision to the initiative.

Benefits of Cultural Diversity

- i. Diverse cultural perspectives can inspire creativity and drive innovation;
- ii. Local market knowledge and insight makes an organization more competitive and profitable;
- iii. Cultural sensitivity, insight, and local knowledge means higher quality, targeted marketing;
- iv. Drawing from a culturally diverse talent pool allows an organization to attract and retain the best talent;
- v. A diverse skills base allows an organization to offer a broader and more adaptable range of products and services;
- vi. Diverse teams are more productive and perform better: A range of experience, expertise, and working methods that a diverse workplace offers can boost problem-solving capacity and lead to greater productivity; and

- vii. Greater opportunity for personal and professional growth: An inclusive and culturally diverse organization will attract talented, ambitious, and globally minded professionals who will appreciate the opportunity for personal and professional growth.

Challenges in Cultural Diversity

- i. Colleagues from some cultures may be less likely to let their voices be heard;
- ii. Integration from multicultural teams can be difficult in the face of prejudice or negative cultural stereotypes;
- iii. Professional communication can be misinterpreted or difficult to understand across languages and cultures;
- iv. Navigating visa requirements, employment laws, and the cost of accommodating workplace requirements can be difficult;
- v. Different understanding of professional etiquette: Colleagues from different cultures can also bring with them different workplace attitudes, values, behaviours, and etiquette which can sometimes cause misunderstandings or ill feelings among team members; and
- vi. Conflicting working styles across teams: If not recognized and accounted, conflicting approaches to work can inhibit teamwork and productivity.

FUNDAMENTALS OF NATIONAL EDUCATIONAL ADMINISTRATION

Fundamentals of National Education Administration are a crucial area in which the nature of service delivery of education in Kenya is investigated. Of interest here are the legal framework, organizational structure and infrastructure, and the policies that guide the provision and governance of education sector.

Definition of Education Policy

A policy is a general statement of intent to act in a particular manner when confronted with a given situation or to achieve a given result at some future point in time.

Functions of Educational Policies

Education policies play a critical role in the management of education in Kenya. The policies:

- i. Constitute vehicles through which the government expresses and maintains control;
- ii. Guide in the administration and formation of rules and regulations of practice;
- iii. Provide consistency, maintain standards, stability and assurance in institutions; and
- iv. Inform the public and reduce uncertainty especially when written, published and disseminated.

Factors the Drive Policy Formulation and Change

Many countries are facing challenges in provision of education to its citizens. These challenges are brought about by some of the following factors:

- i. Globalization.
- ii. Increase in population.
- iii. International convections such as rights of special people and guarantees to education.
- iv. Economic difficulties that many developing nations are facing which reduce their capacity to meet economic responsibilities.
- v. The geopolitical and in-country political ecology.

9.2.3 Policies in Kenyan Education since 1963

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Kenya attained independence in 1963 and since then, several challenges have been faced by the government pertaining to quality education provision. Consequently, the education provision in this country has not been static and has been addressed by the government through concerted efforts of policy formulation. The following are various sources of education policies that have guided education provision in Kenya.

The KANU Manifesto of 1963

The KANU manifesto was the ruling party's commitment and hence the government's commitment to provide universal free primary education. The manifesto is a good example of how politics influence education governance, and hence policies that guide its service provision. It is not therefore possible to divorce politics from education entirely. For more on KANU manifesto, follow this link <http://goo.gl/C8zf5j>.

Education Commissions and Taskforces Reports

Ominde Commission Report of (1964)

Ominde had led the Commission in charge of reviewing all aspects of education and laying down the guidelines of the new nation which had just acquired independence in 1963. The report made the following recommendations:

- i. The integration of the new racially separate schools.
- ii. Promotion of traditional moral values, reduction of examination competition and a curriculum reform to fit Kenya's culture.
- iii. Although English was to be made the universal medium of instructions, Kiswahili was to be made compulsory in primary schools as a unifying national influence.
- iv. Consolidation of teacher training colleges and establishment of in-service training to upgrade teachers for the better quality of education.
- v. Management of schools (public primary schools) by the local authorities.

Gachathi Commission Report of 1976

The major task of the Gachathi Commission was to review the previous educational objectives and policies and draw up a new set of goals to match the changing economic and social life of the country during the second decade of independence and formulate a specific programme of action for achieving these goals.

Recommendations

- i. Teaching of religion and social ethics be introduced into the education system in order to promote African culture.
- ii. Seven years of primary school, four years of secondary school, two years of high school and three years of university education. It emphasized practical subjects such as Agriculture and home economics and Kiswahili.
- iii. To achieve universal primary education, it recommended that University College be given full university status and that a third university must be established by 1989 and develop an extra programme.
- iv. Local authors should be encouraged, and an independent Kenya National examination council be established, the inspectorate be strengthened and teachers' colleges be expanded.
- v. Promotion of teachers by merit and training them in guidance and counselling.

Mackay Report of 1981

This report is also known as the Presidential Working Party on the establishment of a second university. It was set up to review the higher education system in relation to the development objectives of the country, and recommend how the proposed second university could serve the interests of the Kenyan society. It pointed out that there was a great need for a second university due to the rapid expansion of education and the limited facilities available at Nairobi University.

- i. Kiswahili was to be made a compulsory subject at the second university.
- ii. A faculty of Information Science, a school of Environmental studies, a department of Special education and a college of continuing studies should also be established at this second university.
- iii. It also recommended the restructuring of education system from 7-4-3-2 to 8-4-4.

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- iv. Diversification of the school curriculum with emphasis on prevocational and technical skills i.e. aimed at developing self-employment and included more practically-oriented subjects.

The Kamunge Report of 1988

This was also referred to as the Presidential working Party on education and man-power training for the next decade and beyond.

Recommendations

- i. Strengthening and improving of Teachers Advisory Centre's (TACs).
- ii. Streamlining the provision and management of Technical and Vocational Education and training (TVET).
- iii. Reduction of government budgetary allocation to education through cost-sharing where other costs related to uniforms, facilities, meals and transport among others were to be shifted to parents and communities. This was a response to SAPS as a result of world bank Report of 1988 entitled "Education in Sub-Saharan Africa: Policies for Adjustment, Re-vitalization and change."

The Koech (TIQET) Report of 1998

This report's (popularly known as Totally Integrated Quality Education and Training (TIQET)). Its mandate was to make an inquiry into the education system of Kenya. It produced a report that strongly recommended the review of 8-4-4 education system.

Master plan on Education and Training, 1997-2010 of 1998(MPET)

- This plan was a response for the country's aspirations to be industrialized by 2010.
- It was also intended to provide direction in financing and governance of education.
- It further emphasized on the need to address the high dropout rate, regional and gender disparities in relation to education provision.

Task Force on Realignment of the Education Sector to Kenya Constitution 2010

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The task force on the realignment of the education sector to the Kenya constitution 2010 (Odhiambo Report) recommended the implementation of competency based education curriculum in Kenya which has already started in early primary education (schooling). The report of this task can be found in <https://www.slideshare.net/erykkoh>. In particular, this report recommended change of education system from 8-4-4 to 2-6-3-3-3 system of education.

The Task Force recommends a major reform of the curriculum to:

- i. Align it with the Constitution and to ensure that the aspirations of Vision 2030 are met.
- ii. Structure the curriculum within a skills and competences framework that identifies the knowledge, skills and competences all learners will acquire, and which will provide both vertical and horizontal coherence.
- iii. Develop a progressive assessment framework that identifies the knowledge, skills and competencies that will be assessed for each level (Senior Secondary, Junior Secondary, Upper Primary and Lower Primary).
- iv. The Task Force recommends revision of the curriculum and textbooks to ensure skills and competencies are emphasized as proposed.

On **Assessment and Evaluation**, the following issues and recommendations came up regarding assessment and evaluation:

- i. That the current summative assessment at the end of every cycle does not measure
- ii. learners' abilities. School-based assessments need to be strengthened so that regular and cumulative assessment in the form of Competence Assessment Tests (CATs) is put in place.
- iii. The current education system is examination based. The assessment has little regard to molding good citizens and for self-reliance. There is need, therefore, to introduce competency-based assessment in line with a competency based curriculum. Revision of curriculum and textbooks is proposed to ensure skills and competences are emphasized.
- iv. Assessment is not seen as part of the teaching and learning process but as a sieve to determine those who can move to higher education where the limited available space dictates the teaching/learning process towards examinations as opposed to competencies applicable to life.

- v. Achievement at Kenya Primary Education Certificate (KPEC) level and Kenya Junior Secondary Education Certificate (KJSEC) will be considered in Senior Secondary School admission and streaming.
- vi. Schools will be ranked based on holistic assessment on performance indicators built around the following areas: academic, co-curricular activities, quality of management, operations and maintenance of physical facilities, environmental care, learners' services and community outreach programmes.

LEGAL FRAMEWORK ON EDUCATION SYSTEM

10.1 Introduction

The legal framework on education constitutes laws, policies, rules and regulations that guide the provision and governance of education in Kenya. These include the constitution and other national sectoral and ancillary education acts of parliament and subsidiary legislation on education formulated by the county governments that guide the provision and management of education in the country.

Legal Framework of Education in Kenya

These include the laws of Kenya such as the Constitution of Kenya 2010, the Basic Education Act 2013 and the Basic Education Curriculum Frame Work that guide the provision and management of education in the country.

The Constitution of Kenya 2010

In this section, the legal frameworks governing provision of education in Kenya are discussed. These include the Kenya 2010 Constitution (part 3) on the specific application of the fundamental rights in <https://www.wipo.int>laws> which states that children have a basic right to free and compulsory basic education.

The Basic Education Act 2013

Basic Education Act (2013) provides for the governance of education in Kenya discussed in <http://goo.gl/OYHK1i> and <http://www.education.go.ke>file>. The basic education act, 2013 describes the following legal provisions: establishment, powers and functions of the national education board; county education boards; free and compulsory education systems and structure of basic education; promotion of special needs education; private educational institutions; governance and management of basic education and training; standards, quality and relevance; licensing, registration and accreditation; procedures in basic education; and financial and general provisions in basic education.

The Basic Education Curriculum Frame work (BECF) of 2017

Basic Education Curriculum Frame work (BECF) elaborates how the competency based basic education curriculum has been structured. The Basic Education curriculum framework (2017) addresses the following:

- i. Curriculum reforms vision and mission;
- ii. National goals of education;

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- iii. Basic education curriculum framework pillars, values, theoretical approaches, and guiding principles;
- iv. Core competencies for basic education and the specific subjects;
- v. Organization of basic education including early years school education, middle school education, secondary school education and senior school education;
- vi. Education for learners with special education needs;
- vii. Pertinent and contemporary issues in the curriculum; and
- viii. Capacity building framework for a competency based curriculum.

Other Education Acts of Parliament

There are other Acts of parliament that guide the provision and management of education. These can be read from the following links: <https://goo.gl/q23DQC>.

Examples of these Education Acts of Parliament include:

- i. The board of Adult Education Act of 1966 which established a body which would co-ordinate adult education activities in the country.
- ii. The TSC Act of 1969 which established a single employer and unified terms of service for teachers in public schools.
- iii. The UON Act of 1970 which established the UON as the first public (National) University, providing for its control, governance and administration.
- iv. Science, Technology and Innovation Act No. 28 of 2013.
- v. KNEC Act (1980).
- vi. Kenya Literature Bureau Act (KLB) (1984).
- vii. Moi University Act (1984).
- viii. The Universities act No. 42 of 2012 (2016) established C.U.E.
- ix. Kenyatta University Act (1985).
- x. Egerton University Act (1987).

Ministry of Education Structure and Semi-Autonomous Government Education Agencies

The Ministry of Education is the ministry charged with conducting matters of education in Kenya. The cabinet secretary heads the Ministry of Education. The CS is deputized by several

administrative secretaries under various state departments of education. The principal secretaries are the technical heads of the various state departments of education.

Structure of the Ministry of Education

The organogram in the following link <https://goo.gl/T4gMvr> gives an overview of how the Ministry operates. To get details on the functions of the various personnel working in the MOE, follow this link <http://goo.gl/t1bnKq>.

Hierarchy of the Ministry of Education

The Ministry of Education, just like any other governmental department, has a hierarchical order of power. Here is how the power has been divided.

1. Office of the Cabinet Secretary

The office of the Cabinet Secretary is a constitutional office that provides policy and strategy leadership to the ministry. The office is staffed with administrative support staff. They include a cabinet secretary, personal assistant, technical assistant for education, technical assistant for science and technology, personal secretary, support staff and principal driver. Thus, the cabinet secretary is the senior most office bearer in the ministry.

2. Office of the Principal Secretaries

This office is subdivided into two:

Office of the Principal Secretary, Education, Office of the Principal Secretary, Science and Technology, and Office of the Principal Secretary, University Education and Research. The Principal Secretary is the authorized accounting officer for the ministry. This office is staffed with two principal secretaries one for the state department of education and the other heading the state department of science and technology.

Under the office of **Principal Secretary Basic Education** lie the following directories:

1. Office of the Director General Education.

This office established through the Basic Education Act, 2013 and is responsible for: Advising the principal secretary on all matters pertaining to technical aspects of the state department of education, coordination of projects, partnerships and international

commitments, schools audit function, overseeing the implementation of ICT for education project as well as the Field Administration Services Unit.

2. Directorate of Primary Education

The directorate is headed by a Secretary of Primary Education and is responsible for: The overall management of primary, special needs education (SNE) and primary teacher education. The directorate is organized into three departments namely: Research, Policy and Strategy; Primary Education Development and Projects, Programmes and Grants.

3. Directorate of Secondary and Tertiary Education

This directorate is headed by a Secretary of Secondary Education. The directorate: Manages matters related to secondary and tertiary education. The directorate is further organized into two departments namely Research Policy and Strategy and Secondary and Tertiary Education Development.

4. Directorate of Alternative Basic Education and Continuing Education

This directorate is headed by a Secretary at Job group T. The directorate is responsible for: formulation and review of policies for alternative provision of basic education and training; overseeing the development, management and governance of institutions offering alternative adult education; and strategic partnerships and collaborations promoting life-long learning for out of school children, youth and adults.

5. Directorate of Schools Audit

This directorate is headed by a Director and is responsible to the Education Secretary for planning, organizing, directing, coordinating and controlling audit services in public primary, secondary and tertiary institutions.

Office of the **Principal Secretary, Science and Technology** is assigned the following functions: science technology and innovation policy making; management of technical training institutes including youth polytechnics; management of institutions of science and technology; and management of national polytechnics.

To accomplish these tasks, it is divided into the following directories:

1. Office of the Director General, Science and Technology

This office is headed by a Secretary, Science and Technology. The Director General is responsible for: advising the principal secretary on all matters relating to TVET, science,

technology and innovation; coordinating the technical functions of the state department; and coordinating projects, partnerships and international commitments.

2. Directorate of Knowledge Management and Commercialization

This directorate is headed by a secretary. The directorate is responsible for the formulation and implementation of policies, strategies and programmes for the production, preservation and utilization of knowledge. These include: indigenous knowledge, for socio-economic development; establishment and maintenance of a knowledge management information system; generation of national science, technology and innovation statistics to feed into the system; facilitation of the effective linkages between government, research, academia, industry and the society; and initiation and implementation of strategic international, national and institutional collaborations and partnerships for knowledge management and commercialization.

3. Directorate of Science, Technology and Innovation

This directorate is headed by a secretary. The directorate is responsible for: formulation and implementation of policies, strategies and programmes for the development, promotion, dissemination and effective communication of science, technology and innovation; facilitation of the integration of science and technology, including new and emerging areas such as information communication technology, business process outsourcing, nanotechnology, biotechnology, space science, nuclear science etc into the national production systems for sustainable development; and initiation and implementation of strategic collaborations and partnerships for science, technology and innovation.

4. Directorate of Technical, Vocational Education and Training

This Directorate is headed by a Secretary. It is responsible for: policy formulation and supervision of TVET institutions including youth polytechnics; ensuring equitable access, retention and achievement of appropriate knowledge, skills and attitudes; and overseeing the management of institutions established by the TVET Act, 2013.

5. Directorate of Youth Training

This Department is headed by a Director and is responsible for: formulation and review of policies on youth training; development and review of curriculum; overseeing the

implementation of the curriculum and co-curricular activities; and facilitating provision of adequate tools, equipment and infrastructure in youth polytechnics.

With the onset of devolved governments there was need to effectively coordinate functions of the national government at the county levels. This necessitated the post of County Director Education, Science and Technology with two deputies. The county director reports to the Director General, Education and the Director General, Science and Technology.

Office of the **Principal Secretary, University Education and Research** is headed by a Principal Secretary who is in charge of the professional and technical aspects of the department's operations. It is responsible for: formulation, implementation and review of policies for the university education; overseeing the management and governance of institutions established by the University Education Act, 2012; and coordination of strategic partnerships, collaborations and linkages to foreign university education. The directorate of university and research under this state department performs the following specific functions:

1. Formulation and review of policies on Higher Education in collaboration with Commission for Higher Education (CUE), Higher Education Loans Board (HELB) and other relevant institutions and departments.
2. Co-ordination of plans and budgets from public universities in collaboration with CUE and other departments.
3. Initiation, promotion and implementation of Cultural, Technical and Scientific cooperation with other countries in liaison with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs.
4. Administration of scholarships offered by friendly countries.
5. Coordination of matters related to local and overseas universities education.
6. Disbursement of grants and bursaries to local and overseas universities as well as regional and international institutions and organizations that are linked to the state department of education of the Ministry of Education.
7. Joint formulation and implementation of policies on East African Community, Inter-University Council of East Africa (IUCEA) and African Institute for Capacity Development (AICAD).
8. Coordination of admission to public universities in liaison with Kenya Universities and Colleges Central Placement Service) KUCCPS).

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9. Facilitation of appointments of Education Attaches to Kenya Missions in Paris, Moscow, London, Delhi and Washington.
 10. Coordination of Student Exchange Programmes for university students, and clearance of students proceeding for university education overseas.
 11. Facilitation of acquisition of travel documents for students wishing to travel outside the country for studies.
-
1. The State Department of Higher Education and Research collaborates with Higher Education Loans Board, Commission for University Education and Kenya Universities and Colleges Central Placement Service) KUCCPS).

The three bodies offer the following:

Higher Education Loans Board Products

- Loans for undergraduate
- Loans postgraduate (Masters/PhD) studies
- Bursaries for undergraduate studies
- Scholarships for postgraduate studies

Commission for University Education

- Quality assurance and standards in higher education
- Higher Education policy formulation and review
- Coordination of plans and budgets from public universities

Kenya University Central Placement Services (KUCCPS)

- Admissions to public universities

Functions of Semi-Autonomous Government Education Agencies in Implementation of Competency Based Curriculum

Semi-autonomous government education agencies (SAGAS) are created to regulate the Ministry of Education operations in specific subsectors. Examples of SAGAS include:

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I. Teachers Service Commission (TSC) in <http://goo.gl/DTYiwW> is one of the semi-autonomous government agencies (SAGAS) charged with teacher management in Kenya. The Teachers Service Commission was formed to provide teachers with one employer and uniform terms and conditions of service. Its core functions include the following:

1. To register trained teachers;
2. Recruit and employ registered teachers
3. Assign teachers employed by the commission for service in any public school or institution;
4. Promote or transfer teachers;
5. Exercise disciplinary control over teachers; and
6. Terminate the employment of teachers.

(<https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki>)

II. Kenya National Examination Council (KNEC) in <https://www.knec.ac.ke/who-we-are> is the education SAGA in charge of setting, administering, marking and grading national examinations in Kenya such as KCPE, KCSE, PTE and Technical Examinations. The core functions of KNEC include:

1. Developing examination policies, procedures and regulations;
2. Developing national examinations
3. Registering candidates for KNEC examinations
4. Awarding certificates and diplomas to successful candidates; and
5. Conducting research on educational assessment

III. Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) in <https://kicd.ac.ke/about.us/kicd-f> is another SAGA whose major functions revolve around curriculum development, innovation and implementation. The following are the specific key functions of the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development:

1. Advices the government on matters pertaining to curriculum development;
2. Evaluate, vet and approve for application in Kenya, any local and foreign curricula and curriculum support materials in relation to pre-primary, primary, secondary, adult, continuing and non-formal education, teacher education and training, special needs education; and technical and vocational education;

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3. Implements policies relating to curriculum development in basic and tertiary education and training;
4. Develops, reviews and approves programmes, curricula and curriculum support materials that meet international standards for pre-primary, primary, secondary, adult, continuing and non-formal education, teacher education and training, special needs education; and technical and vocational education;
5. Initiates and conducts research to inform curriculum policies, review and development;
6. Collects, documents and catalogues information on curricula, curriculum support materials and innovates to create a data bank to disseminate the information to educational institutions, learners and other relevant organizations;
7. Prints, publishes and disseminates information relating to curricula for basic and tertiary education and training;
8. Collaborates with other individuals and institutions in organizing and conducting professional development programmes for teachers, teacher trainers, QASOs and other officers involved in education and training on curriculum programmes and materials;
9. Develops, disseminates and transmits programmes and curriculum support materials through mass media, electronic, distance learning and any other mode of delivering education and training programmes and materials;
10. Promotes equity and access to quality curricula and curriculum support materials;
11. Promotes appropriate utilization of technology to enhance innovations and achievement of a knowledge based economy;
12. Offers consultancy services in basic and tertiary education and training;
13. Incorporates national values, talent development and leadership values in curriculum development; and
14. Receives, considers, develops and reviews curriculum proposals.

IV. Examples of other education SAGAS in Kenya include Kenya Literature Bureau (KLB), Jomo Kenyatta Foundation (JKF), Kenya Institute of Special Education (KISE), Kenya Education Management Institute (KEMI), Center for Mathematics, Science and Technology in Africa (CEMASTE), Higher Education Loans Board (HELB), Commission for University Education (CUE) and School Equipment Production Unit (SEPU) in <https://www.education.go.ke>.

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SCHOOL ADMINISTRATION AND MANAGEMENT IN KENYA

The subtopics covered in this topic include:

- i) Establishment and registration of basic education institutions;
- ii) Objectives of Basic education
 - a) Objectives of primary education
 - b) Objectives of secondary education
- iii) Governance and Management of basic education
 - a) National education board
 - b) Board of Management
 - c) Parents association
 - d) School Sponsors
 - e) County director of education
 - f) Duties and Functions of the school principal
 - g) Issues and Challenges Affecting Basic Education in Kenya

Establishment and Registration of Private Educational Institutions

Private schools play an important role in the provision and management of education in Kenya. Collins (2020) defines a private school as a school which is not supported financially by the government and which parents have to pay for their children to enroll. This is a school which is either owned by an individual or an organization for business purposes or for corporate, religious and social responsibilities to participate in promoting communities through education and the primary sources of funding are private or fees charged on students.

Establishment of Private Schools

Subject to the Constitution and the provisions of the Basic Education Act 2013 (Republic of Kenya, 2013), any person may establish and maintain a private school so long as s/he qualifies to do so under the private schools' registration requirements.

Registration of Private Schools

The Basic Education Act 2013 provides for registration of private schools. The following are the provisions:

- (1) A person shall not establish or maintain a private school unless it is registered under this Act.
- (2) No private school shall be registered if:
 - (a) The proprietor is disqualified from being a proprietor by reason of Article 10 or Chapter Six of the Constitution;
 - (b) A teacher employed in the school is not registered by the Teachers Service Commission;
 - (c) The school premises, or any part of those premises, are unsuitable for a school; or
 - (d) The proprietor or manager has been convicted of any crime against children under the Sexual Offences Act and Counter Trafficking in Persons Act.
- (3) Subject to the provisions of this Act, the registration of any private school shall be provisional for a term of one year renewable for one further term of one year until the institution is quality assured and notice given in writing to the proprietor that the registration is final.
- (4) If any person:
 - (a) Conducts a private school which is not a registered school or a provisionally registered school, or
 - (b) Being the proprietor of a private school does any act calculated to lead to the belief that the school is a registered school while it is a provisionally registered school, he or she shall be liable on conviction to a fine not exceeding five million shillings or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding three years or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

Objectives of Basic Education in Kenya

Basic Education in Kenya comprises both the primary education and secondary education sectors (Republic of Kenya, K, 2013). The objectives of basic education are spelt out in the National Education Sector Plan Volume One: Basic Education Programme Rationale and Approach (2013 - 2018). Currently in Kenya, objectives of basic education are to integrate the new strategies of education reform that ushered in the new Competency Based Curriculum. The following section presents the objectives of primary and secondary education in Kenya.

Objectives of Primary Education in Kenya

There are thirteen specific objectives of primary education in Kenya (Karanu, 2018). Primary education should provide the learner with opportunities to:

1. Acquire literacy, numeracy, creativity and communication skills;
2. Enjoy learning and develop desire to continue learning;
3. Develop ability for critical thinking and logical judgment;
4. Appreciate and respect the dignity of work;
5. Develop desirable social standards, moral and religious values;
6. Develop into a self-disciplined, physically fit and healthy person;
7. Develop aesthetic values and appreciate own and other people's cultures;
8. Develop awareness and appreciation of the environment;
9. Develop awareness of and appreciation for other nations and international community;
10. Instill respect and love for own country and the need for harmonious co-existence;
11. Develop individual talents;
12. Promote social responsibility and make proper use of leisure time; and
13. Develop awareness and appreciation of the role of technology in optional development.

Objectives of Secondary Education in Kenya

The statements of objectives of secondary education in Kenya are laid out here under the general and specific categories of objectives.

General Objectives of Secondary Education in Kenya

The objectives of secondary education have been presented by Boit (2005) under the following general thematic statements:

1. To promote experience, growth of the whole person through integrated development of mental, physical and emotive (moral, spiritual and aesthetic) attributes and abilities beyond the primary experience;

2. To promote communication skills, numeracy, scientific concepts and skills (such as reasoning, problem solving, creativity, technological application of science) and social skills including services to others and the society;
3. To increase knowledge on economic production and its relationship with the social context and the natural environment;
4. To promote social equity through provision of education to all Kenyans, including those from disadvantaged communities and households, the girl child and the handicapped; and
5. To strengthen the foundation laid down in primary school for formal education and training, the world of work and life-long learning.

Specific Objectives of Secondary Education in Kenya

Jogwel (2020) states the following specific objectives of secondary education. Secondary education in Kenya should provide the learners with the opportunity to:

1. Acquire necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes for the development of the self and the nation;
2. Promote love and loyalty for the nation;
3. Promote harmonious co-existence among the peoples of Kenya;
4. Develop mentally, socially, morally, physically and spiritually;
5. Enhance understanding and respect for own and other people's cultures and their place in contemporary society;
6. Enhance understanding and appreciation of inter-relationships among nations;
7. Promote positive environmental and health practices;
8. Build a firm foundation for further education and training;
9. Develop ability for enquiry, critical thinking and rational judgment;
10. Develop into a responsible and socially well-adjusted person;
11. Promote acceptance of and respect for all persons;
12. Enhance enjoyment in learning;
13. Identify individual talents and develop them;
14. Build a foundation for technological and industrial development; and

15. Develop into a self-disciplined individual who appreciates work and manages time properly.

Management of Basic Education

Functions of the Board of Management

The functions of the Board of Management of a basic education institution according to the Basic Education Act 2013 (Republic of Kenya, 2013) shall be to:

- (a) Promote the best interests of the institution and ensure its development;
- (b) Promote quality education for all pupils in accordance with the standards set under this Act or any other written law;
- (c) Ensure and assure the provision of proper and adequate physical facilities for the institution;
- (d) Manage the institution's affairs in accordance with the rules and regulations governing the occupational safety and health;
- (e) Advise the County Education Board on the staffing needs of the institution;
- (f) Determine cases of pupils' discipline and make reports to the County Education Board;
- (g) Prepare a comprehensive termly report on all areas of its mandate and submit the report to the County Education Board;
- (h) Facilitate and ensure the provision of guidance and counseling to all learners;
- (i) provide for the welfare and observe the human rights and ensure safety of the pupils, teachers and non-teaching staff at the institution;
- (j) Encourage a culture of dialogue and participatory democratic governance at the institution;
- (k) Promote the spirit of cohesion, integration, peace, tolerance, inclusion, elimination of hate speech, and elimination of tribalism at the institution;
- (l) Encourage the learners, teachers and non-teaching staff and other, parents and the community, and other stakeholders to render voluntary services to the institution;
- (m) Allow reasonable use of the facilities of the institution for community, social and other lawful purposes, subject to such reasonable and equitable conditions as it may determine including the charging of a fee;
- (n) Administer and manage the resources of the institution;
- (o) Receive, collect and account for any funds accruing to the institution;
- (p) Recruit, employ and remunerate such number of non-teaching staff as may be required by the institution in accordance with this Act; and

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- (q) Perform any other function to facilitate the implementation of its functions under this Act or any other written law.

Establishment and Functions of Parents Association in Kenya

A provision for the establishment and functions of a Parents' Association in basic education institutions in Kenya is stipulated in the Basic Education Act 2013 (Republic of Kenya, 2013).

The functions of the Parents Association shall be to:

- (a) Promote quality care, nutritional and health status of the pupils;
- (b) Maintain good working relationship between teachers and parents;
- (c) Discuss, explore and advise the parents on ways to raise funds for the physical development and maintenance of the school;
- (d) Explore ways to motivate the teachers and pupils to improve their performance in academic and co-curricular activities;
- (e) Discuss and recommend charges to be levied on pupils or parents;
- (f) Undertake and oversee development projects on behalf of the whole Parents Association.
- (g) Assist the school management in the monitoring, guidance, counseling and disciplining of pupils;
- (h) Discuss and recommend measures for the welfare of staff and pupils;

Role of School Sponsors in Kenya

Educational sponsorship involves an organization investing in education-related programmes. It is aimed at eradicating illiteracy as well as giving better opportunities to everybody through availing cash and equipment donations, scholarships and so on with the overall goal of improving and promoting universal access to education (Optimy Wiki, 2017). The role of the Sponsor (Republic of Kenya, 2013) shall be:

- (a) To participate and make recommendations of review of syllabus, curriculum, books and other teaching aids;
- (b) Representation in the School Management Committees and Board of Management;
- (c) To provide supervisory and advisory services in matters regarding spiritual development in schools including the appointment of chaplains at their own expense;
- (d) Maintenance of spiritual development while safeguarding the denomination or religious

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adherence of others; and

(e) To offer financial and infrastructural support.

County Director of Education

According to Basic Education Act 2013 (Republic of Kenya, 2013), a County Director of Education will be deployed by the Cabinet Secretary through an open and competitive process. The County Director of Education shall be the Secretary to the County Education Board and holder of the authority to incur expenditure of the educational account in the county. The County Director of Education shall, subject to the authority of the Cabinet Secretary and in consultation with the County Government, perform the following functions:

- (a) Implementation of education policies;
- (b) Co-ordination and supervision of all education officers and support staff at the County level;
- (c) Management of basic education, adult continuing education, non-formal, special needs education, tertiary and other educational programmes;
- (d) Initiating educational policies at County level;
- (e) Liaise with Kenya National Examination Council on management of national examinations;
- (f) Maintenance of quality assurance and standards in the County;
- (g) Management and monitoring the implementation of educational programmes;
- (h) Advising and facilitating the establishment and registration of learning institutions by the County government;
- (i) Administration of education management information system and the related information and communication technology at the County level;
- (j) Facilitate auditing of all basic education institutions in the County;
- (k) Advise the County Education Board on selection and appointment of Boards of Management (BOMs), School Management Committees and Parents Associations;
- (l) Co-ordinate capacity building and development for officers, school managers, Boards of Management and curriculum implementers;
- (m) Admissions, transfers and discipline of students;
- (n) Co-ordination of partners and education providers in the county including links with Government Departments on all education matters;

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- (o) Supervision of handing and taking over in schools and educational institutions in consultation with the Teacher Service Commission;
- (p) Oversee the proper management and maintenance of school buildings, property and infrastructure development;
- (q) Monitoring and evaluation of education programmes;
- (r) Management of co-curricular activities, sports education and talent development in basic education institutions in the County;
- (s) Any other duties assigned by the Cabinet Secretary.

Duties and Functions of a School Principal

The school principal performs various duties and functions (Education News Hub, 2019). The following are some of these duties and functions:

- 1) Prepare lesson plans, lesson notes, time tables, schemes of work and maintain academic standards in the school to ensure that the syllabus is covered in time for evaluation;
- 2) Teach subjects of specialization to impart knowledge, skills and attitudes to learners;
- 3) Evaluate learners on subjects of specialization and prepare them for national and other examinations;
- 1) Coordinate and provide guidance and counselling services to the teachers, non-teaching staff and learners and instill norms and values for harmonious coexistence;
- 2) Ensure proper discipline is maintained in the school by the teachers, nonteaching staff and learners to create a conducive learning environment;
- 3) Supervise the interpretation and implementation of the curriculum and ensure teachers prepare lesson plans, schemes of work and other professional documents;
- 4) Ensure that the necessary instructional materials are sourced, availed and utilized by teachers and learners to support the curriculum implementation;
- 5) Oversee the requisition of stores and proper maintenance of inventories to achieve accountability and optimal utilization;
- 6) To promote harmonious relations and linkages between the school and stakeholders, for instance, the local community, parents and private sector organizations;
- 7) Introduce new ideas and programmes to ensure improvement in teaching and learning in the subjects of specialization;

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- 8) Embrace teamwork through collaborative teaching and planning to ensure consistency and improvement in curriculum delivery;
- 9) Serve as a role model and maintain learner discipline;
- 10) Interpret the curriculum in the school to ensure effective teaching and learning;
- 11) Oversee the organization of workshops, seminars and symposia to share ideas to enhance performance;
- 12) Oversee the implementation of remedial actions to support learners with performance gaps;
- 13) Oversee prudent management of institutional resources;
- 14) Ensure health, safety and security of learners;
- 15) Ensure that learners are adequately prepared, registered and presented for the national and other examinations;
- 16) Coordinate the identification of an appropriate curriculum for the school to provide more opportunities for learners in the optional subjects offered in the curriculum;
- 17) Interpret and implement policy decisions on training, recruitment and deployment of non-teaching staff in compliance with relevant laws and regulations;
- 18) Promote the welfare of all staff and learners within the school for motivation, personal and professional growth;
- 19) Manage issues of succession in the school;
- 20) Serve as the accounting officer of the institution and ensure prudent utilization of financial resources in the school;
- 21) Maintain the school's physical facilities and upgrade the same on a regular basis;
- 22) Oversee procurement of goods and services , maintain all inventories and ensure availability of the necessary facilities and items;
- 23) Organize staff, Board of Management and parents meetings;
- 24) Facilitate access and retention of learners in the school;
- 25) Serve as a Secretary and advisor to the Board of Management;
- 26) Participate in coordination of institutional and national examinations;
- 27) Induct and mentor staff to promote professionalism and integrity in the institution;
- 28) Any other duty as may be assigned.

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Issues and Challenges Facing Basic Education in Kenya

A number of issues and challenges characterize provision of basic education for all in Kenya. These issues and challenges include the following:

1. Gender disparities;
2. High poverty levels;
3. Teacher supply and quality;
4. HIV/AIDS pandemic; and
5. Inadequate financial resources.

1. Gender Disparities

The girl child continues to be in a vulnerable situation. Parental gender bias, cultural norms, negative impacts of HIV/AIDS pandemic and poverty continue to impact adversely on the girl child's participation in education. Although the world has made continuous progress towards gender parity showing that gender differences in education can be changed through public policy and attitudinal changes, there is still a long way to go as only 59 out of 176 countries have achieved gender parity in both primary and secondary education. Gender parity in educational opportunities and outcomes is the most challenging to achieve and it is inherently more difficult to measure. Much remains to be done. Many sub-Saharan countries, including Kenya, are miles away from achieving gender parity and equity in education (El, 2009).

Future prospects on girls' education depend on the following factors if Education for All (EFA) goals are to be realized:

- i) Added commitment by all the stakeholders to the girls' education;
- ii) Enough and targeted government and donor funding to the girl child education;
- iii) Strengthening the gender unit by allocating enough financial and material resources;
- iv) Strengthening the capacity of the National Taskforce on Gender and Education by allocating financial resources for their activities;
- v) Incorporating gender programs in pre-service and in-service teachers training;
- vi) Intensifying advocacy for girl child education;

- vii) Appointment of more women in key administrative positions at school and policy making levels; and
- viii) Emulating strategies and plans to address the major disparities identified at primary and secondary school levels.

2. High Poverty Level

In spite of strengthened democratic governance and improving economies, progress has not accelerated and poverty remains high. Most people in the so called developing economies have continued to live below the poverty line in less than US \$1 a day (Sisule, 2001; Wanjohi, 2013). With high poverty, compounded by economic crisis, prevalence of HIV/AIDS and other communicable and non-communicable diseases, it could just be mere dream to attain the sustainable developmental goals (SDGs) by 2030. Poverty has been recognized as one factor that negatively affects education.

3. Teacher Supply and Quality

The most pressing need is in sub-Saharan Africa where estimated 3.8million additional teachers had to be trained and recruited by 2015. In Kenya, for instance, more teachers are required with the increasing primary and secondary school student population as a result of free and subsidized education respectively. Staffing has however remained low despite availability of qualified but unemployed teachers due to limited budgetary allocation to the Teachers Service Commission for employment of more teachers. This remains a challenging task for the Kenyan government.

4. Hiv/Aids Pandemic

HIV/AIDS affected children are failing to go to school, and it's because their governments are failing them. AIDS affected children suffer defacto discrimination in access to education from the moment HIV/AIDS affects their family. Children leave school to perform household chores or to bereave their parents' death. Many cannot afford school fees because their parents are too sick to earn a living (HRW, 2005). HIV/AIDS has also affected teachers. HIV related health problems lead to teacher absenteeism (UNESCO, 2005). Although the government has made certain efforts in catering for the needs of the infected teachers, the impact could still be far much reaching in terms of quality education provision (Wanjohi, 2013).

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5. Inadequate Financial Resources

Funding Education for all (EFA) remains one of the greatest challenges facing many developing countries in Sub-Saharan Africa. Most of these governments depend on donor funds support which more often than not are availed with strings attached (El, 2009). Kenya, for instances, continues to face a number of challenges following introduction of free Primary Education in 2003 and subsidized Day Secondary Education in 2008. These challenges are mainly associated with lack of sufficient teachers (human resources) and equipment and facilities (physical resources) (UNESCO, 2005). The root cause of all these challenges is inadequate financial resources.

Other challenges to basic Education in Kenya are many:

- Quality, access, marginalization, vulnerability,
- Material and human resources.
- No power network in many schools
- Inability to link to radio, TV or internet education
- There are not enough schools close home to accommodate pupils.

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

Definition of School Financial Management

School financial management comprises the planning and implementation of a financial plan, accounting, reporting and the protection of assets from loss, damage and fraud. Schools can regulate their financial management with internal rules.

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT AND PLANNING TECHNIQUES

THE BUDGETING PROCESS

What is a Budget?

The word budget has however been defined in a number of ways by several authors, researchers and scholars. The following are some of the definitions of the concept “budget”.

- i. Budget is a statement of income and expenditure for a school calendar year (Malau, 2005).
- ii. Budget is an estimation of revenues and expenses over a specified future period of time and is usually compiled and re-evaluated on a periodic basis and can be made for a person, a group of people, a business, a government or just about anything else that makes and spends money (Ganti, 2020).

What is Budgeting?

Budgeting has attracted several definitions and descriptions from various authors as follows:

- i) Budgeting is the managerial process of budget planning, preparation and designing, budgetary implementation and control, and the related budget operating procedures (Tanwar, 2020).
- ii) Budgeting is the process of preparing a statement of income and expenditure for a school calendar year (Malau, 2005).
- iii) Budgeting is the process of creating a plan to spend money or simply balancing expenses and the income. (My Money Couch, 2020).

- iv) Budgeting is the comprehensive process of careful preparation of an organization's budget document showing estimated income (revenue) and expenditure (costs) for an organization's calendar or fiscal year.

Purposes of the School Budget

The purposes of budgeting have been equated to its advantages or benefits. The school budget serves a number of important purposes (Achim, 2009a; Aru, 2017; Tysiac, 2018). The following are the purposes for which budgets are prepared.

- i) It projects the proposed school program and educational plan of the school for the next fiscal year.
- ii) It shows the funds expected and their sources, the anticipated expenditure and the allocation of authority for administering budgetary items.
- iii) It serves to inform the public about the educational program of the school and the need for funds to operate it.
- iv) It provides a guide for evaluating a year's program and a means of comparing school services with those which have been offered in other years.
- v) It provides the motivation for careful planning, for establishing systems of control as well as for effective expenditure of funds.
- vi) It shows what proportion the county and the national units of government support the particular institution.

It is important to note that the purpose of a budget have been regarded as the importance or functions of a budgeting by some authors.

The Budget Cycle

The budget cycle has four major phases (Lander, 2019; AfroCave, 2020). The four phases are:

1. Preparation and submission;
2. Approval (Consideration and Adoption);
3. Execution (Budget Implementation); and
4. Audit and Evaluation (Budget Appraisal).

1. Budget Preparation and submission

Budget preparation involves the educational plan (program), the expenditure (cost) plan and the income (revenue) plan (Barasa & Ngugi, 1990; Malau, 2005). At this stage, it should be noted that:

- i) Preparation of the budget document should be done three to four (3-4) months before the ensuing years.
- ii) The school principal should involve all departmental needs and accounts clerk or school bursar during school budget preparation stage.
- iii) There is need to balance the educational program (plans) along with the cost (expenditure) plans and the revenue (income) or financing plans.
- iv) The initial budget is a provisional (tentative) budget until it is officially approved by the Ministry of Education.

2. Budget approval

The budget document and interpretative document are presented (submitted) to the Board of Management and Parents Association before it's presented to the Ministry of Education for approval. However, it's important to present the prepared budget to a technical financial budgeting specialist to look at it before presenting it for approval to the respective budget approving authorities.

3. Budget execution (implementation)

Once the budget is approved, it's time to implement it. This is where the budget is put into effect.

Budget control: This is where the expenditure is as per the budget. This ensures that all the programs are taken care of.

Work Plans: This enables the school principal to have a clear picture of who will procure what and when in accordance to the budget estimates.

Implementation of work plans: During the administration of the budget, there may be over-estimates or underestimates in the various vote heads. During, such instances, virement has to be done from the principal secretary or BoM.

Virement is the transfer of money from one vote head to another.

Interpretative document is the document that explains the increase or decrease of the amount assigned to a given vote-head compared to the previous year.

4. Budget evaluation (Regular budget appraisal)

Budget evaluation (appraisal) is assessing the budget document to determine its effectiveness. Appraisal should be done in terms of the purpose for which it was designed. Appraisal of the budget can be in terms of the following (Malau, 2005):

- i) Extent to which the school meets its Objectives.
- ii) Provision of accurate and systematic estimate and balance of receipts as per the expenditure.
- iii) The budget as an important document for financial accounting.

Sections of the Budget

The following are the sections of the budget as explained by Milano (2019).

1. Business Income Component (cash receipts)

These include the money the school actually receives such as the governmental capitation and school fees. Some of the sources of incoming school cash include sale of obsolete equipment, renting furniture, school buses and halls, fundraising, grants, donations and recoveries and service revenues.

2. Outgoing or the Expenses Component

Outgoing cash is the section for all payments you make or expect to make during the budget implementation phase. Rent or lease payments, payroll, payments to school vendors and

suppliers and any other expenses that the school principal has to pay physically during the reporting period belong to this section.

3. Surplus or Deficiency

The surplus or deficiency section clearly illustrates whether you have adequate incoming revenue to cover the expenditures that the school needs to make. This section consists of one column that reflects the difference between the incoming cash and the expenditures. If a deficiency exists, you may need to consider how to generate more revenue or seek financing alternatives.

4. Financing Details

The financing section is reserved for outstanding loans and other school financing. This section should list all the loans that are currently open for the school, including the full principal, accumulated interest and any payments the school has made so far. The outstanding debt as compared to the current cash solvency status of the school or other educational institution helps it to determine its current financial health.

Financial Statements and Reports

- i. Financial reporting provides information about the past to assist users in forecasting and deciding on the future financial condition and movement of assets of business entity (Anthony & Rees, 2001).
- ii. Financial statements provide a picture of the performance, financial position, and cash flows of a business and these documents are used by the investment community, lenders, creditors, and the management to evaluate an entity (Accounting Tools, 2019).

The three financial statements are presented in as follows:

1. The Balance Sheet

The balance sheet is also referred to as the statement of the financial position of a company or educational organization. It provides information on what an organization is worth from a book value perspective. The balance sheet is divided into three categories and provides summations of the organization's assets, liabilities and stakeholders' equity on a specific date. In order for the

balance sheet to balance, assets must equal liabilities plus equity. Analysts view the asset minus liabilities as the book value or equity of the educational institution.

2. The income Statement

A company's income statement provides details on the revenue a school earns and the expenses involved in its operating activities. Overall, it provides more granular detail on the holistic operating of an educational organization. Broadly, the income statement shows the direct, indirect and capital expenses a company incurs. Direct expenses are those related directly to earning revenue. Cost of sales represents direct wholesale costs. Costs of sales are subtracted from revenue to arrive at gross profits. Gross profit is then often analyzed in comparison to total sales to identify an organization's gross profit margin.

3. The Cash Flow Statement

The cash flow statement provides a view of a company's overall liquidity by showing cash transaction activities. It reports all cash inflows and outflows over the course of an accounting period with a summation of the total cash available. Standard cash flow statements will be broken into three parts namely operating, investing and financing. This financial statement highlights the net increase and decrease in total cash in each of these three areas.

4. Statement of Changes in Equity

This report documents all changes in equity during the reporting period. These changes include the issuance or purchase of shares, dividends issued, and the profits or losses. This document is not usually included when the financial statements are issued internally, as the information in it is not overly useful to the management team.

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING

- i) Financial accounting is the process of recording, classifying and summarizing financial transactions of an educational institution and interpreting the results of these transactions (Malau, 2005).
- ii) Accounting is the art of recording, classifying and summarizing in a significant manner and in terms of money, transactions and events which are, in part at least, of a financial character and, interpreting the results thereof (Accounting Research & Terminology Bulletin, 1961).

General Objectives of Financial Accounting

There are four basic objectives of financial accounting which include:

- 1. Financial accounting ensures that financial resources are used for the intended purpose.
- 2. Financial accounting determines the honesty and integrity of the accounting officer.
- 3. Financial Accounting ensures proper business management relations with other organizations.
- 4. Financial accounting ensures that authorities have a quick check on both expenditure and proper financial control.

Financial Books of Accounts

The following are some financial books of accounts used to record financial transactions in educational institutions.

a) The Receipt Book

All these books are preliminary records of accounts. The receipt book is where all payments received by an educational institution are recorded or entered. The receipt is issued to the person making the payment. Money paid to schools, for instance, student's fees, grants from the Ministry of Education or non-governmental organizations and other donors, rents and sales is recorded in the receipt book.

b) The Cash Book

The cash book is a book of accounts in which all financial transactions with respect to payments and receipts are recorded. The cash book consists of the debit side (left hand side for money received) and the credit side (right hand side for money paid) (Malau, 2005). The cash book:

- i) Deals with both credit and debit transactions using cash.
- ii) Records transactions chronologically.
- iii) Analyzes transactions.
- iv) Totals financial transactions to be posted to the ledger on a regular basis, either directly or through the journal (Fresh Books, 2020).

c) The ledger

The ledger is an extract of all transactions which are recorded in the cash book against each approved vote head. Each page of the ledger referred to as the ledger account shows financial transactions of a given vote-head. The ledger account is divided into both the debit side and the credit side.

Types of Ledger include:

Organizations usually make a single general ledger which includes three additional subtypes of ledgers as follows:

a) Nominal, Impersonal, Real ledgers

They involve accounts not relating to an individual such as fixed assets, stock, services, wages and property.

b) Personal Ledgers

These includes customer and supplier accounts.

c) Private Ledgers

This includes accounts relating to the management and ownership of the business, including personal accounts of the owners. The ledgers have a distinctive T account. The name of the

account appears at the top of the entries (or top of the page). The accounts are balanced regularly.

d)The Journal

The journal is a book of accounts which contains records of financial events as they occur on a daily basis. The journal entries are accompanied by a narration or an explanation of the transaction.

Other books of accounts include the inventory book, stores ledger, purchase order, commitment register and payment voucher.

FINANCIAL AUDITING

Financial auditing is an investigation of the financial records of an organization in order to ascertain the objectivity and accuracy of the financial statements and it's a process that appraises the accuracy and completeness of the accounting system of finances (Malau, 2005).

Financial auditing is defined as the internal or external assessment, examination, evaluation or investigation of a part or the entire financial transactions, records and statements of a company or educational organization to ensure that the financial records are a fair and accurate representation of the transactions they claim to represent.

Objectives of Financial Audits

There are several objectives of financial audits (Iedunote, 2017; Post Journal, 2019; Srivastava, 2020). The major objectives of a financial audit are:

1. To communicate the reasonableness of the financial statements prepared by the management of a particular public entity or private company. Schools constitute public entities.
2. To verify if the established objectives and goals are achieved in terms of the presentation of the production of goods and/or services. In a school, the audit would be geared towards establishing if it's achieving its instructional objectives.
3. To verify that all controls related to income are carried out efficiently. It is important to note that some educational institutions are involved in income-generating activities such as renting vehicles and equipment, farming and investing in securities and stock among others.
4. To affirm that the legal disposition, the standards and the regulation that are applied in the execution of the activities that must be developed are being fulfilled.
5. To design recommendations that improves internal control and strengthens operational efficiency. Such recommendations, for instance, should help the educational institution to improve its internal financial control and strengthen operational efficiency in financial management.

Categories of Auditing

There are two categories of auditing as observed by Malau (2005) namely:

- a) **Special Auditing:** This is a tightly-defined audit where accounts of a given vote-head are scrutinized to assess how funds on this vote-head were utilized (Accounting Tools, 2020).
- b) **General Auditing:** This is where the form and the content of the budget document are scrutinized in which general analysis and assessment of the organization's financial statements and reports are given (Thornton, 2020).

Types of Auditing

According to Swan (2015), there are three types of auditing as follows:

- 1. Internal Auditing:** This is done by the organization itself. This type of auditing enables the organization to appraise the effectiveness of its financial management techniques (Malau, 2005). Internal audit is an independent, objective assurance and consulting activity designed to add value and improve and organizations operations, and it helps an organization to achieve its objectives by bringing a systematic, disciplined approach to evaluate and improve the effectiveness of risk management, control and governance processes (IIA, 2011).
- 2. External Auditing:** This is done by agencies from outside the educational institution. In schools, for instance, it is done by the Ministry of Education Auditors (Malau, 2005). Satka (2017) observes that the external audit is the audit form/type committed by a third party for the purpose, among others, mainly to verify that the financial statements are presented in the correct way.
- 3. Third Party Auditing:** This is done by an entity completely independent of the organization receiving the audit for purposes of certification, validation or registration as required by law.

Sources of school funds

We will now focus on how secondary schools in Kenya are able to raise their funds. The common sources of school funds include the following;

- Fees from parents/pupils
- Grants from the government
- House and furniture rents.
- Electricity and water charges recovered from staff
- Activity funds
- Building funds
- School farm and other income generating activities
- Sale of old and obsolete equipment

Note

Once this money has been collected, it is important that it is used appropriately to meet the school financial obligations.

Resource Mobilization

Resource mobilization refers to all activities involved in securing new and additional resources for your organization. It also involves making better use of and maximizing existing resources.

Sources of Mobilization Resources

Examples of mobilization resource include:

- i) Processes such as spreading flyers, holding community meetings, and recruiting volunteers;
- ii) Materials: include financial and physical capital like office space, money, equipment, and supplies; and
- iii) Human resources such as labour, experience, skills and expertise in certain fields.

Benefits of Resource Mobilization

- i) It ensures continuation of an organization's service provision to clients;
- ii) It supports organizational sustainability; and

iii) It allows for improvement and scale-up of products and services currently provided by the organization.

The procurement process

This is guided by the public procurement manual for schools and colleges. Public procurement is the acquisition by purchase, rental, hire purchase, license, tenancy, franchise or by any other contractual means of any type of works, asset, services or goods including livestock. This is governed Public Procurement and Assets Disposal Act. 2015.

Purpose of public procurement

- ❖ To maximize economy and efficiency
- ❖ To promote competition and fair treatment of competitors
- ❖ To promote integrity
- ❖ To increase transparency, accountability and public confidence.

Strategic Procurement Process (SPP)

Strategic procurement process has seven strategic steps as follows:

- 1) Step 1- Conduct an internal needs analysis
- 2) Step 2- Conduct an assessment of the suppliers' market.
- 3) Sep 3- Collect Supplier Information
- 4) Step 4- Develop a sources or outsourcing strategy
- 5) Step 5- Implement the sourcing strategy
- 6) Step 6- Negotiate with suppliers
- 7) Step 7- Select the winning bid.

Disposal of Goods and Services

Goods include raw materials, products, equipment, and commodities in solid, liquid or gaseous form, electricity and services that are incidental to the supply of the goods, woks and services. Services mean any objects of procurement or disposal other than works or goods and include professional, consultancy services, technical services, and non-professional and commercial type of services as well as goods and works that are incidental to but not exceeding the value of those

services. Disposal refers to physically removing properties from a department and to removing of the item from a department's active inventory, relieving the department of accountability for reporting or tracking. It is a kind of asset disposal involving the removal of a long-term asset from an education institution accounting records especially as a result of depreciation. Disposal of goods and services in Kenya is guided by the public procurement and asset disposal Act of 2015 (RoK, 2015).

Issues and Challenges facing school financial administration

School managers have the duty to facilitate, support and assist the school boards in the execution of its statutory functions relating to the school's assets, liabilities, property and financial management. In financial management, the following financial management issues and challenges are experienced: parents and guardians may default on fees payment; delays in disbursement of government funds; dishonest or uncooperative accounting staff or BOM members; failure to keep proper accounting records; stakeholders may not be involved in the process of drawing the budget; some BOM members and politicians may want tenders for supplying goods and services to the school in a manner that is not transparent and accountable; and the principal or BOM may lack financial management knowledge and skills e.g. auditing of school finances and this may lead to loss of school funds etc.

LESSON 13

ICT INTEGRATION IN EDUCATIONAL MANAGEMENT (3 hours)

ICT Concept and ICTs used in Education management

The concept of ICT

The concept of ICT means the use of technology for communication and information purposes. ICT has not only revolutionized the world but also changed the way education is managed at different levels (Kafu, 2019). Technology has been seen as a tool to manage emerging issues education such as large class sizes, teacher shortages, maintenance of sophisticated educational data and records as well as new forms of curriculum evaluation.

ICTs used in Educational Management

ICT plays a very critical role in the management of educational institutions in Kenya. School administrators use ICT in the planning of educational programmes, management of personnel, financial management, managing resources and other functions of educational management. The Ministry of education has mainstreamed the use of ICT in management of schools.

ICTs are used in educational management in the following areas:

- Planning
- Human resource management
- Financial management
- Physical resource management
- Security systems
- Communication

ICTs in Educational Planning

Educational planning is a key function of educational managers. Planning takes place at various levels of education. These levels are: national level, county level, sub-county level, and school levels. ICTs are used for effective planning purposes at all these levels. Educational planners use

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ICT to plan for national wide educational programmes which include curriculum development, development of educational infrastructure, recruitment and management of teaching and non-teaching staff as well a financial planning. There are several technologies that are used for these purposes. These include EMIS, IFMIS, NEMIS etc

Educational Management Information System (EMIS)

According to (Hua & Herstein, 2003), EMIS is an institutional service unit that is used in producing, managing, and disseminating educational data and information. It is usually used for planning at the Ministry of Education. The management functions of EMIS include collecting, storing, integrating, processing, organizing, outputting, and sharing educational data and statistics in a timely and reliable fashion. These specific tasks serve the needs of educational management, resource allocation, and policy formulation, such as planning and budgeting, policy research and analysis, monitoring and evaluation, allocating school supplies, and domestic and global communication and collaboration (Hua & Herstein, 2003). An EMIS is also a set of formalized and integrated operational processes, procedures, and cooperative agreements by which data and information about schools and schooling, such as facilities, teachers, students, learning activities, and evaluative outputs, are regularly shared, integrated, analyzed, and disseminated for educational decision use at each level of the educational hierarchy.

In Kenya EMIS has been used to achieve the following planning functions at the National level:

- (i) Timely and reliable production of data and information. There is need to produce data regularly for overall educational planning and budgeting cycle. In order to produce this data, there must be a timely process of data collection, data entry, data processing, integration, analysis and reporting. School heads are very critical in this role as they provide data about student enrolment, transition and status of available educational resources.
- (ii) Data integration and data sharing among departments. It means that data from multiple sources (payroll, achievement, school census), multiple years, and multiple levels (student, teacher, or school level) can be linked, integrated, or merged. Data integration is intended to add value to the data that are already collected and available

in variously scattered places within the same system. These data are usually collected by school heads at institutional level and collected at the regional and county levels. Data integration must occur before an educational policy analyst or planner can conduct a high-level and high-quality policy analysis or planning exercise. It is common to see multiple units within a Ministry of Education collect and manage large databases and not share them with each other. For example, the Ministry of Education, data on student achievement are often collected, managed, and available at an examination unit; data on teacher qualification and salary are at a payroll office; data on enrolment and school inputs are at a statistics unit, and data on supplies of textbooks, classroom hardware, and other teaching resources are often at a supply office. These offices often have separate databases for their own task planning and management and they rarely share them with other offices. These data provide information that is used to answer questions such as:

- a. How much do teacher qualification and salary contribute to student learning achievement, given that the school environment and resource allocation are identical?
 - b. What is the impact of a new teacher-training program or a new curriculum (or any new educational investment project) on student learning achievement?
- (iii) Effective use of data & information for policy decisions. Policy makers, planners, policy analysts, and other high stakeholders are the users of the data and information. These data are used in making important policy decisions that affect the education sector in Kenya. Data integration is a prerequisite before an educational policy analyst or planner can conduct a high-quality policy analysis or planning exercise.

To enable and build an effective EMIS system and capacity, and to create a strong demand for using EMIS data and information, organizational capacity must be strengthened, specifically the capacities of budgeting, planning, monitoring, evaluating, and policy research and analysis, and policy formulation.

Integrated Management Information Systems (IFMIS)

IFMIS is a financial management system that is largely used in government departments for procurement purposes. Installing an effective and efficient FMS ensures that all state corporations raise, manage, and spend public resources in the most effective and transparent way (Ogol & Moronge, 2018). In Kenya, Integrated Financial Management Information System (IFMIS) was adopted precisely because of the push for IFMIS due to the need to mitigate the drawback of the manual public management systems (PMS) and the need to improve efficiency and effectiveness in government service delivery.

This has been championed, as the most effective strategy in mitigating the overwhelming effects of irregularities in the public procurement process that has characterized public institutions for many decades. IFMIS increases oversight, control, and monitoring of receipts and expenditure in the public sector. It increases the ability to access important information on operational and financial performance, necessitate ease of accessing information on state cash position as well as information on economic performance (Ogol & Moronge, 2018).

IFMIS supports adequate policy decisions, management reporting, preparation of auditable financial statements, and fiduciary responsibilities. IFMIS is computerization of state financial management process ranging from preparation of budgets to execution. It integrates all the processes of financial management in the government operations sphere.

The overall task of the system is to connect, accumulate, process, and provide financial information to all stakeholders on a continuous basis. In this regard, it is imperative for the system to provide the needed information in a timely and accurate manner for it to fulfill its central function as a financial management system. The Ministry of Education is mandated to provide high quality education to the people of Kenya. The procurement department in the Ministry of Education has the responsibility of ensuring the effective and efficient utilization of resources allocated to the Ministry.

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IFMIS is likely to improve governance because it provides real-time financial information thereby enhancing accountability and transparency, acts as a deterrent to fraud and corruption, and reduces political discretion. Despite the good intentions of the system, in 2016 colossal amounts of money were stolen using the system (Ogol & Moronge, 2018). Illegal payments, diversion of funds and double payments were done through the system to steal taxpayer's money. It is troubling to note that state ministries have fully implemented IFMIS system yet billions of taxpayers' money continues to be stolen by state officials through manipulation of the IFMIS system (Ogol & Moronge, 2018).

National Education Management Information System (NEMIS)

The National Education Management Information System (NEMIS) is web based data management solution which collects data and information from education institutions; processes and reports the status of designed indicators; and provides the sector a solid ground for effective management to ensure that every Learner counts. The Online Platform tracks performance mobility of learners and teaching staff to ensure efficiency and effective utilization of education resources.

Objectives of NEMIS

The Objective of NEMIS is to help streamline the data management for informed decision-making and planning of the education sector by hosting student / pupil data, linked to a Unique Identifier that is randomly generated using a verifiable algorithm.

Specific Objectives of NEMIS

- (1). Online platform for capture of education data at school level (school and learner information);
- (2). Platform that allows all education agencies to share data collected to ease and facilitate administrative and decision-making processes;
- (3). Provide an integrated Business Intelligence (BI) that provide statistics used to report national and international indicators in education and training sub-sectors;
- (4). Provide flexibility of handling of resources (including infrastructure support, textbooks and facilitation of school feeding programmes) that go to education institutions;

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(5). Help in tracking of costing parameters in education and training;

(6). With inclusion of GIS components, Online Platform will help in geographical analysis of education indicators (including production of various maps much needed in the education sector).

Role of MIS in an Organization

Support for short term planning:

- Helps the managers in short term planning
- Target setting and
- Controlling the business functions
- Strategic planning
- Evolving and implementing business plans
- Support information generation and communication
- Aids problem identification and sound decision making

Uses of computers in educational administration

- Payroll and financial accounting
- Student attendance
- Student admission details
- Inventory management
- Staff data recordkeeping
- Library management system
- Result analysis
- Fee collection

Test administration

- Used for examinations involving large number of candidates.
- Can monitor amount of time each examinee took to answer a particular question
- Immediate results

- Grade card preparation
- On demand exam

Test scoring procedures

- Optical Mark Reader to database
- MS –Excel Spreadsheet
- ICR (Intelligent character reader) software's to convert handwritten mark list submitted by evaluator to excel.

Criteria for adoption of ICT in Educational Management

Given the wide array of ICTs available in the world that can be used in the management of an educational institution, the challenge is upon the school administrator to choose the most suitable technology. The choice of technology is guided by the following criteria:

(i) Cost

The cost of is key in determining the technology to use in the management of educational institutions. The initial outlay towards technological investment is usually high. The manager must choose the technology that is within the range of affordability and budgetary allocation. They need to consider the return on investment. Investing colossal amounts of money on technology that is not viable can have a negative effect of the limited financial resources. It is important to compare the different available technologies and their cost before arriving at the choice of the most affordable ones to use (Hua & Herstein, 2003).

(ii) Flexibility

Flexibility is another criteria in choosing technology. The choice of technology to use must be based on its versatility – i.e. the technology must be open for use to perform various functions. Many of the available technologies come with multiple functions (Hua & Herstein, 2003). The manager must choose the technology that performs various functions relevant to institutional management. This include performing planning functions, data manipulation and storage functions (Smith & Ulu, 2012).

The technology must not be limited to a few key functions, otherwise, this will mean investing in several technologies at a high cost of investment.

(iii) **Adaptability**

The other consideration is adaptability. Various technologies are meant to operate in different business environment. The decision must be made to choose the technology that can be adopted to local conditions in which the organization operates. The technical requirements for adopting technology must be based on the ability of adopting the technology to the local business environment (Smith & Ulu, 2012). The considerations to made include language, technical specifications, server capacity and available infrastructure to support the technology.

(iv) **Relevance**

Relevance is the one of the single important consideration. The choice of technology needs to be made in consideration of the reliance – is the technology able to meet the needs and requirements of the institutions.

(v) **Optimality**

Technology used must be able to perform optimally. The cost of maintenance and running the technological functions needs to be put into consideration. Some technological investments come with high overheads costs such as the cost of installation, deployment and maintenance. The manager has to consider these factors before investing in the required technology (Smith & Ulu, 2012).

(vi) **Skill level of users**

The end users must have the technical expertise to use the technology adopted. Usually this can be overcome by additional training on how to use the technology. User friendly technology that do not require a lot of training and are easy to use would be the best preferred option when making choice decisions. If a successful Implementation of a technology requires complex new skills, and if it is time-consuming or costly to acquire the required level of competence, then adoption might be slow. Consequently, the overall level of skills available to the enterprise as well as the manner in which the necessary skills are acquired are important determinants of adopting new technology.

Finally, it is important to consider the safety parameters of the technology being used. The data protection properties and the safety of users' needs to be considered. It is necessary to consider data protection rights and safety from computers hackers and viruses which may destroy huge and valuable data-bases.

Issues and Challenges Educational Managers Face in Using ICTs

Education management system plays a vital role in planning, decision making and monitoring of the schools. However, various challenges emerge in the utilization of Information technologies in educational management and in decision making (Bhatti &Adnan, 2010; Fedena, 2018). The following are some these challenges:

1. Training in Operating the Education System

The success of an education management system is normally dependent on how well the end users are able to use it. It is very vital that all the technical and non-staff members in the educational institution know how to use the system. This is applicable for the instructional staff as well since they would be working with the system as well. It should be ensured that they are able to utilize the system to the fullest. That is why the end users are given hand-on-training so that the education management system could be implemented in a successful manner. A technical team should be readily available and dedicated to provide the assistance that the end user would need to effectively implement the system.

2. Scalability, Security and Robustness of the Database System

Access uses file server architecture rather than client server architecture and so it cannot be used to build stable and efficient system with many concurrent users. Microsoft access does not support atomic transactions and also do not guarantee about changes within a transaction boundary which are committed or rolled back.

3. Database Security

The risk of data security is very high in each EMIS cell as every individual computer is maintaining its own individual database. Analysis shows that the data is not secure from virus

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attack. Unauthorized personnel may have access to data very easily and can change or alter the data because there is no secure password in most of EMIS cell computers.

4. User Requirements

It is most imperative that the education management software being used in an educational institution is capable of satisfying the requirements and expectations that you have from it. It should ideally be capable of effectively addressing the following kinds of tasks in your educational institution.

- i. Managing course and admissions;
- ii. Timetable management;
- iii. Online examination;
- iv. Attendance management;
- v. Fees management; and
- vi. Examinations management and so on.

In addition, the system should allow access to the board of management, teachers, students and parents by way of login. Similarly, different personnel from various departments in the educational institution should be able to observe and view this information from anywhere and everywhere they wish to.

5. Manual Database Integration and Back up

Central database is maintained at county levels which are not electronically linked with databases at each level. Databases are collected, processed and integrated (manually) into the main database at the county level which results in the extra work load on the central EMIS staff. Each EMIS cell uses portable media like flash-drives, CD/DVDS or external hard drives to effect data backup and transmission to the county EMIS cell for processing and integration into the main data base.

6. Lack of Information Sharing

Information and data is not completely shared among all the education levels or between and among various schools in the same county. County EMIS cell distributes annual statistical

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reports to all sub-counties as a major source of information sharing. Sub-counties do not have direct links with each other for valuable data sharing. If a sub-county wants information about the other sub-county, the request is conveyed through the county EMIS office where it is either fulfilled or denied depending on whether it's in the county database.

7. Non-availability of Adequate information

The developed annual statistical reports that are disseminated to all sub-counties consist of limited information/data based on the perceived demands of the users/stakeholders. This results to lack of data or inadequate information for planning and decision making at all levels. Non-availability of adequate information can consequently affect effective realization of goals and objectives of these regions adversely.

8. Data Migration

The biggest issue that educational institutions face in implementing the education management system is data migration. It is very important that data is uploaded properly in the education system. It is also critical at this stage to decide which data to migrate. It is therefore important that the entire data pieces are analyzed in a clear manner. Data such as student admissions, student attendance, fees collections and students' report cards are rated the most vital data for the education institution. The educational managers should ensure that this information is uploaded onto the database and is then properly checked to verify its accuracy.

9. Delay/Slow Data Dissemination Process

Data is disseminated to all the sub-counties in form of hard copy Annual Statistical Reports via physical medium. This process takes time in distribution of reports to all the sub-counties. Although the report is also available on the EMIS internet, due to lack of internet connectivity, some sub-counties may not have access to it. Integration and processing of data take far too long and as a result delay the timely publishing of the annual reports which leads to delayed dissemination of data. By the time many of the documents are produced, the data is out of date and considered irrelevant.

10. Delays in Planning and Decision Making at Sub-County Level

At the National level, EMIS plays a significant role in generating targets for policy framework and decision making. Nevertheless, at the decentralized level, it's not as effective due to capacity constraints and data transmission delay from national and county EMIS to sub-county EMIS offices. Sometimes if one sub-county EMIS cell needs data of another sub-county EMIS, the central EMIS office either may fail to provide it or delays it.

11. Internet Adaptability, Accessibility and connectivity

Internet adaptability, accessibility and connectivity are always major issues when it comes to implementing school management information system. The use of internet as a method of communication has not been widely adopted in most sub-county EMIS cells. Most of the sub-county EMIS cells have internet availability and accessibility but only a few senior management officials use the internet as a medium of communication to send reports via email to county EMIS cell for compilation. Sometimes, there is no internet due to lack of ICT infrastructure and thus no access to it.

12. Affordability: Additional Allocation of Budget for Accessories

Budget is one of the biggest issues that would confront you when trying to implement an education management system. That is why it is vital that before you try to implement such a system, you need to assess the kinds of finances required for the purpose. The internet is not widely adopted as a primary mode of communication at all sub-county EMIS cells. Most of the sub-counties use flash drives, CD/DVDS and external hard drives for copying, backup and transmission of data to the county EMIS cell for further compilation. Some sub-counties also generate hard copy reports to send to the county EMIS office for compilation. All these activities require additional budget allocation to buy flash disks, CDS/DVDS, external hard drives and other related stationery for transmission of data to the county EMIS and vise-versa.

The challenges of ICT integration in educational management may be common among all education systems in developing countries. They could also be significantly different in terms of magnitude from county to county, country to country, or from region to region. The challenge to

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all the education systems is to design optimal techniques or approaches of addressing these challenges.

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CONTEMPORARY ISSUES IN EDUCATION MANAGEMENT (3 HOURS)

Contemporary issues in educational management are the emerging issues in this vital sector.

Current Education and Management Policies

Competency Based Curriculum (CBC)

The vision of the basic education curriculum reforms is to enable every Kenyan to become an engaged, empowered and ethical citizen. The nexus between the education system and curriculum is important for transforming people's education, training and work. In this regard, the curriculum reform is shifting to curricula that define the minimum standards of achievement for every level to ensure that the learner is properly guided and given the opportunity to acquire the necessary competencies to progress to a subsequent level. This is what CBC seeks to address as captured in the Basic Education Curriculum Framework.

One Hundred Percent Transition

The Kenya government has adopted the one hundred percent transition rate from primary school to secondary school in a bid to improve access to secondary education. This is a noble move to ensure all children have access to basic education as per the Kenya constitution 2010. Education stakeholders have however pointed out a number of challenges that affect this policy. These include congestion due to limited infrastructure, inadequate teaching staff affecting the quality of teaching and learning. The government mitigated on some of these challenges by introducing day wings in a few boarding schools.

ICT in Education

Educational planners use ICT to plan for national wide educational programmes which include curriculum development, development of educational infrastructure, recruitment and management of teaching and non-teaching staff as well a financial planning. There are several technologies that are used for these purposes. These include EMIS, IFMIS, NEMIS etc. According to (Hua & Herstein, 2003), EMIS is an institutional service unit that is used in producing, managing, and disseminating educational data and information. It is usually used for planning at the Ministry of Education. The management functions of EMIS include collecting, storing, integrating, processing, organizing, outputting, and sharing educational data and statistics in a timely and reliable fashion. These specific tasks serve the needs of educational management, resource allocation, and policy formulation, such as planning and budgeting, policy

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research and analysis, monitoring and evaluation, allocating school supplies, and domestic and global communication and collaboration (Hua & Herstein, 2003). Educational institutions in Kenya are expected to use EMIS as a tool for storing and disseminating educational data.

ICT has also been used to capture student data e.g. the Universal Personal identification number (UPI) that is used to identify individual learner right from entry into the education institution through to completion. The UPI is also used to enable learners to access medical services through the newly created National Hospital Insurance Fund (NHIF) cover for learners

Using ICT as a tool in teaching and learning enhances the empowerment of teachers and students to fit in the current world of work. ICT can be used as a research tool, problem-solving, creativity and teaching and learning tool. ICTs have the potential to enhance teaching and learning through:

- Enriching the subject matter,
- Improving delivery, extending methods of presenting information as a teaching aid,
- Overcome teacher isolation, by connecting them to colleagues, mentors, curriculum experts, and the global teacher's community.
- Providing teachers the opportunity to disseminate and share good practice via communities of practice, the internet, access reliable facilities, resources and support on pedagogical issues and the latest curriculum developments.
- Offering opportunities for quick, easy and near real time reports and communication to and from the different sectors is possible through various ICTs.

Issues in Teacher management

The Teachers' Service Commission is the constitutionally mandated body to manage teachers in Kenya as per Act 237 of the Constitution of Kenya 2010. Some of the roles of TSC in teacher management include Registration of qualified teachers, deployment, discipline, transfer and dismissal of teachers. There have been current policies in Kenya with regard to teacher management. Some of these reforms are discussed below;

Entry into teaching profession

The Kenya Constitution 2010 gives the TSC the mandate to review the standards of teaching and persons entering the teaching profession. The TSC has since reviewed the entry grade to the teaching profession from grade C to C+ at KCSE level. The commission has also scrapped P1 grade for primary school teachers and entry for primary school teaching has since been revised to diploma level. Those seeking to head primary schools are also expected to be Bachelors graduates while those in secondary schools should have a master's degree.

Teacher performance appraisal

The TSC introduced the teacher performance appraisal tool in all public schools in Kenya in 2014. The appraisal process involves the county education officers, school administrators, Heads of departments, senior teachers and all teachers. The tool is supposed to be filled in and submitted to the TSC headquarters on a termly basis. There has however been opposition concerning teacher appraisal from Kenya National Union of Teachers (KNUT) that the process is time wasting and adds no value to the teachers. The TSC has on the other hand maintained that this is a useful process and has since developed an improved version of the appraisal tool.

Delocalization

It is the constitutional mandate of the Teachers Service Commission to transfer school administrators and teachers from one school to another. In fact, on accepting the offer for teaching letter, teachers agree that they are willing to teach in any school in the Republic of Kenya. In 2016, the TSC began the transfer of school heads from their counties of birth to other counties, a move that was dubbed 'delocalization'. This was to be later followed by delocalization of classroom teachers. There was however, uproar from teacher unions and teachers themselves that the process was punitive and was done in an inhumane manner with no consideration for age and health status. The TSC however reiterated that each case would be dealt with individually after the affected teachers reported to their new work stations.

Education in Emergencies

The term “emergency education” is used at inter-agency level to refer to education in situations where children lack access to their national education systems, due to man-made crises or natural disasters. Its precise interpretation varies, from a concern with emergency education during the first few months after a crisis, to the years taken to restore normal education systems after a “complex humanitarian emergency. An educational emergency is a crisis situation created by conflicts or disasters which have destabilized, disorganized or destroyed the education system, and which require an integrated process of crisis and post-crisis response (UNESCO, 1999).

Broad categories of emergencies include:

- Natural disasters, such as, hurricanes/typhoons, earthquakes, droughts and floods.
- Complex emergencies: Are situations that are ‘man-made’ and are often caused by conflict or civil unrest, which may be compounded by a natural disaster. In such circumstances, the lives, safety, well-being and dignity of the populations concerned are endangered by various crisis factors, such as natural and man-made disasters and armed conflict.

Some of the emergencies that affect education include

- Armed conflict
- Health pandemics e.g. Corvid-19
- Floods
- Drought

The strongest reasons for supporting organized activities such as education early in an emergency situation are to lessen the psychosocial impact of trauma and displacement and to protect groups at-risk.

Corvid-19 Pandemic on Education

The novel Coronavirus (COVID-19) is a human-to-human transmitted disease which emerged from the City of Wuhan, China in December 2019. This virus had spread to all parts of the world by May 2020. The education sector is greatly affected as millions of learners stay at home for unspecified period of time due to closure of learning institutions.

Effects of covid-19 on education

- Interrupted learning-when schools close children are denied opportunities for growth and learning. The gap is further widened between different social economic backgrounds from which these children come from.
- Ill prepared parents and society for distance and home schooling-parents with limited education and resources, low literacy levels and inaccessibility of technology devices find it difficult to provide education to their children.
- Unequal access to learning portals-lack of technology and internet connectivity across the country is an impediment to equal learning opportunities during the pandemic. This is further complicated by household economic status.
- Dropout rates tend to rise-it is difficult to ensure that learners return to school once they reopen. This is due to a number of challenges like early marriages, teenage pregnancies, child labour and drug and substance addiction.
- Social isolation-schools are hubs of social activity and human interaction. With schools closed learners miss on social contact and that is essential to learning and development.
- Stigma- stigma on persons from homes that have covid-19 patients may be stigmatized and this may have detrimental effects on school going children

Proposed interventions

- Provide TV and radio live broadcast to ensure equitable learning opportunities
- Strengthen radio cloud at KICD to ensure learners and teachers get access to digital content
- Build capacity of teachers on interactive remote learning methodologies
- Provide live streaming of model lessons for peer leaning
- Leverage digital literacy program at the school level
- Share education content in local languages including sign language
- Establish a remote tutoring service for learners and teachers to access remote learning opportunities.

Maintaining Healthy and Safety at School

Health and Safety are major issues especially at this period where schools are experiencing the Covid 19 pandemic and the threat of terrorism. Currently, school principals should provide face masks, clean flowing water and soap for hand washing or alcohol based sanitizers for hands sterilization purposes. School principals should maintain a safe school facility. There is, for instance, need to replace broken windows, doors, locks, drinking fountains, bathrooms, ceiling or floor tiles, etc. or need to replace worn out carpets, black/white boards, chairs, desks, etc. School

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based intelligence should also be put in place since students are major targets for recruitment into terror gangs especially in the poor neighborhoods.

Gender Issues and Teenage Pregnancy

The Kenyan girl child is adversely affected by gender issues ranging from clitoridectomy (female genital mutilation) especially in regions like Kajiado, Samburu, and Narok, early community sanctioned marriages, traditional practices such as preference for the boy's than the girl's education, and gender based labour division, which affects the girl child school performance since girls fail to competitively do their homework given at school (Republic of Kenya, 2020). It is for this reason that girls still lag behind in terms of education outcomes. Teenage pregnancy, which affects the girl child, is another prevalent contemporary issue affecting education of the female gender in Kenya. According to a survey by the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA, 2016), nearly a quarter a million adolescent girls in Kenya aged between 10 and 19 years were impregnated between July 2016 and June 2017. The Kenya Demographic and Health Survey revealed that one in every five girls between 15-19 years has commenced childbearing while nearly 13,000 teenage girls drop out of school every year as a result to pregnancy (KNBS, 2014).

Other contemporary issues include school violence and extremism, drug and substance abuse, Hiv and Aids, child labour.